

FROM MEDICATION TO MEDITATION



how meditation supports physical
and psychological health

OSHO

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“These brilliant insights will benefit all those who yearn for experiential knowledge of the field of Pure Potentiality inherent in every human being. This book belongs on every shelf of every library and in the home of all those who seek knowledge of the higher self.”

~ Dr. Deepak Chopra

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Any advice or teachings given in this book are not intended to replace the services of your physician, psychotherapist, or psychiatrist. Nor is the book meant to provide an alternative to professional medical treatment. This book offers no diagnosis of, or treatment for, any specific medical or psychological problems that you may have. Before you start any intensive activity that may be part of some of the meditations or exercises, consult your physician.

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FOREWORD: MEDICINE AND MEDITATION

A talk given by Osho to the Medical Association in India.

Man is a disease. Diseases come to man, but man himself is also a disease. This is his problem, and too, this is his uniqueness. This is his good fortune, and also his misfortune. No other animal on Earth is such a problem, an anxiety, a tension, a disease, an illness, in the way man is. And this condition itself has given man all growth, all evolution, because “disease” means that one cannot be happy with where one is; one cannot accept what one is. This disease itself has become man’s dynamism, his restlessness, but at the same time it is his misfortune also, because he is agitated, unhappy, and he is suffering.

No other animal except man is capable of becoming mad. Unless man drives some animal insane, it does not go mad on its own – does not become neurotic. Animals are not mad in the jungle, they become crazy in a circus. In the jungle, the life of an animal is not warped; it becomes perverted in a zoo. No animal commits suicide; only man can commit suicide.

Two methods have been tried to understand and cure the disease called man. One is medicine, the other is meditation. Both these are treatments for the same disease. It will be good to understand here that medicine considers each disease in man separately – an approach of analysis of the part. Meditation considers man as a whole a disease. Meditation considers the very personality of man as the disease. Medicine considers that diseases come to man and then they go – that they are something alien to man. But slowly this difference has diminished and medical science too has started saying, “Do not treat the disease, treat the patient.”

This is a very important statement, because this means that disease is nothing but a way of life which a patient lives. Every man does not fall sick in the same fashion. Diseases also have their own individuality, their

personality. It is not that if I suffer from TB and if you also suffer from TB, we both will be patients of the same kind. Even our TBs will present themselves in two forms, because we are two different individuals. It may also happen that the treatment that cures my TB does not bring about any relief to your TB. So deep down the patient is at the roots, not the disease.

Medicine catches the diseases in man very superficially. Meditation gets hold of man from deep within. In other words it can be said that medicine tries to bring about the health of a person from the outside; meditation tries to keep the inner being of a person healthy. Neither can the science of meditation be complete without medicine, nor can the science of medicine be complete without meditation, since man is both body and soul. In fact it is a linguistic mistake also to call man both of them.

For thousands of years man has thought that the body and the soul of a person are separate entities. This thinking has given rise to two very dangerous results. One of the results was that some people considered that man was only the soul and they neglected the body. Such people brought about developments in meditation but not in medicine – medicine could not become a science; the body was totally disregarded. In contrast, some people considered man as only the body and negated the soul. They did a lot of research and development in medicine but no steps towards meditation.

But man is both at the same time. I am also saying that this is a linguistic mistake: when we say both at the same time, it gives the impression that there are two things but connected together. No, in fact the body and the soul of man are two ends of the same pole. If it is seen in the right perspective, we will not be able to say that man is body plus soul – it is not so. Man is psycho-somatic or somato-psychic. Man is mind-body or body-mind.

According to me, that part of the soul which is within the grasp of our senses is the body, and that part of the body which is beyond the grasp of the senses is the soul. The invisible body is the soul, the visible soul is the

body. They are not two different things, they are not two separate entities, they are two different states of vibrations of the same entity.

Actually, this notion of duality has harmed mankind badly. We always think in terms of two and land up with problems. Initially we used to think in terms of matter and energy; now we do not. Now we cannot say that matter and energy are separate. Now we say that matter is energy. The reality is that use of the old language is creating difficulties. Even to say that matter is energy is not right. There is something – let us call it X – which seen on the one end is matter while seen on the other end is energy; they are not two. They are two different forms of the same entity.

Similarly the body and the soul are two ends of the same entity. Illness can begin from either of the two ends. It can start from the body and reach to the soul; in fact, whatever transpires in the body, its vibrations are felt in the soul. That is why sometimes it happens that a man is physically cured of a disease but still he goes on feeling ill. The disease has left the body; the doctor says there is no disease, but the patient still feels ill and refuses to believe that he is not sick. All the various investigations and tests indicate that clinically everything is alright, but the patient keeps on saying that he does not feel well.

This type of patient has really bothered the doctors a lot, because all the modes of investigation indicate that there is no disease. But having no disease does not mean that you are healthy. Health has its own positivity. Absence of diseases is only a negative state. We might be able to say that there is no thorn, but that does not mean the presence of a flower; that there is no thorn only indicates the absence of thorns. But the presence of a flower is another matter altogether.

The science of medicine has so far not been able to achieve anything in the dimension of what health is. Its whole work has been in the dimension of what disease is. If you question the science of medicine about diseases it tries to give definitions, but if you ask it what health is then it tries to deceive you. It says that when there is no disease, then whatever remains is

health. This is deception, not a definition. How can you define health in relation to disease? It is like defining a flower in relation to thorns; it is like defining life in relation to death, or light in relation to darkness. It is like defining a man in relation to a woman, or vice-versa.

No, the science of medicine has not been able to say so far what health is. It can only tell us what disease is, naturally. There is a reason for it. The reason is that the science of medicine only grasps from the outside, only grasps the bodily manifestations – from the outside only the disease can be grasped. Health can be grasped only from that which is within the man, his innermost being and his soul. In this respect the Hindi word *swasthya* is really wonderful. The English word “health” is not synonymous with *swasthya*. Health is derived from healing; illness is associated with it. Health means healed – the one who has recovered from illness.

Swasthya does not mean that, *swasthya* means the one who has settled within himself, the one who has reached himself. *Swasthya* means the one who is able to stand within himself, and that is why *swasthya* is not just health. Actually there is no word in any other language in the world comparable to the word *swasthya*. All the other languages of the world have words which are synonyms either with disease or with no-disease. The very concept of *swasthya* that we carry is that of no-illness. But having no-illness is necessary but not enough for *swasthya*. Something else is required – something from the other end of the pole, from our inner being. Even if a disease starts from the outside, its vibrations are echoed all the way to the soul.

Suppose I throw a stone in a calm lake: the disturbance occurs only at the place where the stone hits the water, but the ripples produced reach the banks of the lake where the stone did not hit. Similarly, whatever happens to our body, its ripples reach the soul. And if clinical medicine treats only the body, then what will happen to those ripples which have reached far away to the banks? If we have thrown a stone in the lake and if we concentrate only at the place where the stone has hit the water and settled

down, then what will happen to all those ripples which now have their own existence independent of the stone?

Once a man falls ill, the vibrations of the disease enter the soul, and that is why often the disease persists even after the body has been given the treatment and is cured. This persistence of the disease is there because of its vibrations which echoed all the way to the innermost being of the person and for which medical science has no solution so far. So medical science will always remain incomplete without meditation. We will be able to cure the disease but we will not be able to cure the patient. Of course, it is in the interest of the doctors that the patient is not cured; that only the disease is cured but the patient should always come back!

The disease can also originate from the other end. Actually, in the state in which man is, the disease is already present there. In the state in which man is, there is a lot of tension present within him. I have already said before that no other animal is dis-eased in this manner, is restless in this manner, is in such a tension – and there is a reason for this. No other animal's mind has this idea of becoming something else. A dog is a dog; it does not have to become one. But a man has to become a human being, he is not one already. That is why we cannot say to a dog that he is a little less dog. All dogs are equally dogs. But in the case of man, we can reasonably say to a man that he is a little less man. Man is never born in his completeness.

Man is born in an incomplete state; all other animals are born in their completeness. It is not so with man. There are certain things he will have to do in order to be complete. This state of incompleteness is his disease. That is why he is troubled throughout the twenty-four hours. It is not that only a poor man is in trouble because of his poverty – this is how we commonly think. But we do not realize that on becoming rich, only the level of trouble changes but the troubles remain.

The truth is that a poor man is never in such anxiety as a rich man gets into, because the poor man at least has a justification for his problems – that he is poor. A rich man does not have even this justification. He cannot even

pinpoint the reason for his anxiety. And when an anxiety is without any apparent cause, it becomes terrible. A reason gives you some relief, some consolation, because then one has hopes that one may be able to remove the reasons. But when some trouble arises without any reason then difficulties increase.

The poor nations have suffered a lot, but the day they become rich they will realize that the rich countries have their own sufferings.

I would like that humanity chooses the rich man's sufferings, not the poor man's. If it is a question of choosing sufferings, then it is better to choose those of a rich man. But the intensity of restlessness will be heightened.

Today, the amount of restlessness and anxiety faced by America is greater than any other country in the world. Although no other community has ever had the amount of facilities that are available in America today, actually it is in America that for the first time disillusionment has taken place. For the first time the illusions have been broken. Man used to think he was in anxiety due to some reason. In America, for the first time it has become clear that man is in anxiety not because of any reason; man himself is the anxiety. He invents new anxieties for himself. The personality that is there within him goes on demanding continuously for something that is not there. That which is there goes on becoming meaningless every day; that which has already been achieved becomes meaningless, futile. There is a continuous striving for those things which one does not have.

Nietzsche has said somewhere that man is a bridge stretched between two impossibilities – always eager to achieve the impossible, always eager to become complete. It is out of this eagerness to become complete that all the religions have been born.

It will be useful to note that there was a time on the earth when the priest was the physician also, when the religious leader was the doctor also. He was the priest and he was the doctor. And it will not be surprising if we end up with the same situation again tomorrow. There will only be a slight

difference: the one who is a physician will be the priest! This has started happening in America, because for the first time it has become clear that the question is not of the body alone; and also it has come to light that if the body is completely healthy, then the problems increase manyfold, because for the first time the person starts sensing the disease which is present within, at the other pole from the body.

Our senses too need causes. If a thorn has pierced one's leg, then only does one feel the leg. As long as the thorn does not prick one's leg, one remains unaware of the leg. When the thorn is in the leg, then one's whole soul becomes like an arrow pointed towards the leg; it notices only the leg and nothing else – naturally. But if the thorn is removed from the leg, then too the being would need to notice something else. If your hunger is satisfied, good clothes are available to wear, your house is in proper order, you get the wife you wanted – although there is no bigger calamity in this world than this. There is no end to the sufferings of a person who gets the wife he wanted. If you do not get the wife you want, then at least you can derive some happiness out of hope. That too is lost when you get the wife you want.

I have heard about an asylum. A man had gone to see the asylum, and the superintendent of the asylum took him around on a tour. In front of a particular cell the man asked the superintendent what was wrong with the inmate. The superintendent replied that this person became mad because he could not get the woman with whom he was in love. In another cell the inmate was trying to break the bars, was beating his chest, was pulling at his hair. When asked what was wrong with this man, the superintendent replied that this man got the same woman the other person could not get, and he became mad. But because he could not get his beloved, the first person used to keep her photograph near his heart and was happy in his madness, while the second person was beating his head against the bars! Fortunate are those lovers who do not get their beloveds!

In fact, whatever we have not achieved, we hope for it and can go on living in that hope. Once we have achieved it our hopes are shattered and we

become empty. The day the physician makes man free from his body-problems, that day he will have to take on the other part of the work. The day man becomes free of his bodily diseases, that day we are providing him with the situation in which he can become aware of his inner diseases. For the first time he will be troubled inside and will wonder that everything on the surface is alright, and yet nothing seems to be alright.

It is not surprising that in India, twenty-four *tirthankaras* were the sons of kings; Buddha was a king's son, Rama and Krishna were all from royal families. For these people the restlessness had disappeared from the level of the body; their restlessness had begun from within now.

Medicine tries to free man from diseases superficially, at the level of the body. But remember, even freed from all his diseases, man does not become free from the basic disease of being a man. That disease of being a man is a desire for the impossible. That disease of being a man is to be not satisfied with anything, that disease of being a man is making all that one achieves futile and attaching significance to whatever one has not got.

The cure for the disease of being a man is meditation. For all the other diseases, physicians have the cure, medicine has the cure; but for this particular disease of being a man only meditation has the cure. Medical science will be complete the day we understand the inner side of man and start working with that too, because according to my understanding, the diseased person who is sitting within us creates a thousand and one illnesses at the level of the body outside.

As I have already said, whenever the body becomes ill, the vibrations, the ripples are felt in the soul. Similarly, if the soul is diseased then the ripples reach the level of the body.

This is why there are so many kinds of *pathies* in the world. It should not be so if pathology is a science; then there cannot be thousands of *pathies*. But it becomes possible because man's diseases are of thousands of types. Some types of diseases cannot be cured with the help of allopathy. For those

diseases which originate in the interiority of man and travel to his outside, allopathy is useless. For those diseases which start on the outside and move towards the interiority, allopathy is very successful. Those diseases which reach the outside from within are not bodily diseases at all. They just manifest at the body level. Their level of origin is always psychic, or still deeper – spiritual.

Now, if a person is suffering from a disease in his psyche, this means no clinical medicine can give him any relief. In fact it may be harmful, because it will try to do something and in the process, if it does not give relief it is bound to do some harm. Only those medicines are incapable of causing harm which are incapable of giving any relief either. For example, homeopathy does not harm anyone, because there is no question of any relief from it either. But homeopathy does give relief. It is incapable of providing relief but that does not mean that people do not get relief.

But to get relief is entirely a different story; to give relief is again a different story. These two things are two separate phenomena. People do get relief because if the person is creating the disease at the level of his psyche then he needs some placebo for it. He needs some placebo for his disease, he needs some consolation, some assurance that he is not sick, but is just carrying the idea that he is sick. That can also be achieved through ashes from some mendicant; that can be achieved through the holy water of the Ganges, etcetera.

Nowadays a lot of experimentation is going on with what you may call illusory medicine, placebo. If ten patients are suffering from the same disease, and if three of them are treated by allopathy, three with homeopathy and three of them by naturopathy, then an interesting result is seen: each of these *pathies* is affecting the same percentage of people for the good and for the bad. There is not much difference in the proportions. This does produce some reason for thought. What is going on?

According to me, allopathy is the only scientific medicine. But since something in man is unscientific, the scientific medicine alone will not do.

Allopathy alone deals with the human body in a scientific manner. But allopathy cannot cure one hundred percent, because man in his inner being is imaginative, inventive, and projective also. Actually a person on whom allopathy does not work is sick due to some unscientific reason. What does it mean to be ill due to some unscientific reason?

These words may sound very strange. You know that there can be scientific medical treatment and there can also be unscientific medical treatment. I am saying to you that there can also be scientific sickness and unscientific sickness – unscientific ways of falling sick. All the diseases which start at the level of the psyche of a person and manifest at the level of the body, cannot be cured in a scientific way.

I know a young woman who went blind. But the blindness was psychological – actually her eyes were not affected. Eye specialists said that the eyes were alright, the girl was deceiving everyone. But the girl was not deceiving anyone, because even if you led her towards the fire she would go into the fire; she would stumble against a wall and injure her head. The girl was not fooling; she really could not see with her eyes.

But this disease was beyond the physicians.

This girl was brought to me and I tried to understand her. I came to know that she was in love with somebody but her family members had stopped her from seeing that person. When I repeatedly questioned her, she replied that she had no desire to see anyone else in the world except her lover. This determination not to see anything except her lover... and if this sort of intensity is present in the determination, the eyes become psychologically blind. The eyes will become blind, the eyes will stop seeing anything. This cannot be understood by seeing the anatomy of the eyes, because the anatomy is normal, the mechanism of seeing is functional. Only the seer who used to be behind the eyes has slipped away, has removed itself from there. We experience this in our day-to-day life, only we are not aware of it. The mechanism of our body functions only while our presence is there behind it.

Now consider a young boy playing hockey who gets injured in his leg. He is bleeding but he does not realize it. Others can see that he is bleeding but he himself has no inkling of it. Then, when the play is over after half an hour, he grasps his leg and starts shouting and asking when he got hurt. It is hurting a lot. Now half an hour has passed since he was injured. The injury in his leg is a reality, the sensory mechanisms in his leg are working absolutely alright – since it is they that informed him about the pain after half an hour – so why was the information not conveyed earlier? His attention was not there with the leg, his attention was on the play, and so great was his attention there that there was nothing of it left to notice his leg. The leg must have kept on informing him – the muscles, the nerves must have twitched – the leg must have knocked on all possible doors, it must have rung the exchange, but the man at the exchange was asleep. He was fast asleep or he was present somewhere else. He was absent, he was not present. When he returned after half an hour, then it was noticed that there was an injury to the leg.

I told the girl's family to do one thing. I told them that since she is not allowed to see the person she wants to see, she has committed a partial suicide – a suicide of her eyes. Nothing else is the matter with her except that she has gone into a phase of partial suicide. Let her lover meet her. They said, "What has that got to do with the eyes?" I asked them to just try it for once. And as soon as she was informed that she is allowed to meet her lover and that he would arrive at five o'clock, she came and stood at the door. Her eyes were alright!

No this is not deception. Now, experiments in hypnotism have shown us that there is no place for deception. This I am telling you from my own experiments. If a deeply hypnotized person is given an ordinary pebble in his hand and told that it is a piece of hot coal, he will behave exactly the way he would with a piece of ember in his hand. He will throw it away, he will start shouting, wailing that he has been burned. Up to this point it can be easily understood. But he will also get blisters on his hands – and then the difficulty arises. If by merely imagining that there is burning coal in

your hand you can get blisters, then it is dangerous to begin the treatment of these blisters at the level of the body. The treatment for these blisters should start at the level of the mind.

Since we consider only one end of man, we have been able to slowly eliminate diseases which affect the body, but at the same time diseases originating from the mind have increased. Today, even those who think only in terms of science have started agreeing that at least fifty percent of diseases are of the mind. This is not so in India, because for diseases of the mind, first a strong mind is required. In India we still see that about ninety-five percent of diseases are of the body, but in America incidents of diseases of the mind are increasing.

Diseases of the mind usually begin from within and spread to the outside; they are outgoing diseases, while those of the body are ingoing. If you try to treat the bodily manifestations of the mental disease, then it will immediately find some other means of manifestation. We might be able to stop the small trickles of the mental disease from one place or a second or third place, but it will definitely manifest at a fourth or fifth place. It will try to manifest from the weak spot in the personality of the individual. That is why so many times a physician is not only unable to treat a disease but also is responsible for multiplying the various forms of the disease. What can come out through one source alone starts pouring from various sources, because we have built dams at different sites.

According to me, meditation is the cure at the other end of the human being. Naturally, medicines depend on matter, their chemical constituents; meditation depends on the consciousness. There are no tablets available for meditation, though people are trying. LSD, mescaline, marijuana – thousands of things are being tried. Thousands of efforts are going on to produce pills for meditation. But you can never have any pills for meditation. Actually, trying to make such pills is the same old stubbornness of only treating from the level of the body, of making all the treatments only from the outside. Even if our psyche is affected inside, we will still treat from the outside, never from within. Drugs like mescaline and LSD can only

produce an illusion of inner health, they cannot create it. We cannot reach man's innermost being through any chemical means. The deeper we go inside, the less will be the effect of chemicals. The deeper we go within man, the less meaningful the physical and material approach starts becoming. A non-material approach, or we could say a psychic approach, has meaning there.

But it has not been achieved so far because of some prejudices. Interestingly, doctors are one of the two or three most orthodox professions in the world. Professors and medical doctors list highest among the most orthodox people. They do not let go of old ideas easily. There is a reason for it – perhaps it is quite a natural reason. If doctors and professors drop old ideas, become flexible, then they will have a difficult time teaching the children. If things are fixed, then they are able to teach efficiently. Ideas should be definite, solid, not shaky and fluid; then they can have confidence while teaching them.

Even criminals do not require the amount of confidence that a professor requires. He should have self-confidence that what he is saying is absolutely right, and whoever requires this kind of confidence about being right in their profession becomes orthodox. Teachers become orthodox. This does great harm, because in all senses education should be the least orthodox; otherwise there will be obstacles in the path of progress. This is the reason why usually no teacher is an inventor. There are so many professors in all the universities but inventions, discoveries are made by people from outside. More than seventy percent of Nobel prizewinners are people from outside the universities.

The other profession that is full of orthodoxy is that of the doctors. That too has its professional reason. Doctors have to make decisions very fast. If they start contemplating when the patient is on the deathbed, then only the ideas will remain, the patient will be dead. If the doctor is very unorthodox, liberal, and practices new theories, does new experiments every time, then too there is danger. He has to make instant decisions, and all those who

have to make instant decisions rely mainly on past knowledge; they do not want to get caught up in new ideas.

These people who are making decisions on the spot every day have to rely on past knowledge, and that is why the medical profession runs behind medical research by about thirty years. This results in many patients dying unnecessarily, because what should not be practiced today is actually being followed. But this is a professional hazard. And so some of the concepts of the doctors are deep down very fundamentalist. One of them is their faith in medicine more than in the man himself – more faith in the chemicals than in the consciousness, more importance is given to chemistry than consciousness. The most dangerous outcome of this attitude is that while chemistry is given more importance, no experiments will be done on consciousness.

Here I would like to talk about a few such examples so that you might get some idea. To have painless labor during the birth of a child has been a very old problem; how to bear a child without pain has been a question since long. Of course the priests are against this. Actually the priests are against the very idea that the world should become free from pain and suffering, because they will be out of a job if there is no pain in this world. Their profession will have no meaning. If there is pain, suffering and misery, then there is a call, a prayer. Maybe even God might get totally neglected if there is no suffering in the world. People may hardly pray, because we remember God only in suffering. Priests have always been against painless labor. They say that the pain during labor is a natural process.

But it should not be there. To call it an arrangement by God is a false idea. No God wants to give pain during childbirth. The doctor believes that for the painless birth of a child some medicine should be given, some chemicals should be arranged for, anesthesia should be given. All these remedies by the doctors start at the level of the body, meaning that we get the body in such a state that the mother does not realize that she is in pain. Naturally women themselves have been experimenting with this on their own for centuries....

That is why seventy-five percent of babies have to take birth during the night. It is difficult in the daytime because a woman is very active and aware at that time. During the night they go to sleep, they are more relaxed, and so seventy-five percent of babies do not get a chance to be born when the sun is shining; they have to take birth in the darkness. When the woman is asleep she is more relaxed and it is easier for the baby to be born. A mother starts creating obstacles for the child right from the moment it is about to be born. Of course later on she manages so many obstacles for the child, but she begins causing hindrances for the child even before it is born.

One of the remedies is to do something through medication so that the body becomes relaxed as it is during sleep. These remedies are being followed but they have their own drawbacks. The biggest drawback is that we do not trust at all in the consciousness of the person. And as this trust in the human consciousness goes on decreasing, the consciousness starts disappearing.

A doctor called Lozem has trusted in human consciousness and he has managed thousands of painless deliveries of babies for women. This method is of conscious cooperation – that the mother tries to cooperate meditatively, consciously, during the delivery, that she welcomes it, does not fight against it or try to resist it. The pain that is produced is not because of the childbirth but because of the fight the mother makes against it. She tries to constrict the whole mechanism of childbirth. She is in fear that it will be painful, she is afraid of the labor. This fear-centered resistance is preventing the child from being born. While the child is trying to be born, there is a tussle between the two; there is a clash between the mother and the baby. This conflict is responsible for the pain. This pain is not natural: it is only from the clash, from the resistance.

There are two possible ways to solve this problem of resistance. We can sedate the mother, if we are working at the level of the body. But the thing to remember here is that a mother who delivers her child in a state of unconsciousness can never become a mother in the fullest sense. And there is a reason for it. When a child takes birth, not only is a child born but a

mother too is born. The birth of a child actually is two births: on the one hand a child is born and on the other an ordinary woman becomes a mother. And if the baby is born in the state of unconsciousness, we have managed to distort the basic relationship between the mother and the child. The mother will not be born, only a nurse will be left behind in the process.

I am not in favor of delivering a child by sedating the mother with the help of chemicals or using superficial means. The mother should be fully conscious during the delivery, because in that very consciousness the mother is born too. If you realize the truth of this matter, then it means that the mother's consciousness should be trained for the delivery. The mother should be able to take the childbirth meditatively.

Meditation has two meanings for the mother. One is that she should not resist, should not fight. She should cooperate with whatever is going on. Just like a river which flows wherever there is a depression in the earth, just as the winds are blowing, just like the falling of the leaves – no one gets an inkling of it and the dry leaf just falls off the tree – similarly she should be in total cooperation with all that is unfolding before her. And if the mother gives her total cooperation during the delivery, does not fight against it, does not become afraid, becomes fully immersed meditatively in the event, then there will be painless birth, the pain will just vanish.

I am telling you this on a scientific basis. Many experiments have been done using this method. She will become free from pain. And remember, this will have far reaching results.

Firstly, we start harboring an ill feeling towards the thing or person that produces pain in us from the very first moment of contact. We fall into a sort of enmity with the person with whom we encounter a struggle in our very first experience. This becomes an obstacle in forming a friendly relationship. It is difficult to create a bridge of cooperation with a person with whom we fell into conflict in the very beginning. It will be superficial. But that moment when we will be able to deliver a child with cooperation and in full awareness....

This is very interesting: until now we have only heard the expression “labor pains,” but we have never heard the expression “labor bliss” – because it has not taken place so far. But if there is full cooperation, then ‘labor bliss’ will also happen. So I am not in favor of painless birth, I am in favor of blissful birth. With help from medical science, at the most we can achieve painless birth but never blissful birth. But if we approach it from the side of consciousness, then we can have blissful birth. And right from the first moment we will be able to build a conscious inner connection between the mother and the child.

This was only an example to put across to you that something can be done from within also. Whenever we fall sick, we are trying to fight the sickness only from the outside. The question is, is the patient really ready from the inside to fight the sickness? And we never bother to find this out. It is quite possible that it is a self-invited disease. The number of self-invited sicknesses is large. Actually very few diseases come on their own, most of them are invited. Of course, we had invited them long before they came; hence we are unable to see any connection between the two.

For thousands of years so many societies in this world could not form a connection between physical intercourse and childbirth because the time difference was big – nine months. It was difficult for them to relate such a distant cause and effect. And then not all intercourse leads to childbirth, so obviously there was no reason for thinking in terms of connecting the two. It was much later that man understood that what had occurred nine months back is resulting in a childbirth today. He could form a cause and effect relationship. The same happens to us regarding illness. We invite it sometime, but it will come later on. Much time passes between the two events, and that is the reason we are unable to see any connection between the two.

I have heard of a man who was on the verge of becoming bankrupt. He was afraid to go to the market, to his shop. He was afraid to even walk on the streets. One day as he was coming out of his bathroom he fell down and

was paralyzed. Now all sorts of treatments are being done for him. But we do not want to accept that the man wanted to become paralyzed. He did not think about this consciously, but that is not the point. Nor does it matter whether he had made up his mind or not to get paralyzed – most probably he never thought of it. But somewhere inside his mind, in his unconscious, he must have wanted that he should not have to go to the market or to the shop or on the streets. This is the first thing.

Secondly, he also wanted people to be less hostile towards him and wanted them to start showing some sympathy – these were his deep desires. Obviously his body will support him. The body always follows the mind like a shadow; it will always support the mind. The mind makes the arrangements. Actually we never realize what arrangements the mind has in its store. If you have fasted for the whole day, then you will have a meal in the night – the mind will see to that. It will tell you in your dreams that you have fasted for the whole day, you must be uncomfortable; let's go to a feast at the king's palace. And you will eat there in the night in your dream.

The mind arranges for everything that the body could not do. So most of the dreams we see are just like these – just substitutes. What we could not do in the day we do in the night. Mind arranges all these things. If suddenly in the night you feel like going to the bathroom, then it means that the mind is sounding an alarm. It will send you to the bathroom in your dream and you will feel less strain on your bladder. You will think that that is alright and that you have been to the bathroom. The mind arranges so that your sleep is not disturbed. Throughout the day and night, the mind is constantly making arrangements so that all your desires are fulfilled.

This man had an attack of hemiplegia and he fell down. Now we are trying to treat that. But actually the medicines might harm him, because he does not have hemiplegia; he has brought the disease upon himself. Even if we treat his paralysis then he will manifest a second or a third, or maybe a fourth disease. Actually, until he gathers courage to go to the market he will suffer from one disease or another. And as soon as he falls ill he realizes that the whole situation has changed. Now he has some justification for

going bankrupt. What can I do?--I am paralyzed! Now he can tell his creditors, "How can I repay you? You can see the condition I am in." Actually, when the creditor will come to him, he himself will feel ashamed to ask for the money. His wife will take better care of him, his children will serve him better, his friends will come to meet him, people will surround his bed.

In reality we never show our love to anyone until he falls sick. So whoever wants to be loved has to fall sick. Women are always falling sick, and the main reason is that for them this is the way of getting love. They know there is no other way of keeping their husbands at home. The wife cannot keep him there but the illness can. Once we realize this, and if this gets fixed in our minds, then every time we want some sympathy we will fall sick. Actually it is dangerous to show sympathy to a sick man; you should only treat him. It is dangerous because through sympathy you may be adding flavor to his disease and this will be harmful.

No medicine will cure this person who has had paralysis; at the most he will keep changing diseases, because in reality he does not have the disease, it is just deep auto-suggestion. The hemiplegia is mental in origin.

A similar story is that of another man who was also suffering from hemiplegia. For two years he was suffering and he could not even get up. One day his house caught fire and everybody ran out of the house. Suddenly they panicked and wondered what would happen to the sick man. But then they saw him coming – he was running – and this person could not even sit before. And when his family pointed out to him that he could walk, he said that that was not possible and he collapsed then and there.

What has happened to this man?... and he is not fooling anybody. The disease is mind-oriented, not body-oriented. That is the only difference. And that is the reason why when a physician tells a patient that his disease is in the mind, the patient does not like it because it seems to convey that he is unnecessarily trying to show that he is sick. This is not right. No one wants to show that he is ill for no reason. There are mental reasons for

falling sick, and these reasons are as important or maybe more important than the reasons for falling sick because of some actual physical problem. And it will be mistreatment on the part of the physician to tell someone, even by mistake, that he is mentally ill. The patient does not feel better with this statement; in fact he feels bitter towards the doctor.

We haven't yet been able to develop a kindly attitude towards mind-oriented diseases. If my leg is hurt then everyone will be sympathetic, but if my mind is hurt then people will say that this is a mental disease – as if I have done something wrong. If my leg is hurt then I get sympathy, but if I have a mind-oriented disease then I am blamed as if it is my fault! No, it is not my fault.

Mind-oriented diseases have their own place, but the physicians don't accept it. This reluctance is because they have treatment only for body-oriented diseases; there is no other reason. It is beyond him, so he just says that this is not a disease. Actually he should say that this is beyond his scope. He should advise you to find a different type of doctor. This person actually needs a treatment which will start from within and then come outwards. And it is possible that a very small thing can change his inner life.

According to me, meditation is a treatment that spreads from the inside out.

One day somebody went to Buddha and asked, "Who are you? Are you a philosopher, or a thinker or a saint or a yogi?" Buddha replied, "I am only a healer, a physician."

This answer of his is truly marvelous: Only a healer – I know something about the inner diseases and that is what I discuss with you.

The day we understand that we will have to do something about these mind-oriented diseases – because anyway we will never be able to eradicate all the body-oriented diseases completely – that day we will see that religion and science have come closer to each other. That day we will see that

medicine and meditation have come nearer to each other. My own understanding is that no other branch of science will help as much as medicine in bridging this gap.

Chemistry does not have any reason to come close to religion as yet. Similarly physics and mathematics have no reason to come close to religion as yet. Mathematics can survive without religion and I think this will remain true forever, because I do not see a situation where mathematics will need the help of religion. Nor can I conceive of a moment when mathematics will feel that it cannot develop without religion. Never will that day come. Math can keep its game going for eternity, because math is only a game, it is not life.

But a physician is not playing a game, he is dealing with life. Most probably it is the medical doctor who will become the first bridge between religion and science. Actually it has already started happening, especially in the more developed and understanding nations. The reason is that the doctors have to deal with human lives. It is what Carl Gustav Jung said just before dying. He said that on the basis of being a physician I can say that of all the patients who came to me after the age of forty, basically their illness was because of lack of religion. It is a very surprising point. If somehow we can give them some kind of religion then they will become healthy.

This is worth understanding. As the life of a person declines...until the age of thirty-five it is on the rise, then it starts moving down. Thirty-five is the peak. So it is possible that up to the age of thirty-five a person may not find any value in meditation, because until then man is body-oriented ; the body is still on the rise. Perhaps all the diseases in this stage are of the body. But after the age of thirty-five, the diseases will take a new turn, because now life has started moving towards death. And when life grows, it spreads toward the outside, but when man dies he shrinks withinwards. Old age is to have shrunk withinwards.

The truth is that most probably all the diseases of old people are deep down rooted in death.

Usually people say that such and such person died because of such and such sickness. But I think it would be more appropriate to say that such and such person is sick because of death. What happens is that the possibility of death makes a person vulnerable to all kinds of diseases. As soon as a person feels that he is moving towards death, all the doors open up to various diseases and he starts catching hold of them. Even if a healthy person comes to know for sure that he is going to die tomorrow, he will fall sick. Everything was alright, all the reports were normal; X-ray was normal, the blood pressure was within normal limits, the pulse was alright; the stethoscope was conveying that everything was perfect. But if a person becomes convinced completely that tomorrow he is going to die, then you will see that he starts catching a variety of diseases. He will catch so many diseases in twenty-four hours that it is difficult to catch them in twenty-four lifetimes.

What has happened to this person? He has opened himself up to all kinds of diseases. He has stopped resisting. Since he was sure of his death, he has moved away from his consciousness which was within him acting as a wall and forming a barrier against all the diseases. Now he has become ready for his death and the diseases start coming. And that is why a retired person dies soon.

So everybody wishing to retire should understand this before they retire. They die sooner by as much as five or six years. The one who would have died at the age of seventy will die when he is only sixty-five; the one who would have died at the age of eighty, will die when he is seventy-five. Those ten, fifteen years of retirement will be spent in the preparation for death; he will not accomplish anything else, because now he knows that he is of no use in life. There is no work for him, no one greets him on the road.

It was different when he was in the office. Now no one even looks at him, because now they have to greet someone else. Everything works on economics. New people are there in the office, so people will have to greet them. They cannot afford to go on greeting this man as well. They will

forget him. Now he suddenly realizes that he has become useless. He feels uprooted. He is of no use to anybody. Even the children are busy with their wives, going out to movies. The people he knew have slowly started ending up at the burning ghats. He has become useless for the same people who needed him earlier. Suddenly he becomes vulnerable, he opens up completely for death.

When does the consciousness of man become healthy from within? First, when he starts feeling his inner consciousness. Usually we do not feel the inner; all our feelings are for the body – for the hand, for the leg, for the head, for the heart. There are no feelings of “I am.” Our whole awareness is concentrated on the house and not on the dweller in the house.

This is a very dangerous situation, because if the house starts falling down tomorrow then I will think that I am falling, and this itself will become my sickness. But if I understand that I am different from the house, I am only residing in it – even if the house collapses I will still remain – then this will make a big difference, a basic difference. Then the fear of death will fade away.

Without meditation the fear of death never vanishes. So the first meaning of meditation is awareness of oneself. As long as we are in consciousness, our consciousness is always an awareness about something, it is never about itself. That is why when we are sitting alone we start feeling sleepy, because there is nothing to do. If we are reading a paper or listening to the radio, then we feel that we are awake. If we leave a person alone in a dark room then he will feel sleepy, because since you cannot see anything you do not require your consciousness. If you cannot see anything then what can you do except sleep? There does not seem to be any other solution. If you are alone, there is darkness, no one to talk to, nothing to think about, then sleep will envelop you. There is no other way.

Remember that sleep and meditation are alike in one sense, and different in another. Sleep means that you are alone but you are in a slumber.

Meditation means that you are alone but awake. This is the only difference. If you can remain awake about yourself when you are alone....

One day a person sitting with Buddha was fidgeting with his toe.

Buddha asked him, “Why are you moving your toe?”

The person replied, “Forget it, it was just moving. I was not even aware of it.”

Buddha said, “Your toe is moving and you do not even know? Whose toe is it? Is it yours?”

The man said, “It is mine – but why have you deviated from what you were saying? Please continue.”

Buddha said, “I will not continue with my talk anymore because the person I was talking to is unconscious. And remain aware of your toe movement in future. That will create double awareness in you. In the awareness of the toe will be born the awareness of the watcher as well.”

Awareness is always double-pointed. If we experiment with it, then one side of it will go outwards and the other one will pierce within you. So the basic meditation is that we start becoming aware of our bodies and ourselves. And if this awareness can increase then the fear of death will fade away.

And the medical science which cannot free man from the fear of death can never cure this disease which is man. Of course medical science tries hard; it tries to increase the life span. But increasing your life span increases only the waiting period for death and nothing else. And it is better to wait for a shorter period of time than a longer one. You make death even more pitiful by increasing the life span.

Do you know, there is a movement going on in those countries where medical science has increased the life span of people. This movement is for euthanasia. The old people are demanding that they should be given a right to die in the constitution. They say that life has become arduous for them and you are just keeping them hanging on in the hospitals. It has become possible: you can put a man on an oxygen cylinder and keep him hanging on endlessly. You can keep him alive, but that life will be worse than death. God knows how many people in Europe and America are lying in hospitals in upside down or other strange positions, hooked up to oxygen cylinders. They have not the right to die, and they are demanding to be given the right to die.

My understanding is that by the end of this century most of the developed countries in the world will have the right to die as one of the constitutional rights of man, because the doctor has no right to keep a person alive against his wishes.

By increasing the age of a person you cannot remove the fear of death from him. By making a person healthy you can make his life more happy but not fearless. Fearlessness comes in only one situation, which is when one comes to understand from within that there is something in him that never dies. This understanding is absolutely essential.

Meditation is the realization of this immortality, that that which is within me never dies. Only that dies which is on the outside. And that is why you should treat the body medically so that it lives happily for as long as it lives, and at the same time try to be aware of what is inside you so that even if death is at your doorstep, you are not afraid. This inner understanding is fearlessness.

Meditation from within and medication on the outside; then you can make medical science a complete science.

According to me, meditation and medicine are two poles of the same science where the connecting link is still missing. But slowly, slowly they

are coming closer to each other. Today, in most of the major hospitals of America, a hypnotist has become essential. But hypnotism is not meditation. However, this is a good step. At least it shows that there is an understanding that something needs to be done about the consciousness of man, and that only treating the body is not enough.

And I think that if a hypnotist has entered the hospitals today, then tomorrow a temple will also enter. It will come later, it will take some time. After the hypnotist every hospital will have a department of yoga, of meditation. It should happen. Then we will be able to treat man as a whole. The body will be taken care of by the doctors, the mind by the psychologists, and the soul by yoga, meditation.

The day the hospitals accept man as a whole, as a totality, and then treat him as such, will be a day of rejoicing for mankind. I request you to think in that direction so that this day will come soon.

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1. DEFINITION OF HEALTH

What is meant by health? This we must try to understand. Ordinarily, if we ask a physician what the definition of health is, he will only say that health is the absence of sickness. But this definition is negative. It is unfortunate that we must define health in terms of illness. Health is a positive thing, a positive state. Illness is negative. Health is our nature; illness is an incursion upon nature. So it is very strange that we must define health in terms of illness.

That we must define the host in terms of the guest – this is very strange. Health coexists with us; illness comes occasionally. Health accompanies us at birth; illness is a superficial phenomenon. But if we ask a physician what is the meaning of health, he can only say that health is present when illness is absent. Paracelsus used to say that this interpretation is wrong – that the concept of health needs to be positively defined. But how can we arrive at a positive definition, at an interpretation of the concept of health that will be creative?

Paracelsus used to say, “Until we know the state of your inner harmony, we can at the most release you from your illness – because your inner harmony is the source of your health. But when we release you from one illness, you will immediately catch another, because nothing has been done with regard to your inner harmony. The fact of the matter is that it is your inner harmony which must be supported.”

Western medical science has viewed man as a separate unit – apart from nature. That is one of the biggest errors that has been committed. Man is part of nature; his health is nothing but being at ease with nature.

Western medicine takes a mechanical view of man, so wherever mechanics can be successful, it is successful. But man is not a machine; man is an

organic unity, and man needs not only the treatment of the part that is sick. The sick part is only a symptom that the whole organism is going through difficulties. The sick part is only showing it because it is the weakest.

You treat the sick part, you are successful...but then somewhere else the disease appears. You have prevented the disease from expressing itself through the sick part; you have made that part stronger. But you do not understand that man is a whole: either he is sick or he is healthy, there is no station between the two. He should be taken as a whole organism. I will give you a few examples which can make it clear to you.

Acupuncture was developed in China nearabout seven thousand years ago by accident. A hunter was trying to kill a deer, but as his arrow was moving towards the deer, a man not knowing what was happening came in between and the arrow hit the man's leg. The man had been suffering from migraine his whole life; the moment the arrow hit his leg, the migraine disappeared. This was very strange. Nobody had thought about it in that way.

Out of that accident the whole of acupuncture developed, and developed to a full science. So if you go to an acupuncturist and you say, "Something is wrong with my eyes," or "Something is wrong with my head," or "Something is wrong with my liver," he may not bother about your liver, your head or your eyes. He will think of the whole organism; he will try to heal *you* – not just the part that is sick.

Acupuncture has developed an approach to seven hundred points, which were discovered in man's body. Man's body is a bioelectric phenomenon, alive. It has a certain electricity – hence we call it bio-electricity. This bioelectricity can be reached through seven hundred points in the body, and each point relates to some part of the body, which may be far away from it. That's what happened in that accident: the arrow hit a bioelectric point that related to the head, and the migraine disappeared.

Acupuncture is more holistic. The difference has to be understood. When you take man as a machine you take a partial view of him. If his hand is

sick, you just treat the hand; you don't bother about his whole body, of which the hand is only a part. The mechanical outlook is partial. It succeeds, but its success is not real success because the same disease that has been repressed in the hand by medicine, surgery or other things, starts expressing itself somewhere else in a worse form. So medicine has developed tremendously; surgery has become a great science – but man is suffering from more diseases, sicknesses, than ever.

This dilemma can be understood. Man should be taken as a whole, treated as an organic unity. But the problem with modern medicine, Western medicine, is that it does not think you have any soul, that you have anything more than a body-mind structure. You also are a machine: your eyes can be replaced, your hands can be replaced, your legs can be replaced – and sooner or later brains will be replaced.

But do you think if we can take Albert Einstein's brain while he is dying, remove it before death is certain and transplant it, for example in the skull of Polack the pope, do you think he will become an Albert Einstein? The brain is only a part. He would become a strange phenomenon, a crossbreed between a Polack and Albert Einstein. At least right now he is perfectly a Polack; then he would be in a limbo, not knowing who he is – a pope or a physicist.

In India, medical science developed almost five thousand years ago. And you will be surprised to know that whatever surgery we have today is exactly described by Sushrut, one of the greatest surgeons in the East, in ancient scriptures five to seven thousand years old. But it was abandoned – and that is the point I want you to notice. Why was a developed science abandoned? – because it was found that surgery takes man as a mechanism, and man is not a mechanism; so rather than destroying man they abandoned surgery.

All the finest instruments that surgery uses are described by Sushrut in his scripture. All the operations, even the brain operations, are described in full detail as if it is a modern textbook on surgery. But it is at least five thousand

years old. They developed it to the same point where we are, and they must have faced the same problem that we are facing. They must have found that something is basically wrong.

We go on working so much... and the sickness and the disease go on increasing. Even if we make a person without sickness, that does not mean that he is healthy. Absence of sickness is not health; that is a very negative definition.

Health should have something more positive, because health is the positive thing and sickness is the negative thing. Now the negative is defining the positive.

Health is the feeling of well being, your whole body functioning at its peak without any disturbance. You feel a certain well being, a certain at-onement with existence. That was not happening through surgery.

India abandoned the whole science and developed a totally different approach, *Ayurveda*, which means “science of life.” It is significant. In the West we call it medicine, and medicine simply indicates sickness. Health has nothing to do with medicine. Medicine means that the whole science is devoted to curing you from sicknesses.

Ayurveda has a different approach. It is the science of life; it helps you, not to cure sicknesses but to prevent sicknesses from happening – to keep you so healthy that the sickness becomes impossible. The ways of the East and the West are different on this point, whether man is a machine or a spiritual entity with a wholeness....

Secondly, what Western medicine has done is make people less immune.

Real medicine should give you immunity rather than take it away. It should make you stronger, able to fight any infection rather than make you weak so that you are vulnerable to all kinds of infections.

One very famous psychologist, Delgado, has been working on animals. He was surprised to know that if rats are given one meal a day, they live twice as long; the life span of the rats who are given two meals a day is cut in half. He himself was surprised: less food and longer life; more food and less life. Now he has come up with the theory that one meal is perfectly enough; otherwise you are loading the system of digestion, and that causes the cut in your life span. But what about people who are taking five meals a day...? Medicine will not allow them to die but will not allow them to live either. They will simply vegetate.

Man has to reconsider all traditions, all different sources; whatever facts have become available have to be reconsidered. A totally new medical approach has to be evolved which takes note of acupuncture, which takes note of Ayurveda, which takes note of Greek medicine, which takes note of Delgado and his research – which takes note of the fact that man is not a machine. Man is a multidimensional spiritual being, and you should behave with him accordingly.

Health should not be defined negatively: you don't have any sickness so you are healthy. Health should find some positive definition. I understand why they have not been able to find a positive definition – because sickness is objective, and the feeling of well-being is subjective.

Western medicine does not accept that there is any subject in you. It only accepts your body; it does not accept *you*.

Man has to be accepted in his totality.

All other methods that have been used around the world should be brought into a synthesis; they are not against each other. Right now they are functioning as if they are against each other. They should be brought to a synthesis and that will give you a better view of man and a better life for human beings.

It is now well known, by brain surgeons particularly, that everything has its center in the brain. If your hand becomes paralyzed, it is stupid to treat the hand; you cannot treat it. Then the only suggestion, the mechanical suggestion, will be to cut it off and put on a mechanical hand, which will at least be movable, you can do something with it. This hand is absolutely useless, it has died. But it has *not* died. Some center in your head controls this hand, and that center has to be cured. The hand has not to be touched at all; that center is not working, there is some problem with the center.

Sooner or later the whole of medicine is going to become dominated by the brain centers. Those centers have control of everything in the body. When something goes wrong in the center it is only symbolically represented by the outer part of the body. You start treating the outer part; you don't go deep enough.

Modern Western medicine is superficial. You should go to very root: why has this hand suddenly become paralyzed?

The center in the brain is in some trouble, and that center can be cured very easily. It is a bioelectric center.

Perhaps when you are not feeling well being it is just that your battery is running out – you need some recharging. If your hand has become paralyzed, perhaps the center has lost its electricity; it can be recharged. No medicine is needed, no surgery is needed. We are in a position now to look at man from different angles: how different societies, in different cultures, in different times have treated man. And sometimes if strange things seem to be working, they should be accepted rather than rejected.

For example, seventy percent of diseases are only in your mind: you don't have them, you just think you have them. Now, to give you allopathic medicines for these diseases is dangerous, because all allopathic medicine is somehow or other connected with many poisons. If you have a disease, medicine is good; but if you don't have the disease but only the idea, then

homeopathy is the best because it harms nobody. It has nothing in it, but it is a great help to humanity. Thousands of people are cured by homeopathy.

The question is not whether homeopathy is real medicine or not. The question is: if people are having unreal diseases, you need some unreal medical system for them. Homeopathy has nothing in it, but there are people who don't have any sickness but are getting tortured with the idea that they have. Homeopathy will help them immediately. It cures people but it never harms anybody. It is bogus medicine – but what to do with a bogus humanity?

The Indian physician and the practical nurse don't have any instruments, sophisticated mechanisms, X-rays or other things; they don't have even the stethoscope. They just check your heartbeat – and this has been functioning perfectly well for thousands of years. They check it because the heartbeat is your very center of life; if something is not perfect it gives them indications of what has to be done. Rather than treating the disease, they will try to make your heartbeat more harmonious. Their medicine will help your heartbeat be more harmonious, and immediately the disease disappears. You think the disease has been treated – but the disease was only a symptom.

That's why in Ayurveda they could discard surgery completely: it was reducing man to a machine. When things can be done very easily with minerals, herbs, natural things, without poisoning the system of man, then why unnecessarily go on giving man poisons, which are going to have their side effects?

Perhaps that is one of the reasons why medicine has grown and evolved, and side by side disease goes on growing. You treat one disease, but you treat it with poison; the disease will be gone but the poison will be left in the system. And that poison is going to create its own effects. So all herbal medicines, all minerals and things like homeopathy should be combined.

There should be only one science with different branches, and the medical person has to decide to which branch this man has to be sent. It is no use

telling somebody, “You don’t have the disease”; it is no use at all. He will simply change the doctor, that is the only effect. He will love the doctor who says, “You have this disease....”

A few people have lost the will to live; then no medicine can help because the basic will to live is no longer there. They have already died; they are only waiting for the funeral time. These people do not need medicine, they need a different kind of therapy which gives them the will to live again. That is their basic thing – only then will any other medicine help.

All these things have to be combined together into a synthesis, a whole, and man can be completely free from diseases. Man will be able to live at least three hundred years; that is a scientific estimate. His body has the possibility to go on renewing itself for three hundred years. So whatever we have been doing is basically wrong because man dies at seventy.

And there are proofs.... In a part of Kashmir that is now part of Pakistan – Pakistan has occupied it – people live very easily to one hundred and fifty years. In Russia there are many people who are one hundred and fifty years old, and there are people who have even reached one hundred and eighty. Now, these people’s foods, their habits should be studied, and those foods and those habits should be made known. A person one hundred and eighty years old in Soviet Russia, in a particular part of the Caucasus, still works in the field just like any young man; he is not even old. His food, his way of living has to be looked into very deeply. And there are many people in that area – only in that area, Caucasia. That area has produced really strong people. Joseph Stalin himself was from that area; George Gurdjieff was from that area – tremendously strong people.

Medicine needs a totally new orientation. It is possible now because everything is known that has happened around the world; we just should not be prejudiced from the very beginning.

There is only one kind of health – you don't need any adjective with it. If somebody asks, "How is your health?" you say, "I am perfectly healthy." He does not ask you, "What kind of health?" If he asks you, "What kind of health?" you will be surprised. You will say, "Simply health! Health is just health, a sense of well-being, that nothing is wrong, that everything is running smoothly, that I am happy, that I can't think that things can be better than this."

Are there many kinds of health? No, there is only one kind: healthiness. But diseases are millions.

The same is the case with truth: truth is one. But lies are millions because lies depend on you; you can go on inventing as many as you want. Diseases depend on you. You can go on living wrongly, eating wrong things, doing wrong things, and you can go on creating new diseases.

Health is the same – always new, but it has always been the same. You can call it the ancientmost and yet the latest, the newest.

Five thousand years ago somebody was healthy, and now you are healthy; do you think there will be some difference? He was not your color, he did not know your language, and five thousand years have passed. But if somebody was healthy, whoever he was, whatever his language, whatever his color, man or woman, young or old – if he was healthy then you know at least one thing that he was: healthy. That feeling of health you can experience. You need not know anything about that man – beautiful, ugly, short, tall, does not matter; one thing is similar, that he was healthy and you are healthy. One experience is exactly the same.

But diseases... every day new diseases go on being produced. There are millions of diseases, and there will be many more as man becomes more inventive.

You never go to the doctor because you are feeling healthy, or do you? Saying, "For two weeks I have been feeling healthy – something must be

wrong.”

In fact in ancient China there was one thing worth remembering; perhaps some time in the future it may be used again. Confucius impressed China the most. One of his ideas was... and it was implemented, for centuries it remained functioning. The idea was that the doctor should be paid for keeping the patient healthy, not for curing him. If a doctor is paid for curing you then his vested interest is that you remain sick. The more you fall sick, the better; the more people are sick, the better. You are creating a dichotomy in the physician's mind.

First you teach the physician that his work is to keep people healthy: “Your function is to lengthen their life, vitality, youth.” But the doctor's vested interest is that if everybody remains healthy, young, nobody falls sick, then he will die of hunger. If everybody is healthy then doctors will be sick, completely sick, sick unto death! What are they going to do?

No, a doctor's vested interest is against the philosophy that he has been taught. His interest is that people should remain sick, the more sicknesses the better. Hence you will see one strange thing: if a poor man falls sick, he gets well sooner than the rich man. Strange... why does the poor man get well so soon? – because the doctor wants to get rid of him, he is unnecessarily wasting time.

Confucius' idea is of great importance; he says that every person should pay the doctor a monthly salary for keeping him healthy. If he remains healthy the whole month then he has to pay a certain amount to the doctor. If he falls sick then accordingly the salary will be cut.

Very strange in the beginning, because we are doing just the opposite all over the world – but very logical, very sane. And Confucius is, in many ways, a sane man. Everybody should have his physician, and he should pay the physician for keeping him healthy, not for curing him. If he falls sick then the expenses go on the doctor; the medicines and all the expenses –

and his salary will be cut, too, because he has not been taking care of the man.

For centuries it continued. And it worked well, tremendously well, for both. For the doctors, for the patients, for both it worked well. Doctors were not so heavily burdened. And patients were perfectly happy because now the vested interest of the doctor was not against them, it was in their favor.

So the doctor was not interested that they should in any way fall sick and should depend on medicine. He was prescribing more exercises – walking, swimming, sports – so they would remain healthy. And for centuries, while Confucius' influence lasted, China must have been the healthiest country in the world.

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2. TO BE HEALED MEANS TO BE WHOLE

The word 'meditation' and the word 'medicine' come from the same root. Medicine means that which heals the physical, and meditation means that which heals the spiritual. Both are healing powers.

Another thing to be remembered: the word 'healing' and the word 'whole' also come from the same root. To be healed simply means to be whole, not missing anything. Another connotation of the word – the word 'holy' also comes from the same root. Healing, whole, holy, are not different in their root.

Meditation heals, makes you whole, and to be whole is to be holy.

Holiness has nothing to do with belonging to any religion, belonging to any church. It simply means that inside you, you are entire, complete; nothing is missing, you are fulfilled. You are what existence wanted you to be. You have realized your potential....

Religion is a journey inwards, and meditation is the way. What meditation actually does is, it takes you, your consciousness, as deep as possible. Even your own body becomes something outside. Even your own mind becomes something outside. Even your own heart – which is very close to the center of your being – becomes outside. When your body, mind and heart, all three, are seen as outside, you have come to the very center of your existence.

This coming to the center is a tremendous explosion, which transforms everything. You will never be the same man again, because now you know the body is only the outer shell; the mind is a little bit inner but not really your inner core; the heart is a little bit more inner, but still not the innermost center. You are disidentified with all the three.

You start feeling, for the first time, crystallized...not that old wishy-washy person you had always been. For the first time you start feeling a tremendous energy, inexhaustible energy that you were not aware of. For the first time you know that death will happen only to the body, to the mind, to the heart, but not to you.

You are eternal. You have always been here, and you will be always here – in different forms, and ultimately in a state of formlessness. But you cannot be destroyed – you are indestructible. That takes all fear from you. And the disappearance of fear is the appearance of freedom. The disappearance of fear is the appearance of love. Now you can share. You can give as much as you want, because you are now at the inexhaustible source of living waters.

Meditation makes you whole, makes you holy, and makes you an inexhaustible source for all those who are hungry, thirsty, seeking, searching, groping in the dark. You become a light. Meditation is the way to the mastery of your own being. No God is needed, no catechism is needed, no holy book is needed. Nobody is needed to become a Christian or a Jew or a Hindu – all that is sheer nonsense. All that is needed is to find your center, and meditation is the simplest way to find it.

It will make you whole, healthy spiritually, and it will make you so rich that you can destroy all the spiritual poverty of the world. And that is the real poverty.

The poverty of physical bodies in food, in clothes, in shelter, can be easily helped by science and technology. But science and technology cannot help to give you blissfulness – that is beyond their scope. And you may have everything that the world can offer, but if you don't have peace, serenity, silence, ecstasy, you will still remain poor.

In fact, you will feel your poverty more than ever, because the contrast will be there. You are living in a golden palace, and you know you are a beggar.

The golden palace will become a contrast: now you can see inside there is nothing, you are just empty.

That's why as humanity becomes more intelligent, more mature, more and more people start feeling meaninglessness, more and more people start feeling life is accidental, that it is just futile to go on living.

The latest developments in philosophy in the West all indicate one thing, that perhaps suicide is the only solution. And of course, if you don't know your inner world, and you have everything available that the outside world can give to you, suicide will appear to be the only solution.

Meditation can make you inwardly rich. Then suicide is out of the question; even if you want to destroy yourself, there is no way. Your being is indestructible. And to know this immortality is a great freedom – from death, from disease, from old age. All those things will come and go, but you remain untouched, unscratched. Your inner health is beyond any sickness.

And it is there, just to be discovered.

The next time you enter a temple of Gautam Buddha or Mahavira, just sit silently, watch the statue...because the statue has been made in such a way, in such proportions that if you watch it you will fall silent. It is a statue of meditation; it is not concerned with Gautam Buddha or Mahavira....

In that oceanic state the body takes a certain posture. You have observed it yourself, but you have not been alert. When you are angry, have you observed? – your body takes a certain posture. In anger you cannot keep your hands open; in anger – the fist. In anger you cannot smile – or can you? With a certain emotion, the body has to follow a certain posture. Just small things are deeply related inside....

A certain secret science has been used for centuries so the coming generations could come in contact with the experiences of the older generations – not through books, not through words, but through something which goes deeper – through silence, through meditation, through peace. As your silence grows, your friendliness, your love grows; your life becomes a moment-to-moment dance, a joy, a celebration....

Have you ever thought about why, all over the world, in every culture, in every society, there are a few days in the year for celebration? These few days for celebration are just a compensation – because these societies have taken away all celebration of your life, and if nothing is given to you in compensation your life can become a danger to the culture. Every culture has to give some compensation to you so that you don't feel completely lost in misery, in sadness.... But these compensations are false. But in your inner world there can be a continuity of lights, songs, joys.

Always remember that society compensates you when it feels that the repressed may explode into a dangerous situation if it is not compensated. The society finds some way of allowing you to let out the repressed. But this is not true celebration, and it cannot be true. True celebration should come from your life, *in* your life.

And true celebration cannot be according to the calendar, that on the first of November you will celebrate. Strange, the whole year you are miserable and on the first of November suddenly you come out of misery, dancing. Either the misery was false, or the first of November is false; both cannot be true. And once the first of November is gone, you are back in your dark hole, everybody in his misery, everybody in his anxiety.

Life should be a continuous celebration, a festival of lights the whole year round. Only then you can grow up, you can blossom. Transform small things into celebration.... Everything that you do should be expressive of you; it should have your signature on it. Then life becomes a continuous celebration.

Even if you fall sick and you are lying in bed, you will make those moments of lying in bed moments of beauty and joy, moments of relaxation and rest, moments of meditation, moments of listening to music or to poetry. There is no need to be sad that you are sick. You should be happy that everybody is in the office and you are in your bed like a king, relaxing – somebody is preparing tea for you, the samovar is singing a song, a friend has offered to come and play flute for you. These things are more important than any medicine. When you are sick, call a doctor. But more important, call those who love you because there is no medicine more important than love. Call those who can create beauty, music, poetry around you because there is nothing that heals like a mood of celebration.

Medicine is the lowest kind of treatment. But it seems we have forgotten everything, so we have to depend on medicine and be grumpy and sad – as if you are missing some great joy that you were having in the office! In the office you were miserable – just one day off, and you cling to misery too; you won't let it go.

Make everything creative, make the best out of the worst – that's what I call 'the art'. And if a man has lived his whole life making every moment and every phase of it a beauty, a love, a joy, naturally his death is going to be the ultimate peak of his whole life's endeavor.

The last touches... his death is not going to be ugly as it ordinarily happens every day to everyone. If death is ugly, that means your whole life has been a wastage.

Death should be a peaceful acceptance, a loving entry into the unknown, a joyful good-bye to old friends, to the old world. There should not be any tragedy in it....

Start with meditation, and things will go on growing in you – silence, serenity, blissfulness, sensitivity. And whatever comes out of meditation, try to bring it out in life. Share it, because everything shared grows fast. And when you have reached the point of death, you will know there is no death.

You can say good-bye, there is no need for any tears of sadness – maybe tears of joy, but not of sadness.

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3. THE SUPERSTITIONS OF MEDICAL SCIENCE

Medical science, physiology, psychology, are very immature in the sense that they are only doing their work on the surface of human beings – they are not finding a way to man's center. And because they do not accept the existence of some consciousness beyond mind, of some consciousness beyond death, they are completely closed, prejudiced against the whole tremendous effort mystics have made in finding the center of consciousness.

Many times the diagnosis of a physiologist or a physician may be absolutely wrong for the simple reason that the vision is not comprehensive enough. He understands man only as matter, and mind as just by-product of matter, a shadow phenomenon with nothing beyond it, nothing eternal, nothing that is going to remain forever. They have created a picture of human beings which creates despair in intelligent people. And because of their outright rejection, their approach is not scientific; it is as superstitious as any other fanatic religious or political person's.

Science has no right to deny consciousness unless it has explored the inner sky of human consciousness and found that it is dream stuff, not a reality but only a shadow.

They have *not* explored – they have simply assumed. Materialism is the assumption, the superstition of the world of science, just as God, heaven and hell are superstitions of the religious world.

Science is not yet pure science and it cannot be, because the scientist is not yet innocent, unprejudiced, ready to go with the truth in spite of himself and his conditioning.

? In medicine today, we talk about the subjectivity of therapy; the same medicine has different results with different doctors.

Can you comment about the subjectivity of a science that claims to be an objective one?

Anything that has to do with human beings can never be totally objective; it will have to allow a certain space for subjectivity.

It is not only true that the same medicine from different doctors has different effects; it is also true that the same medicine has different effects on different patients from the same doctor. Man is not an object.

First you have to understand the word 'subject'. A piece of stone is just an object. There is no interiority, there is no innerness to it. You can cut it in two; then there are two objects. You can cut it in four, and there are four objects. But you will not find any interiority.

Subjectivity means that from the outside a man is just as objective as any other object – a statue, a dead body, a living body, what is the difference? The statue is simply an object, it has no subjectivity. The dead body has once been a house for a subjective phenomenon, but now it is empty. Now it is an empty house; the person who used to live in it has left it.

The living man has all the objectivity of the statue, the dead body, and something more – an interior dimension – which can change many things because it is the most powerful thing in existence. For example, it has been noted that three persons can be suffering the same disease, but the same medicine will not work. On one person it is working; on another it is just fifty-fifty, working and not working; but on the third it is not working at all. The disease is the same, but the interiorities are different. And if you take the interiority into consideration, then perhaps the doctor will make a different impact on different people for different reasons.

One of my friends was a great surgeon in Nagpur – a great surgeon but not a good man. He never failed in his surgery, and he charged five times more

than any other surgeon would charge. I was staying with him and I told him, “This is too much. When other surgeons are charging a certain amount for the same disease, you charge five times as much.”

He said to me, “My success in many other things also has this basis: when a person gives me five times more, he is determined to survive. It is not only because of money that I am greedy. If he is willing to give me five times more – when he could get the operation at cheaper rates – he is determined to survive whatsoever the cost. And his determination is almost fifty percent of my success.”

There are people who don’t want to survive; they are not willing to cooperate with the doctor. They are taking the medicine, but there is no will to survive; on the contrary, they are hoping that the medicine does not work so they will not be blamed for suicide, yet they can get rid of life. Now, from the inside that person has withdrawn already. Medicine cannot help his interiority, and without his interior support, the doctor is almost helpless – the medicine is not enough.

I came to know from this surgeon.... He said, “You don’t know. Sometimes I do things which are absolutely immoral, but to help the patient I have to do them.”

I said, “What do you mean?”

He said, “I am condemned by my profession....” And all the doctors of Nagpur condemned him – “We have never seen such a cheat.”

He would put the patient on the table in the operating theater – doctors would be ready, nurses would be ready, students would be watching from the gallery above. And he would whisper in the patient’s ear, “We had agreed on a fee of ten thousand – that will not do. Your problem is more serious. If you are ready to give me twenty thousand, I am going to take the instruments in my hands; otherwise, you get up and get out. You can find cheaper people.”

Now, in such a situation.... And the person has money, otherwise, how can he say yes? And he accepts it: "I will give twenty thousand, but save me."

And he told me, "Any surgeon could have saved him, but not with such certainty. Now that he is paying twenty thousand, he is absolutely with me; his whole interior being is supportive. People condemn me because they don't understand me. Certainly it is immoral to agree on ten thousand and then put the person in the operating theater and whisper in his ear, 'Twenty thousand, thirty thousand; otherwise, get up and get out – because I had not realized that the disease had gone so deep. I am taking a risk, and I am putting my whole reputation on the line. For ten thousand I will not do that. And I have never failed in my life, success is my rule. I operate only when I am absolutely certain to succeed. So you decide. And I don't have much time, because there are other patients waiting. You just decide within two minutes: either agree, or get up and get lost.' Naturally, the person will say, "I will give you anything you want, but please do the operation."

It is illegal, immoral, but I cannot say that it is unpsychological.

Anything to do with man cannot be purely objective.

I used to have another friend, a doctor who is now in jail because he was not qualified at all. He had never been to any medical college; all the degrees that he had written on his sign were bogus. But still I am of the opinion that an injustice has been done to the man – because it does not matter whether he had degrees or not. He helped thousands of people, and particularly those who were becoming hopeless, going from one doctor to another – all with degrees – and getting tired. And this man was able to save them. He had a certain charisma – no degree. And he made his hospital almost a magic land. The moment a patient entered his office, immediately he would be surprised. He had been everywhere... because people used to go to him only as a last resort. Everybody knew that the man was bogus, it was not something hidden. It was an open secret. But if you are going to die, what is the harm in trying?

And as you entered his garden – he had beautiful garden – and then his office.... He had beautiful women as his receptionists, and it was all part of his medical treatment – because even if a person is dying, looking at a beautiful woman his will to live takes a jump; he wants to live. After the reception, the person would pass through his lab. It was absolutely unnecessary to take him through the lab, but he wanted the person to see that he was not an ordinary doctor. And the lab was a miracle – absolutely useless, there was nothing significant in it, but so many tubes, flasks, colored water moving from one tube into another tube, as if great experiments were going on.

Then you would reach the doctor. And he never used the ordinary methods of checking your pulse, no. You would have to lie down on an electric bed with a remote control. The bed would move far up into the air, and you are lying there looking up and hanging over you there are big tubes. And wires would be attached to your pulse and the pulse would make the water in the tubes jump. The heart would be checked in the same way – not by ordinary stethoscope. He had made all his arrangements visual for the patient – so that he could see he had come to some genius, an expert.

The man had no degrees, nothing at all. His pharmacist had all the degrees, and he used to prescribe the medicines because the man had no idea about medicine. In fact, he never did any criminal thing. He never prescribed medicines, he never signed for them. This was done by a man who had degrees, who was absolutely qualified to do it. But because he arranged all this, and because he had written strange degrees on his sign... and since those degrees don't exist I don't think they can be illegal. He was not claiming that they were from any university that exists. It was *all* fiction – but the fiction was helpful.

I have seen patients half cured just in the examination. Coming out, they said, “We feel almost cured, and we have not taken the medicine yet. The prescription is here – now we will go and purchase the medicine.”

But because he had done all this.... This is when I saw that the law is blind. He had not done anything illegal, he had not harmed anybody – but he is in jail because he was “cheating people.” He has not cheated anybody! To help somebody to live longer, if that is cheating, then what is medical help?

Because of human beings, medicine can never become an absolutely solid, one hundred percent objective science. That’s why there are so many medical schools – ayurveda, homeopathy, naturopathy, acupuncture, and many more – and they *all* help. Now homeopathy is simply sugar pills, but it helps. The question is whether the person believes. There are people who are fanatic naturopaths – nothing else can help them, only naturopathy can help them. And it has no connection with the disease.

One of my professors was madly into naturopathy. Any problem... and a mud pack on your stomach. I used to go to him to enjoy, because it was very relaxing, and he had a very good arrangement – a beautiful bath and showers.... And even though it was not true, I used to go and say, “I have a very bad migraine.”

He said, “Don’t be worried. Just put a mud pack on your stomach.” Now a mud pack on the stomach is not going to help a migraine. But it used to help me, because I had no migraine! A mud bath, the full bathtub, and you are drowned in the mud, just your head is out – it is very comfortable and very cool. Soon he realized: “You come again and again with new diseases.”

I said, “That’s true... because I have got a book on naturopathy; from the book I get the disease, and then I come to you. First I read it, to see what you will do. If I want it to be done to me, I bring that disease; otherwise, unnecessarily lying down in the mud for half an hour....”

He said, “So you have been cheating me?”

I said, “I am not cheating you. I am your most prominent patient! In the university everybody else laughs at you, I am the only one who supports

you. And the others who come here, come here because of me – because I say that my migraine disappeared.”

He said, “My God, now *I* am suffering from migraine. Go!”

People used to become angry with me. They would tell me, “My migraine, instead of going, has become more intense – because a cold stomach does not help migraine!”

I would say, “Then your system must work differently. With my system, it helps me!”

There are homeopaths, fanatics who believe that homeopathy is the only right medicine and all other medicines are dangerous – particularly allopathy is poison. If you go to a homeopath, the first thing he will do is inquire about your whole history from your birth up to now -- and you are just suffering from a headache!

One of the homeopathic doctors used to live near me. Whenever my father came to see me, I would take him to the homeopath. The homeopath told me, “I pray you don’t bring your father because he starts back three generations, that his grandfather had a disease....”

I said, “He is also a homeopath. He goes deeper into the roots.”

He said, “But he wastes so much time, and I have to listen – and he just has a headache! About his grandfather and all his diseases, then his father and all his diseases...then himself. By the time *he* comes, almost the whole day is finished. My other patients are gone, and I am listening to him telling me what kind of diseases he has suffered from his childhood, and finally it comes out that he has a headache.”

“I say, ‘My God, why didn’t you tell me before?’ and he says, ‘Just as you are a homeopath, I am also a homeopath. And I want to give you a complete picture.’”

The first thing they will ask is about all your diseases because they believe that all diseases are connected, your whole life is one single whole. It does not matter whether you had something in your leg or your head – they are part of one body, and for the doctor to understand, he has to know everything. The homeopath will ask you what kind of allopathic medicines you have been taking – because that is the root cause of all your diseases; all allopathic medicines are poison. That is the attitude of naturopathy too, that allopathy is poison. So first you have to do fasting, enemas...just to clean you of all allopathy. Once you are clean of allopathy....

Man is a subjective being. If the patient loves the doctor, then water can function as medicine. And if the patient hates the doctor, then no medicine can help. If the patient feels the doctor is indifferent – which is ordinarily the case with doctors, because they are also human beings, the whole day long seeing patients, the whole day long somebody is dying.... They slowly, slowly, become hard, they create a barrier to their emotions, sentiments, humanity. But this prevents their medicine from being effective. It is given almost in a robot-like way, as if a machine is giving you medicine.

With love the patient is not only getting medicine, around the medicine something invisible is also coming to him. Medicine will have to understand man's subjectivity, his love, and will have to create some kind of synthesis in which love and medicine together are used to help people.

But one thing is absolutely certain: that medicine can never become entirely objective. That has been the effort of medical science up to now, to make it absolutely objective.

4. ALTERNATIVE HEALTH APPROACHES

All problems are psychosomatic because the body and the mind are not two things. The mind is the inner part of the body, and the body is the outer part of the mind, so anything can start in the body and can enter into the mind, or vice versa: it can start in the mind and enter into the body. There is no division, there is no watertight compartment.

So all problems have two edges to them: they can be tackled through the mind and through the body. And up to now this has been the practice in the world: a few believe that all problems are of the body – the physiologists, the Pavlovians, the behaviorists.... They treat the body, and of course in fifty percent of cases they succeed. And they hope that as science grows they will be succeeding more, but they will never succeed more than fifty percent; it has nothing to do with the growth of science.

Then the other party is there which thinks that all problems are of the mind – which is as wrong as the first. Christian Science people and hypnotists and mesmerists, psychotherapists, they all think problems are of the mind. They also succeed in fifty percent of cases; they also think that sooner or later they will succeed more and more. That is nonsense. They cannot succeed more than fifty percent; that is the limit.

My own understanding is that each problem has to be tackled from both sides together, simultaneously. It has to be attacked from the doors, a double-fronted attack; then man can be cured one hundred percent. Whenever science becomes perfect it will work both ways....

The first is the body, because the body is the portal to the mind – the porch. And because the body is gross it is still easily manipulatable. First the body has to be freed of all its accumulated structures. If you have lived for so long with the feeling that you are weak, then it must have entered into the

body, into the very structure of the body. First it has to be relieved from there; and simultaneously your mind has to be inspired so that it can start moving upwards and can start dropping all the loads that keep it down.

? I understand that the science of Yoga regards man as having not one but several types of body. If this is so, does it follow that for different individuals, one kind of medicine might work more effectively than another, depending from where the illness is originating?

The science of man does not exist yet. Patanjali's Yoga is the closest effort ever made. He divides the body into five layers, or into five bodies. You don't have one body, you have five bodies; and behind the five bodies, your being. The same as has happened in psychology has happened in medicine. Allopathy believes only in the physical body, the gross body. It is parallel to behaviorism. Allopathy is the grossest medicine. That's why it has become scientific, because scientific instrumentation is only capable yet of very gross things. Go deeper.

Acupuncture, the Chinese medicine, enters one layer more. It works on the vital body, the *pranamayakos*. If something goes wrong in the physical body, acupuncture does not touch the physical body at all. It tries to work on the vital body. It tries to work on the bioenergy, the bioplasma. It settles something there, and immediately the gross body starts functioning well. If something goes wrong in the vital body, allopathy functions on the body, the gross body. Of course, for allopathy, it is an uphill task. For acupuncture, it is a downhill task. It is easier because the vital body is a little higher than the physical body. If the vital body is set right, the physical body simply follows it because the blueprint exists in the vital body. The physical body is just an implementation of the vital.

Now acupuncture is gaining respect, by and by, because a certain very sensitive photography, Kirlian photography, has come across the seven hundred vital points in the human body as they have always been understood by acupuncturists for at least five thousand years. They had no instruments to know where the vital points in the body were, but by and by,

just through trial and error through the centuries, they discovered seven hundred points. Now Kirlian has also discovered the same seven hundred points with scientific instrumentation. And Kirlian photography has proved one thing: to try to change the vital through the physical is absurd. It is trying to change the master by changing the servant. It is almost impossible because the master won't listen to the servant. If you want to change the servant, change the master. Immediately, the servant follows. Rather than going and changing each soldier, it is better to change the general. The body has millions of soldiers, cells, simply working under some order, under some commandment. Change the commander, and the whole body pattern changes.

Homeopathy goes still a little deeper. It works on the *manomayakos*, the mental body. The founder of homeopathy, Hahnemann, discovered one of the greatest things ever discovered, and that was: the smaller the quantity of the medicine, the deeper it goes. He called the method of making homeopathic medicine 'potentizing'. They go on reducing the quantity of the medicine. He would work in this way: he would take a certain amount of medicine and would mix it with ten times the amount of milk sugar or with water. One quantity of medicine, nine quantities of water; he would mix them. Then he would again take one quantity of this new solution, and would again mix it with nine times more water, or milk sugar. In this way he would go on: again from the new solution he would take one quantity and would mix it with nine times more water. This he would do, and the potency would increase.

By and by, the medicine reaches to the atomic level. It becomes so subtle that you cannot believe that it can work; it has almost disappeared. That is what is written on homeopathic medicines, the potency: ten potency, twenty potency, one hundred potency, one thousand potency. The bigger the potency, the smaller is the amount. With ten thousand potency, a millionth of the original medicine has remained, almost none. It has almost disappeared, but then it enters the most deep core of *manomaya*. It enters into your mind body. It goes deeper than acupuncture. It is almost as if you have reached the atomic, or even the sub-atomic level. Then it does not

touch your body. Then it does not touch your vital body; it simply enters. It is so subtle and so small that it comes across no barriers. It can simply slip into the *manomayakos*, into the mental body, and from there it starts working. You have found an even bigger authority than the *pranamaya*.

Ayurveda, the Indian medicine, is a synthesis of all three. It is one of the most synthetic of medicines.

Hypnotherapy goes still deeper. It touches the *vigyanmayakos*: the fourth body, the body of consciousness. It does not use medicine. It does not use anything. It simply uses suggestion, that's all. It simply puts a suggestion in your mind – call it animal magnetism, mesmerism, hypnosis or whatsoever you like, but it works through the power of thought, not the power of matter. Even homeopathy is still the power of matter in a very subtle quantity. Hypnotherapy gets rid of matter altogether, because howsoever subtle, it is matter.... Ten thousand potency, but still, it is a potency of matter. It simply jumps to the thought energy, *vigyanmayakos*: the consciousness body. If your consciousness just accepts a certain idea, it starts functioning.

Hypnotherapy has a great future. It is going to become the future medicine, because if by just changing your thought pattern your mind can be changed, through the mind your vital body, and through the vital body your gross body, then why bother with poisons, why bother with gross medicines? Why not work it through thought power? Have you watched any hypnotist working on a medium? If you have not watched, it is worth watching. It will give you a certain insight.

You may have heard, or you may have seen – in India it happens; you must have seen fire-walkers. It is nothing but hypnotherapy. The idea that they are possessed by a certain god or a goddess and no fire can burn them, just this idea is enough. This idea controls and transforms the ordinary functioning of their bodies. They are prepared: for twenty-four hours they fast. When you are fasting and your whole body is clean, and there is no excreta in it, the bridge between you and the gross drops. For twenty-four

hours they live in a temple or in a mosque, singing, dancing, getting in tune with God. Then comes the moment when they walk on the fire. They come dancing, possessed. They come with full trust that the fire is not going to burn, that's all; there is nothing else. How to create the trust is the question. Then they dance on the fire, and the fire does not burn.

It has happened many times that somebody who was just a spectator became so possessed. Twenty persons walking on fire are not burned, and somebody would immediately become so confident: "If these people are walking, then why not I?"; and he has jumped in, and the fire has not burned him. In that sudden moment, a trust arose. Sometimes it has happened that people who were prepared, were burned. Sometimes an unprepared spectator walked on fire and was not burned. What happened? – the people who were prepared must have carried a doubt. They must have been thinking whether it was going to happen or not. A subtle doubt must have remained in the *vigyanmayakos*, in their consciousness. It was not total trust. So they came, but with doubt. Because of that doubt, the body could not receive the message from the higher soul. The doubt came in between, and the body continued to function in the ordinary way; it got burned. That's why all religions insist on trust.

Trust is hypnotherapy. Without trust, you cannot enter into the subtle parts of your being, because a small doubt, and you are thrown back to the gross. Science works with doubt. Doubt is a method in science because science works with the gross. Whether you doubt or not, an allopath is not worried. He does not ask you to trust in his medicine; he simply gives you medicine. But a homeopath will ask whether you believe, because without your belief it will be more difficult for a homeopath to work upon you. And a hypnotherapist will ask for total surrender; otherwise, nothing can be done.

Religion is surrender. Religion is hypnotherapy. But, there is still one more body. That is the *anandmayakos*: the bliss body. Hypnotherapy goes up to the fourth. Meditation goes up to the fifth. Meditation – the very word is beautiful because the root is the same as 'medicine'. Both come from the same root, medicine and meditation are off-shoots of one word: that which

heals, that which makes you healthy and whole is medicine – and on the deepest level that is meditation.

Meditation does not even give you suggestions because suggestions are to be given from the outside. Somebody else has to give you suggestions. Suggestion means that you are dependent upon somebody. They cannot make you perfectly conscious because the other will be needed, and a shadow will be cast on your being. Meditation makes you perfectly conscious, without any shadow – absolute light with no darkness. Now even suggestion is thought to be a gross thing. Somebody suggests – that means something comes from the outside, and in the ultimate analysis that which comes from the outside is material. Not only matter, but that which comes from the outside is material. Even a thought is a subtle form of matter. Even hypnotherapy is materialistic.

Meditation drops all props, all supports. That's why to understand meditation is the most difficult thing in the world, because nothing is left – just a pure understanding, a witnessing.

? Wilhelm Reich says in his book, Listen, Little Man, that he found that man reaches out with his life energy when he feels well and loving; that he retracts that energy when he is afraid. Reich says that he found that man's life energy – which he termed “orgone” – is “found in the atmosphere,” outside the body. He says he succeeded in seeing it and devised apparatus which magnified it.

Is what he observed so?

Wilhelm Reich was one of the unique intelligences born in this century. What he has found has been known to the East as the *aura*. You must have seen around the statues of Buddha or Mahavira or Krishna – a round aura around the head. That round aura is a reality. What Wilhelm Reich said was authentically true, but the people to whom he said it were not the right people to understand it. They thought he was mad because he described life as an energy surrounding the body. It is exactly true.

Life is an energy that surrounds your body. Not only your body, but flowers, trees – everything has its own aura. And that aura, that energy surrounding you shrinks and expands in different situations. Any situation where your energy shrinks should be thought bad, sick. And every situation where your energy expands, should be respected and loved. In love your energy reaches out, you become more alive. And when you are in fear, your energy shrinks, you become less alive.

Now, poor Wilhelm Reich was thought by Americans to be mad because he was not only magnifying that energy – he had found a few exercises in which that energy magnifies – he was even catching that energy in boxes, big boxes in which a man could enter. And if the man was sick he would come out whole and healthy. Naturally such a man should be thought mad. He was selling those boxes, empty boxes – but they were not empty. He had found ways to collect the energy which is available in the atmosphere. Around a tree you can find that energy showering, but with your bare eyes you cannot see it.

After he was declared mad and imprisoned, another man in the Soviet Union even managed to photograph it. And now it has become a recognized psychology in the Soviet Union, that life has an aura. And the man, Kirlian, has developed a certain sensitive plate to photograph it. He would photograph the hand, and the hand would come with an aura around it. In a very strange way his photographs even showed if a man would be sick within six months: “Right now he does not show any pattern of sickness, but his aura is shrinking at a certain point....” And if at a certain point the aura is shrinking – maybe the person will become deaf or blind if the aura around the eyes is shrinking. And all his photographs proved to be right. When he said, “This man is in danger of losing his eyesight,” there was no visible sign, there was no reason to believe it, but within six months that man became blind. Kirlian photography was recognized by the Soviet government, and now it is spreading into other countries also. A man can be cured before he becomes sick. Kirlian photography is very predictive. It shows, at least six months ahead, what is going to happen.

In the East it has been known for centuries that before your death, six months before, you stop being able to see the tip of your nose. Because your eyes start turning upwards, they cannot see the tip of your own nose. The moment you recognize you cannot see the tip of your nose means that within six months your energy will shrink, go back to its source. And the aura, without any photographic technology, has been recognized by yoga for five thousand years. But now, it can be accepted on scientific grounds.

Wilhelm Reich was a unique genius. He could manage to see and feel what is not ordinarily possible. But if you are very meditative, you will start seeing the auras of people, even your own aura. You will see your own hand with the light rays around it, radiating. And when you are healthy you will feel your aura expanding. When you are sick you will feel your aura shrinking – something is shrinking within you.

When you are by the side of a sick person, you will have a strange feeling that he somehow makes you feel sick, because the sick person exploits the auras of the other without his knowing. He needs more life, so whoever has life and comes around him, he takes his life. And you know by experience, without understanding, that there are people you want to avoid, because meeting them you feel sick, meeting them you feel that something has been taken away from you. And there are people you want to meet, because meeting them you feel an expanding, you feel more alive.

Wilhelm Reich was right, but unfortunately the masses never accept their own geniuses; on the contrary, they condemn them, because if Wilhelm Reich is right, then everybody else is almost blind. And in anger he wrote the book, *Listen, Little Man*. But that book is beautiful, and his anger can be forgiven because he was mistreated by ‘the little man’, by the masses. He was first thought to be mad, then forced into a madhouse, and he died in a madhouse. In the East he would have become a Gautam Buddha. He had the quality, the insight. But a wrong society, a society of very little men, of very small people, small-minded, who cannot conceive the vast, who cannot conceive the mysterious...

The whole atmosphere is full of life. And if you understand your own sources of life you will be suddenly aware that birds are alive, trees are alive, grasses are alive – everywhere there is life! And you can dance with this life, you can start having a dialogue with the atmosphere. Of course, people will think you are mad, because people are still the same. The same people crucified Jesus, the same people forced Wilhelm Reich into a madhouse, the same people poisoned Socrates...but those little people are in the majority.

Wilhelm Reich's anger is right, but still I would say, rather than anger, the little man needs compassion. He was angry because they misbehaved with him, they destroyed his whole life. Rather than understanding him – he would have opened a new door to experiencing, to loving, to living – they destroyed the man completely. Obviously, he became angry.

In the East, the same little men are there, but the Eastern genius has never been angry with them. Rather than being angry it has shown compassion, it has felt compassion for their blindness, and it has tried in every way to bring light to them, a little understanding to their hearts.

When you approach any Eastern science with the Western mind you miss many things. Your whole approach is different: it is methodological, it is logical, analytical. And these Eastern sciences are not really sciences but arts. The whole thing depends on whether you can shift your energies from the intellect to the intuition, whether you can shift from male to female, from yang to yin; from the active, aggressive approach. Can you become passive, receptive? Only then do these things work; otherwise you can learn all about acupuncture, and it will not be acupuncture at all. You will know all *about* it, but not *it*. And sometimes it happens that a person may not know much about it and *knows* it, but then it is a knack – just an insight into it.

So this is happening to many Eastern things: the West becomes interested – they *are* profound. The West becomes interested in an Eastern thing, but

then it brings in its own mind to understand it. The moment the Western mind comes into it, the very base of it is destroyed. Then only fragments are left and those fragments never work. And it is not that acupuncture was not going to work, acupuncture *can* work, but it can work only with an Eastern approach.

So if you really want to learn acupuncture, for example, it is good to know about it but remember that is not the most essential thing. Learn whatsoever information is possible, then forget all the information and start groping in the dark. Start listening to your own unconscious, start feeling en rapport with the patient. It is different....

When a patient comes to a Western medical man, the Western medical man starts reasoning, diagnosing, analyzing, finding out where the illness is, what the illness is, and what can cure it. He uses one part of his mind, the rational part. He attacks the disease, he starts conquering it: a fight starts between the disease and the doctor. The patient is just out of the game – the doctor does not bother about the patient. He starts fighting with the disease – the patient is completely neglected.

When you come to an acupuncturist the disease is not important, the patient is important, because it is the patient who has created the disease: the cause is in the patient, the disease is only a symptom. You can change the symptom and another symptom will come up. You can force this disease by drugs, you can stop its expression, but then the disease will assert itself somewhere else and with more danger, more force, with a vengeance. The next disease will be more difficult to tackle than the first. You drug it too, then the third disease will be even more difficult.

That's how allopathy has created cancer. You go on forcing back the disease on one side, it asserts itself from another, then you force it on that side – the disease starts becoming very, very angry. And you don't change the patient, the patient remains the same; so because the cause exists, the cause goes on creating the effect.

Acupuncture deals with the cause. Never deal with the effect, always go to the cause. And how can you go to the cause? Reason cannot go to the cause – the cause is too big for the reason – it can only tackle the effect. Only meditation can go to the cause. So acupuncture will feel the patient. He will forget his knowledge, he will just try to get in tune with the patient. He will fall en rapport; he will start feeling a bridge with the patient. He will start feeling the disease of the patient in his own body, in his own energy system. That is the only way for him to know intuitively where the cause is, because the cause is hidden. He will become the mirror and he will find the reflection in himself.

This is the whole process of it, and this is not being taught because it cannot be taught. It is really worth going into, so my suggestion is first learn in the West for two years, then for at least six months go to some Far Eastern country and be with some acupuncturist. Just be in his presence – just let him work and you watch. Just absorb his energy, and then you will be able to do something; otherwise it will be difficult.

If you start feeling your own energy by and by, or the working of the energy in your own body, acupuncture will not remain just a technique, it will become an instrument. And it is an insight – you can learn the technique and nothing will come out of it – it is more a hunch than an art. That is one of the most difficult things about ancient techniques: they are not scientific, and if you approach them with a scientific outlook you may get some inkling but the major part will be missing. And whatsoever you will be able to get hold of will not be much, and it will be frustrating.

The whole ancient approach was totally different: it was not logical at all, it was more feminine, more intuitive, more illogical. One was not thinking in syllogism as the scientific mind thinks; rather, one was in a deep participation with existence – more in a sort of dreaming state, in a reverie, and allowing nature to release its secrets and mysteries. It was not aggression on nature...a persuasion at the most. And the approach is from the interior.

One has to approach one's own body from the interiormost core. Those seven hundred points were not known objectively, they were known in deep meditation. When one goes deep inside and looks from inside – a tremendous experience – one can see all the acupuncture points surrounding oneself, as if the night is full of stars. And when you have seen those energy points, then only are you ready. Now you have an inner grasp, and just by touching the body of the other person you will be able to feel where the body energy is missing and where it is not; where it is moving, where it is not moving; where it is cold and where it is warm; where it is alive and where it has gone dead. There are points at which it responds, and there are points at which it has no response at all.

You will be able to know acupuncture only to the extent that you become capable of knowing yourself, and when both coincide there is a great light. In that light you can see everything – not only about yourself, but about the bodies of others. A new vision arises as if a third eye had opened.

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5. THE FUNCTION OF THE HEALER

Medicine is not an ordinary profession. It is not just technology, because human beings are involved. You are not repairing mechanisms, it is not only a question of know-how, it is a deep question of love....

You are playing with human beings and their lives, and it is a complex phenomenon. Sometimes one can commit errors, and those errors can prove fatal to somebody's life. So go into it with deep prayer. Go with humanity, humbleness, simplicity.

People who simply go into medicine as if they are going into engineering are not the right people to be doctors and physicians – they are the wrong people. Those who never feel ambivalent are the wrong people. They will operate on human beings as a motor-mechanic does with a car. They will not feel the spiritual presence of the patient. They will not treat the person, they will treat the symptoms. Of course, they can be very certain; a technician is always certain. But when you are involved with human beings you cannot be so certain; hesitation is natural. One thinks twice, thrice, before doing anything, because a precious life is involved – life which we cannot produce, life which once gone is gone forever. And it is an individual who is irreplaceable, unique, the like of whom has never been there, and the like of whom there is going to be never again. You are playing with fire – hesitation is natural. Go into it with tremendous humbleness. Have a deep reverence for the patient. And while treating him, just become a vehicle of the divine energy. Don't be a doctor, simply become a vehicle of the divine healing energy – just instrumental. Let there be the patient – have great reverence for the patient, don't treat him like a thing – and let there be God, and with deep prayer allow God to flow through you and reach the patient. The patient is ill; he cannot connect with God. He has fallen far away. He has forgotten the very language of how to heal himself. He is in a desperate state. You cannot blame him; he is in a helpless state.

Somebody who is healthy can be of tremendous help if he becomes a vehicle. And if the healthy person is also a man who knows, it can be of more importance, because the divine energy can give you only very subtle hints – they have to be decoded by you. If you know medicine, you can decode them very easily. And then you are not doing anything to the patient, it is God who is doing it. You make yourself available to God and you make all your knowledge available. It is God's healing energy in conjunction with your knowledge that helps. And it never harms. *You* can be harmful. So drop yourself, let God be there. Go into medicine, and go on meditating.

Everybody can become a healer. Healing is something like breathing; it is natural. Somebody is ill; it means he has lost his capacity to heal himself. He is no longer aware of his own healing source. The healer is to help him to be rejoined. That source is the same from which the healer draws, but the ill man has forgotten how to understand the language of it. The healer is in relationship with the whole, so he can become a *via-media*. The healer touches the body of the ill person and becomes a link between him and the source. The patient is no longer connected directly with the source so he becomes indirectly connected. Once the energy starts flowing, he is healed.

And if the healer is really a man of understanding...because it is possible that you can become a healer and you may not be a man of understanding. There are many healers who go on doing it but they don't know how it happens; they don't know the mechanism of it. If you understand also, you can help the patient to be healed and you can help him to be aware of the source from where the healing is happening. So not only is he healed of his present illnesses, he is prevented from future illnesses. Then the healing is perfect. It is not only curative, it is also preventative.

Healing almost becomes an experience of prayer, an experience of God, of love, of the whole.

6. A TIME FOR CARING, A TIME FOR LOVE

It seems all religions are concerned with the sick, with the diseased, with the poor. Nobody is concerned with you and your riches and your greatness and your grandeur.

I say unto you: Unless you love yourself, unless you have found your own riches, your own heights, you will not be able to share your love with anybody. Certainly the sick and the diseased need care, but they don't need love. This has to be understood, because Christianity has made it almost a universally accepted truth – that it is the greatest religious thing, the most spiritual thing, to love the sick and the diseased. But it is absolutely against psychology and against nature. The moment you love the sick you are not helping him to recover from his sickness, because the moment he is healthy nobody loves him. Sickness is a good excuse for others to be provoked to love him.

You may have seen it, but you may not have thought about it. The wife is working the whole day, perfectly healthy, but as the husband comes home, looking from the window, she immediately goes to bed. She has a headache – because unless she has a headache the husband does not show any love. But if she has a headache, reluctantly the husband sits by her side, massages her head, shows some phony kind of love, talks sweet and beautiful words. For months he has not called her 'darling', but when the headache is there he has to call her 'darling'. And that's what she wants to hear, "I love you. And I love you not just today, I will love you forever."

It is strange that you show your love to your children when they are sick. But you don't understand a simple psychology of association – sickness and love become associated. Whenever the child needs your love he has to be sick. Who cares about the healthy child, who cares about the healthy wife,

who cares about the healthy husband? Love seems to be something like a medicine; it is needed only by the sick.

I want it to be clear to you – take care of the sick, but never show love. Taking care of the sick is a totally different thing.

Be indifferent, because a headache is not something great. Take care, but avoid your sweet nothings; take care in a very pragmatic way. Put the medicine on her head, but don't show love, because that is dangerous. When a child is sick, take care, but be absolutely indifferent. Make the child understand that by being sick he cannot blackmail you. The whole humanity is blackmailing each other. Sickness, oldness, disease have become almost demanding, "You have to love me because I'm sick, I'm old...."

When somebody is sick and you show love.... And that's the routine that humanity has followed. To the sick person you don't show anger, even if you are angry. To the sick person, even if you don't feel any love, you show love; if you cannot show love, at least sympathy. But these are dangerous, and very much against psychological findings....

You should love yourself without thinking whether you deserve it or not. You are alive – that is enough proof that you deserve love, just as you deserve breathing. You don't think whether you deserve breathing or not. Love is a subtle nourishment to the soul, just as food is to the body. And if you are full of love for yourself you will be able to love others. But love the healthy, love the strong.

Take care of the sick, take care of the old; but care is a totally different matter. The difference between love and care is the difference between a mother and a nurse. The nurse takes care, the mother loves. When the child is sick it is even better for the mother to just be a nurse. When the child is healthy, pour as much love as you can. Let love be associated with healthiness, strength, intelligence – that will help the child a long way in his life.

7. THE HEALING TOUCH

Massage is something that you can start learning but you never finish. It goes on and on, and the experience becomes continuously deeper and deeper, and higher and higher. Massage is one of the most subtle arts – and it is not only a question of expertise. It is more a question of love.

Learn the technique – then forget it. Then just feel, and move by feeling. When you learn deeply, ninety percent of the work is done by love, ten percent by the technique. By just the very touch, a loving touch, something relaxes in the body.

If you love and feel compassion for the other person, and feel the ultimate value of him; if you don't treat him as if he is a mechanism to be put right, but an energy of tremendous value; if you are grateful that he trusts you and allows you to play with his energy – then by and by you will feel as if you are playing on an organ. The whole body becomes the keys of the organ and you can feel that a harmony is created inside the body. Not only will the person be helped, but you also.

Massage is needed in the world because love has disappeared. Once the very touch of lovers was enough. A mother touched the child, played with his body, and it was massage. The husband played with the body of his woman and it was massage; it was enough, more than enough. It was deep relaxation and part of love. But that has disappeared from the world. By and by we have forgotten where to touch, how to touch, how deep to touch. In fact touch is one of the most forgotten languages. We have become almost awkward in touching, because the very word has been corrupted by so-called religious people. They have given it a sexual color. The word has become sexual and people have become afraid. Everybody is on guard not to be touched unless he allows it. Now in the West the other extreme has come. Touch and massage have become sexual. Now massage is just a

cover, a blanket, for sexuality. In fact neither touch nor massage are sexual. They are functions of love. When love falls from its height it becomes sex, and then it becomes ugly.

So be prayerful. When you touch the body of a person be prayerful – as if God himself is there, and you are just serving him. Flow with total energy. And whenever you see the body flowing and the energy creating a new pattern of harmony, you will feel a delight that you have never felt before. You will fall into deep meditation.

While massaging, just massage. Don't think of other things because those are distractions. Be in your fingers and your hands as if your whole being, your whole soul is there. Don't let it be just a touch of the body. Your whole soul enters into the body of the other, penetrates it, relaxes the deepest complexes. And make it a play. Don't do it as a job; make it a game and take it as fun. Laugh and let the other laugh too.

Massage is to come to a rapport with the of somebody else's body and to feel where it is missing, to feel where the body is fragmentary and to make it whole... to help the energy of the body so it is no longer fragmentary, no longer contradictory. When the energies of the body are falling into line and becoming an orchestra, then you succeed.

So be very respectful about a human body. It is the very shrine of God, the temple of God. So with deep reverence, prayer, learn your art. It is one of the greatest things to learn.

Just lay your hands on the needed part of the person. If the person has a headache, lay your hands on his head, close your eyes, start feeling energies pouring, and you will have a tingling sensation in the hands, they will become electrified. Or if the person has some trouble with the stomach, put your hands on the stomach. The needed part has to be touched. If it can be touched bare, without clothes, it is better, it will be more effective. But

don't touch the needed part for more than one minute. If you touch the needed part for more than one minute, then sometimes the disease can start flowing towards you.

Energy is a rhythm: one minute it goes outwards, another minute it comes inwards. So make it a point that when you put your hands on somebody's body, exhale; it synchronizes with inhalation, exhalation. When you put your hands on them, exhale, and go on exhaling; and when you see that you cannot exhale any more, take your hands off and then inhale. If you inhale while laying your hands on, you can be affected by the illness. The person may be healed but you will suffer, and that is meaningless. Just lay your hands with exhalation, and the moment inhalation starts, withdraw.

When you are healing a person, so much energy is pouring out that if you touch, it will be almost as if you are touching him with a live wire, a live electric wire. He will might become so afraid that his doors will close – and if the doors are closed, you can go on showering and nothing will happen. Healing is possible not only because of your energy – it is possible only when your energy enters the other person and becomes his energy. If it comes up to the door and returns, no healing happens.

That's why if a person does not trust you, never try healing – never try, because it is not possible. If a person has doubts about you, forget about him. It is possible only in deep trust, and if you try on persons who won't trust you, you will become unconfident about your own energy. If you fail many times, then by and by you will think, "Nothing is happening. I don't have the energy." In fact every person has the energy to heal. It is something natural. It is not that a few people are healers and others are not, no. Every person born is a healer but has forgotten the capacity, or has never used it, or has used it in wrong associations and has come to feel that it never works.

So never try it on somebody who challenges you. It is not a challenge. If somebody is ready to participate, to go with you, then it is a beautiful

experience. So in the beginning never touch. When the person is relaxing more and more and you feel... and I am saying *feel* – not that you think. If you feel an urge arises to touch the person – for example he has a stomachache or a headache or something and you feel that just touching the head will be helpful – then touch, but first let him get in tune with you. First just give an energy massage, not touching the body.

Keep about two inches' distance, because the person's body aura is about six inches away from his body. Keep about two, three inches away, so in a way you are touching his energy aura. You are not touching his or her physical body, but you are touching his subtle body – and that's enough. For the energy to penetrate, that's enough. You have really touched him, but he will not be afraid about that. When you feel that the person is participating tremendously, when his trust is immense and you can see that he is flowing with you, and you can feel that your energy is being absorbed – it is not rejected; he has become like a sponge and is soaking it up – then it becomes a pinpoint. On that point the whole energy showers and enters deepest.

After each healing it is better that if you can take a shower, do so. If it is not possible, then at least wash your hands immediately and shake them. It always happens that when you are passing your energy into the other person, his or her energy also sometimes passes into you; they overlap. Sometimes the person can be very strong, even stronger than you. Sometimes the person may not be strong, but his illness may be very strong, so those vibrations of illness can enter you and can be destructive. They can make you ill, tense. Healing is good but not at your own cost, because then it is foolish and you cannot heal much. Sooner or later you will become ill, badly ill, and your body will be confused very much.

Massage is not simply massage. You are sharing energy; and unless you have energy flowing in you, soon you will become tired. Then it is very risky. It is not physical tiredness that comes – that is not important; you will sleep, you will eat, and it will go. But massage is a deeper sharing of energy. When you are massaging somebody's body, not only are your

bodies involved – your subtle bodies, two energy bodies, two bio-plasmas. The person who is taking massage can take too much of your bio-plasma, and unless you are a constant inner supply, unless you are joined to the source, you will become very much dissipated by it. It may not immediately affect you because you are young. Even for months and years you may not feel it, but one day suddenly you will feel you are collapsed.

So my understanding is that first one should work upon oneself, and one should become very, very centered. When you are centered, *you* are not. When you are centered, the source starts functioning. Then you are just a passage. The cosmos starts flowing through you – then there is no problem. You can share as much energy as you want, and you will be constantly getting new energy, mm? Then you are not like a reservoir of water which has no springs to it. You are like a well which has many springs to it; you go on taking the water out and new water is flowing in – you cannot exhaust it. In fact you take the old, rotten, stale water out, and the fresh and alive water comes in. So the well is very happy – you are unburdening it from the past and the old and the stagnant. So if you are in a flow and your energy is flowering then there is no problem.

So massage and healing and these phenomena are very subtle. And it is not only a question of knowing the technique, the bigger question is how to be at the source – then there is no problem. Then I don't bother even about the technique and whether you know it or not. You can simply start playing with somebody's body and energy will be flowing, and there will be great benefits. But there is only real benefit when the person who is massaging is also benefited through it – then there is a real benefit. Then the healer is benefited, and the healee too – both are benefited. Nobody is at loss.

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8. MEDITATION AND PSYCHIATRY

No psychotherapy has the quality of meditation, because no psychotherapy has produced a single enlightened being. Their founders were not enlightened and the enlightened beings in the East never bothered about any psychotherapy. They have not even bothered about psychology or mind itself, because for them the question was not to solve the problems of the mind, for them the question was how to get out of the mind, which is easier. Then the problems are all finished, because once you are out of the mind, the mind has no nourishment to go on creating problems; otherwise it is an unending process. You get psychoanalyzed, whether old or new fashions it doesn't matter; they are just variations of the same theme. Your mind feels a little fresh and good after a psychological session because you have unburdened yourself. A little understanding of mind also comes – that keeps you normal.

In fact, all psychotherapies are in the service of the establishment; their function is not to let people go abnormal. Somebody is going outside the herd and the norms of the herd and doing things which it is not supposed that you should do.... They may be harmless but the society cannot tolerate such people. They have to be brought to the normal, to the average standard.

The psychotherapist's work is to clean your mind. It is a kind of lubricating your mechanism – it functions a little better and you start becoming a little more understanding about the functionings of the mind, although that does not make any revolutionary change. And it is possible you may solve one problem, but you have not removed the cause. Mind itself is the problem. So *you* can remove one problem, *mind* will create another problem.... It is just like pruning the trees: you prune one leaf and just out of self-respect and dignity the tree will grow three leaves in the place where there used to be one. That's why gardeners go on pruning; that gives trees more foliage, more leaves.

The same is the situation with the mind: you can remove one problem by understanding it – and it is costly – but the mind is still there which has created the problem, and psychoanalysis does not go beyond the boundaries of the mind. The mind will create a new problem, more complicated than the one that you have solved. Naturally, because the mind understands you can solve that kind of problem, it creates something new, more complicated, more foliage.

Meditation is a totally different thing than psychoanalysis or any therapies which are confined to the mind. It is simply a jumping out of the mind: “You have your problems – I’m going home.” Because mind is a parasite it does not have its own existence. It needs you inside in it, so it can go on eating you, your head. Once you jump out of it, the mind is just a graveyard. All those problems that were too big drop, they simply drop dead.

Meditation is a totally different dimension: you simply watch the mind and in watching you come out of it. And slowly, mind with all its problems disappears; otherwise the mind is going to create strange problems....

Mind is your only problem – all other problems are just offshoots of the mind. Meditation cuts the mind from the very roots. And all these therapies – Gestalt and Voice Dialogue and Fritz Perls – we can use them for those who have not yet entered into meditation just to have a little understanding of the mind so they can find the door from where to get out. We are using all kinds of therapies which are helpful, but not for the meditators. They are only helpful in the beginning when you have not yet become accustomed to meditation. Once you are meditative you don’t need any therapy, no therapy is helpful then. But in the beginning, it can be helpful, and particularly for the Western sannyasins....

Sigmund Freud is right only about the Western mind and its tradition. When he says that every girl hates her mother because she loves the father, the whole thing is based on their understanding of sex, that one loves the

opposite sex. So girls love the fathers, the boys love the mother. But the girls cannot express their love, particularly they cannot be sexually related with the father, and the mother is related sexually. So they become jealous of the mother – the mother is their enemy. The boys become enemies of the father and because of that the boy cannot make love to the mother. The Japanese cannot even think of this; even Indians cannot think of this – just a totally different upbringing. Sigmund Freud or Jung or Adler or Assagioli or Fritz Perls have no idea. Not even in their dreams have they thought that people can be different from the Western people....

In the East, psychoanalysis is not of much help. For the Westerners, I like them to go through groups just to clean the mind. With a clean mind, to enter into meditation is easier. But if you don't enter meditation and you simply depend on cleaning the mind, then you will be cleaning the mind for your whole life and you will not go anywhere else. Because of its different orientation the East should find seats in the universities for meditation, not for psychoanalysis....

In the East for centuries the problem has been how to get beyond the mind – the only problem, the single problem. But for the Western mind, because it has developed in a different way it has never thought about transcending mind. I have looked into Jewish sources, into Christian sources; there is not a single statement in the whole history of the West where somebody has made an effort to go beyond the mind. They have used the mind to pray, they have used the mind to believe in God; they have used the mind to become religious, virtuous, but they have never even thought that there is a possibility of going beyond the mind.

In the East that has been the only, single search. The whole genius of the East has been working for one thing, no other problems: how to go beyond the mind, because if you can solve your problems wholesale just by going beyond, then why go for retail solving of problems? The mind will go on creating; it is a very creative force. You solve one problem, another problem arises. You solve that problem, another problem arises. It is a good business for the psychoanalyst, because he knows you are never going to be cured.

You are not going to be cured of the mind; he cures your specific problems. Your mind is there, the source. He never cuts the roots, he only cuts leaves, branches at the most, but they go on growing again – the roots are there.

Meditation is cutting the very roots of problems. I repeat: the mind is the only problem, and unless you go beyond the mind, you will never go beyond problems. It is strange that even today, the Western psychologists have not even pondered over the fact that the East has created so many enlightened people. None of them has bothered about the analysis of the mind.... Hundreds of methods have been found which can help you to transcend the mind, and once you are beyond the mind all its problems look as if they are somebody else's problems. You attain to a state of a watcher on the hills, and all the problems are in the valleys. And they don't have any impact on you; you have gone beyond them.

The West has remained utterly mind-centered. In the West the only thing they have thought about is matter and mind. And matter is the reality and mind is only a by-product; beyond mind there is nothing. In the East matter is illusory, mind is a by-product of all your illusions, projections, dreams. Your reality is beyond matter and mind, both. So we divide reality in the East into three parts: matter, the outermost; the soul, the innermost; the mind is in between the two. Matter has a relative reality; it is not absolutely real, just relatively real. The mind is absolutely unreal, and the soul is absolutely real.

This is a totally different categorization of humanity. In the West the categories are simple: matter is real, mind is just a by-product, and there is nothing beyond mind. So remember, if you are meditating then nothing else is needed. If you are not meditating, then these psychotherapies may be helpful as a stepping stone for meditation.... The West is being exploited by all kinds of frauds for the simple reason that the West has not looked into the matter of meditation itself. So any idiot goes and says anything, and gathers followers because they don't know what meditation is. Neither will chanting a mantra nor hopping nor levitation.... These things have nothing to do with meditation. Meditation has only one meaning, and that is going

beyond the mind and becoming a witness. In your witnessing is the miracle – the whole mystery of life.

? In Newsweek I read a joke within an article on so-called quick-fix therapy. A middle-aged man had been the despair of his family for years because of his compulsive habits of tearing papers to bits and scattering the pieces all over the ground wherever he went. His family dragged him to famous Freudians, Jungians, and Adlerians at great expense but with frustrating results. Trying to shed light into the dismal abyss of his unconscious, where the habit must have its home, failed.

Finally his relatives took him to an obscure but innovative new psychotherapist. This magician took a little walk with his new patient up and down his office, whispering something in his ear. Then he declared to the surprised family, “You can take him home; he’s cured.”

A year later the habit hadn’t returned and the grateful family asked the doctor what he had told his patient. He said, shrugging his shoulders, “Don’t tear paper.” Would you like to comment?

The secrets of life are very simple, but the mind tries to make them complex. Mind loves complexity, for the simple reason that mind is needed only if there is something complex. If there is nothing complex, the very necessity for mind’s existence disappears. Mind does not want to let go of his mastery over you. He is only a servant but he has managed to become the master, and things have become upside down in your life.

The joke simply indicates a very obvious fact. The man was tearing up bits of paper and throwing them all over; naturally everybody thought something has gone wrong: he needs psychoanalysis, he needs some great person who understands the ways of the mind so that he can be fixed up. Nobody even bothered to tell him, “Don’t do this.”

It was obvious that the man was getting insane, so they went to the Freudians, the Adlerians, the Jungians, to great psychoanalysts. And all those psychoanalysts must have worked hard, for hours, for years, analyzing the dreams of the man to find out why he tears up bits of paper and throws them all over the place. But nobody succeeded. As a last resort they took him to a magician, and he cured the man.

But *Newsweek* is a snobbish magazine, so the joke is not complete. That's why you don't see what is so great about the joke.

The magician walked up and down the staircase and then whispered in the ear of the man, "You stop tearing papers; otherwise I will kick you down from the top." And he was a strong man. "So take heed, because I don't believe in psychoanalysis or anything, I simply believe in kicking. And I kick people from this place. Then they go rolling down hundreds of steps to the road. Now you can go home; just remember that I have only one trick. When any kind of mentally sick person is brought to me, I cure him. That's why I have been walking with you up and down these steps, to show you what it means when I kick you. So now just go home and remember it. Next time I will not say anything, I will simply do it." And the man understood it; anybody would have understood it.

They have left that part out of the joke and destroyed the beauty of it. That man must have been enjoying just a childish thing, tearing papers into bits, into pieces, and throwing them all over the place. And it became an enjoyment because everybody was puzzled. It was simply a childish phenomenon. The man was retarded; he did not need any psychoanalysis. He needed a good kick – that was the language that he understood immediately.

In many ways we go on thinking about simple things in complex ways. Our problems are mostly very simple, but the mind confuses you. And there are people to exploit you. They make your problem even more complex.

Once a boy was brought to me. He must have been sixteen or seventeen years old, and his family was puzzled, harassed, although there was no need for anybody to be harassed. The boy went on saying that two flies have entered into his belly, and they go on moving around inside his body – now they are in the head, now they have come in the hand.

He was taken to doctors, physicians, and they said, “It is not a disease.” He was X-rayed, and there were no flies or anything. They tried saying, “You don’t have any flies.”

But he said, “How can I believe you? They are moving all around inside my body. Should I believe my experience or your explanation?”

Just by chance somebody suggested me to the parents, so they brought the boy. I heard the whole story. The boy was looking very reluctant, stubborn, because he was getting tired of this doctor, that doctor, and they all were saying, “There are no flies.”

I said, “You have brought him to the right man. I can see the flies. The poor boy is suffering, and you have been telling him that he is stupid.” The boy relaxed. I was favorable – for the first time, a man who has accepted his idea of the flies.

I said, “I know how they have entered. He must be sleeping with an open mouth.”

The boy said, “Yes.”

I said, “It is such a simple thing. When you sleep with an open mouth, anything can enter. You are fortunate that only flies have entered. I have seen people...rats have entered...”

He said, “My God, rats?”

I said, “Not only rats, but behind rats, cats also.”

He said, “Those people must be in great trouble.”

I said, “They are. You are nothing, your case is very simple – just two flies. You just lie down here, and I will take them out.”

He said, “You are the first man who has shown understanding to a poor boy. Nobody listens to me. I am insistently saying that they are there. I show them the place...they are here, now they have moved here...and they all laugh, and they make me look foolish.”

I said, “They are all fools. They have not come across such cases, but this is my special expertise. I deal only with people who sleep with an open mouth.”

He said, “I know you understand, because immediately you recognized that they are there – exactly where they were.”

I told his parents to stay out of the house and leave him for fifteen minutes with me. I told him to lie down. I blindfolded his eyes and told him to keep his mouth open.

But he said, “If more flies go in...?”

I said, “You don’t be worried; this is air-conditioned, and there are no flies. You just lie down with your mouth open and I will try and persuade the flies to come out.”

I left him there and ran around the house to catch two flies somehow – for the first time, because I had never done that. But somehow I managed, and I brought two flies in a small bottle. And while I was keeping the bottle on his mouth I removed his blindfold and said, “Look!”

He said, “These two small flies...but what a turmoil they were creating! My whole life was ruined. Now can you give me these flies?”

I said, “I can, yes.” I closed the bottle and gave it to him.

I asked him, “What are you going to do?”

He said, “I am going to go to all those doctors and physicians who have been taking fees and doing nothing and just telling me, ‘There are no flies.’ Anybody who has told me that...I am going to show them that these are the flies.”

He was cured. His mind just got stuck with an idea. But if you go to the psychoanalyst, he will make a mountain out of a molehill – so many theories, explanations...and it takes years and still the problem will remain, because the problem has not been touched. He has been philosophizing about it and he is trying his philosophy on this poor patient.

But most of the diseases of the mind – and seventy percent of diseases are of the mind – can be easily cured. The most basic thing is to accept; don’t deny, because your denial is against the pride of the man. The more you deny, the more he is going to insist: it is a simple logic. You are denying his understanding, you are denying his feeling, you are denying his humanity, his dignity. You are saying, “You don’t know anything” – about his own body!

The first step is to accept: “You are right. Those who have denied you were wrong.” And immediately half of the ground is covered. Now there is a sympathetic relationship with the person. Those who suffer from any mental sickness need sympathy; they need approval, not denial. They don’t want you to reduce them to a mad, insane person. Just give them sympathy, give them understanding, be loving.

Let them come close to you and then find a simple way. Don’t go roundabout with Freudian scriptures – they are almost holy scriptures, and

the literature of psychoanalysis goes on increasing, goes on becoming bigger and bigger. And you start trying all those ideas on the poor man, and he has nothing much.

My own understanding is that every man needs love, and every man also needs to love. Every man needs friendship, friendliness, sympathy – and every man wants to give it, too.

I am reminded: it happened when George Bernard Shaw was almost eighty years old. His doctor was ninety years old – his personal physician – and both were great friends.

Once in the middle of the night Bernard Shaw felt a sudden pain in the heart, and he became afraid: perhaps it was a heart attack. He phoned the doctor and said, “Come immediately because I may not see the sunrise again.”

The doctor said, “Hold on. I am coming, don’t be worried.” The doctor came. He had to come up three flights of stairs – a ninety-year-old man carrying his own bag, perspiring.

He came and put his bag on the floor and sat in the chair and closed his eyes. Bernard Shaw asked, “What is the matter?” The doctor put his hand on his heart, and Bernard Shaw said, “My God, you have got a heart attack!” And he could see...a ninety-year-old man, three flights of stairs, in the middle of the night, and he was perspiring.

Bernard Shaw got up, started waving a fan, washing his face with cold water, gave him some brandy to drink because the night was cold, and tried in every way...covered him with blankets and completely forgot about his own heart attack, for which the doctor was called.

After half an hour the doctor was feeling better and he said, “Now I am okay. This was a great heart attack. This has happened for the third time and

I was thinking this is the last, but you helped me immensely. Now give me my fees.”

Bernard Shaw said, “Your fees? – and I have been running and bringing things and serving you. You should give me fees.”

The doctor said, “Nonsense. This was all acting. I do it with every heart patient – and it always works. They forget their heart attack and they start looking after me – a ninety-year-old man. You just give me my fees. Half the night has passed and I have to go home” – and he took his fee.

And Bernard Shaw said, “This is something. I used to think that I am a joker, but this doctor is a practical joker. He really treated me.” He tried his heart, it was perfectly okay. He had completely forgotten it. It was just a small pain that his mind had multiplied...his fear of heart attack, the idea of heart attack, the idea of death became magnified.

But the doctor was really good. He got Bernard Shaw up, got all the services, had a good drink, and finally took his fees and walked down the stairs. And Bernard Shaw simply looked completely mystified. “This man says that he has been doing this with every heart case, and he has always been successful. Just because of his age he manages beautifully. Anybody will forget.... Any other doctor would start making it a complex phenomenon, with injections and medicines and rest, or a change of climate, or a twenty-four-hour nurse. But that man did it quick, fast, without any complexity.”

I have seen all kinds of cases concerned with the mind. All that they need is a very sympathetic, friendly, loving approach, and in every case a unique treatment – because whatever has been done to the man is ordinary, common, and slowly, slowly the patient starts feeling that he has been successful in defeating all kinds of doctors – allopathic, homeopathic, naturopathic, ayurvedic, acupuncturists, acupressurists – all kinds of people, and yet nobody can cure him. He starts having a certain ego about it, that

his sickness is something very special. He wants it to be accepted as special. It is a substitute.

This has to be understood: everybody wants to be special, extraordinary – a great musician, a great dancer, a great poet – but everybody cannot manage. It needs a long, arduous discipline to become a great musician....

Everybody seems to be closed. Nobody's heart is with open windows. And nobody's doors are open to welcome a guest. This whole situation creates strange things. The real needs of the human mind are not fulfilled; it starts behaving strangely.

Perhaps that was the only cause of that man tearing up papers and throwing bits here and there – just to make it known, “I am here, and I am different from everybody else. I am doing something that nobody else does.” Perhaps he was not accepted, not received, not loved. And the cure that he got is worse than the disease. That was really the disease – that nobody loved him – and now the magician gives him the cure: “If you do it again I will give you such a kick that you will roll down all these hundred stairs, and at the end you may just burst into pieces on the road.” But he stopped doing it – that shows that rather than getting love, he got more fear. Fear can also change your behavior, but it is not a change for the better, it is a change for the worse. And while love is available – and it costs nothing – why not use it?

I don't see that there is any other psychotherapy than love. If the psychotherapist can shower his love, the disease will disappear without any analysis.

All analysis is just bunk. The psychotherapist is avoiding love himself. He is avoiding seeing the patient face to face. He is afraid to recognize the reality. All psychoanalysts of the Freudian camp, which is the biggest camp and the most important, don't sit in front of the patient. The patient lies down on a couch, and behind the couch sits the psychoanalyst. The patient talks, lying down on the couch, to no one, and the psychoanalyst is just

sitting there. No human touch – he cannot even hold the hand of the patient, he cannot look in the eyes of the patient.

In the East nothing like psychoanalysis has ever happened for the simple reason that there were thousands of masters, deep in meditation, and anybody who came to them...just their love, their sympathy, the way they looked into the eyes of the patient was enough. People were cured. It was not that without psychoanalysis.... In the East, what happened to neurotics, to psychotics, was that they were instantly changed. All that they needed was an immense love which asks nothing – a man of peace and silence, whose very presence is medicine. A man who has meditated for a long time becomes an immense source. He radiates something that is not visible to the eyes, but the heart catches it. Something reaches to your innermost being and changes you.

Problems are simple. Solutions are simple. Just one has to get out of the mind to see the simplicity. And then whatsoever is done by a man in silence, in peace, in joy, will be medicinal, will be distributing health. It will be a healing force.

A psychiatrist needs to be meditative more than anybody else – because your whole work is dangerous in a way. Unless you are very calm and quiet, unless you can remain unaffected by things that happen around you, it is very dangerous. More psychiatrists go mad than any other professional people, and more psychiatrists commit suicide than any other professional people. This is something to be pondered over. The proportion is really too much! Twice as many commit suicide. That simply shows that the profession is full of dangers. It is – because whenever you are treating a person who is psychologically disturbed, in a mess, he is constantly broadcasting his vibes. He is constantly throwing out his own energy, his negative waves upon you, and you have to listen to him. You have to be very attentive. You have to care, you have to love and be compassionate towards him; only then can you help him. He is constantly throwing

negative-charged energy – and you are absorbing it. In fact the more attentively you listen, the more you absorb it.

Living continuously with neurotic and psychotic people, you start thinking, in an unconscious way, that this is what humanity is. We become by and by like the people we live with, because nobody is an island. So if you are working with sad people, you will become sad. If you are working with happy people, you will become happy, because everything is infectious. Neurosis is infectious; suicide also is infectious.

If you live around people who are enlightened, very aware, then something in you starts responding to this higher possibility. When you live with people who are very low, abnormally low, in a perverted state, then something morbid in you starts corresponding and relating to them. So to be continuously surrounded by ill people is in a way dangerous, unless you protect yourself. And there is nothing like meditation to give you protection. Then you can give more than you are giving and yet you will remain unaffected. You can help more than you are helping, because the higher your energy, the more is the possibility to help. Otherwise the psychiatrist, the healer and the healee are almost on the same ground; maybe a little difference of degrees, but the difference is so small that it is not worth considering.

The psychiatrist can go into madness very easily – just a slight push, some accidental thing, and he can move into the condemned territory. People who are neurotic were not always neurotic. Just two days ago they were normal people, and again they can become normal. So normality and abnormality are not qualitative distinctions, just quantitative: ninety-nine degrees, one hundred degrees, one hundred and one degrees – that type of difference.

In fact, in a better world, every psychiatrist should be trained deeply in meditation, otherwise he should not be allowed to practice. That is the only way that you can protect yourself and not be vulnerable – and you can really help. Otherwise even great psychiatrists, great psychoanalysts, even they become in a way very hopeless about humanity...even Freud. After a

whole life's experience he finally said that he could not hope for man; he felt hopeless. And it is natural – forty years of being with people who are in a mess; the only experience of humanity being of people who are mad. By and by it started to look to him as if abnormality is normal... as if man is bound to remain neurotic, as if there is something natural in man which drives him towards neurosis.

So at the most the healthy person is one who is a little more adjusted to the world, that's all. Adjustment becomes the standard of health. But it cannot be. If the whole society is mad you can be adjusted to it and you will still be mad. In fact in a mad society, a person who is not mad will be maladjusted. And that's what is really the case.

When a Jesus walks in this world he is maladjusted. We have to crucify him. He is such a stranger – we cannot tolerate him. We are not concerned with him, we are simply concerned with ourselves. Because of his presence, only two things are possible – either he is mad or we are mad. Both cannot be healthy. We are many and he is alone. Of course we will kill him; he cannot kill us. When a Buddha walks, he looks strange – a healthy man, a really natural, normal man, moving in an abnormal society.

So Freud came to conclude that there is no future for humanity. At the most we can hope that man can be adjusted with the social pattern, that's all. But there is no possibility for man to be blissful. There cannot be, by the very nature of things. Why such a pessimistic conclusion ? – because of his whole experience.

Freud's whole life is a long nightmare of mad people, of working with them. And by and by he himself became abnormal. He was not really healthy. He was not a blissful person. He had never known what wholeness is. He was afraid of small things – so much so that it looks absurd. He was afraid of death. If somebody talked about ghosts, he would start perspiring. Twice he fainted because somebody started talking about death! This seems to be a very unbalanced mind, but in a way it can be accounted for. Even this is a miracle – that he remained sane for his whole life.

One of the most penetrating psychiatrists, Wilhelm Reich, went mad. And the only reason that he went and others have not, was because he was really penetrating. He had a really deep talent to go into the roots of things – but it is dangerous. Freud or Reich or others' whole lives show one thing – that had they been trained in deep meditation, the whole world would have been different. Then these neurotic people would not become the standard.

Maybe it is very difficult to become a buddha, but he is the norm. And a normal person is one who comes closer to the norm. It has nothing to do with adjustment. One comes closer to the idea of wholeness, happiness, health.

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9. RESPECT FOR THE BODY

Respect your body the same way as you respect your soul. Your body is as sacred as your soul is. In existence everything is sacred because the whole thing is throbbing with the heartbeat of the divine....

You are moving moment to moment, from one stage of consciousness to another stage of consciousness. The body may be fast asleep, but it is also conscious. You know if you are asleep and a mosquito starts disturbing you, you remain asleep and your hand removes the mosquito.... The body has its own consciousness.

The scientists say the body has millions and millions of living cells; each cell has its own life. You have lost the capacity of wonder; otherwise you would wonder first about your own body, how the body turns the bread into blood. We have not been able to find a factory yet where bread can be turned into blood. And not only that, it sorts out what is needed and what is not needed by your body; that which is not needed is thrown out, and that which is needed is needed for different functions.

The body goes on supplying different places, different parts of your body, whatever their need is. You eat the same food for all your needs; out of the same food your bones are made, your blood is made, your skin is made, your eyes are made, your brain is made; and the body knows perfectly well what is needed and where it is needed. The blood is circulating continuously, supplying particular chemicals to particular parts.

Not only that, the body also knows the priority. The first priority is your brain – hence, if there is not enough oxygen, first the body will give the oxygen to the brain. The other parts are tougher and they can wait a little, but the brain cells are not so tough. If they don't get oxygen for six minutes they will die, and once they are dead they cannot be revived.

It is a tremendous work of intelligence to be alert about the different functions. When you have a wound, then the body stops supplying certain parts which can survive, but first the wound has to be healed. Immediately the white cells of the body rush towards the wound to cover it so it is not open. And then inside, the work, the very subtle work, continues.

Medical science knows that we are not yet as wise as the body is. The most prominent physicians have said that we cannot cure the body; the body cures itself – we can only help. At the most our medicines can be of some help, but the basic cure comes from the body itself. It is a wonder how it is being done. It is such a vast work.

I have come to know from one scientist friend, who has been working on the functions of the body, that if we want to do all those functions we will need almost one square mile of factory with many complicated mechanisms, computers. Then, too, we are not certain that we will succeed – and your religions have been condemning the body and telling you that to take care of the body is irreligious....

First, inside become one with your body, then become one with the whole existence. The day your heartbeat has a synchronicity with the universe and its heartbeat you have found religion – not before it.

For centuries man has been told all kinds of life-negative things. Even to torture your body has been a spiritual discipline....

You walk, you eat, you drink, and all these things indicate that you are a body and a consciousness as an organic whole. You cannot torture the body and raise your consciousness. The body has to be loved – you have to be a great friend. It is your home, you have to clean it of all junk, and you have to remember that it is in your service continuously, day in, day out. Even when you are asleep, your body is continuously working for you digesting,

changing your food into blood, taking out the dead cells from the body, bringing new oxygen, fresh oxygen into the body – and you are fast asleep!

It is doing everything for your survival, for your life, although you are so ungrateful that you have never even thanked your body. On the contrary, your religions have been teaching you to torture it: the body is your enemy and you have to get free from the body, its attachments. I also know that you are more than the body and there is no need to have any attachment. But love is not an attachment, compassion is not an attachment. Love and compassion are absolutely needed for your body and its nourishment. And the better body you have, the more is the possibility for growing consciousness. It is an organic unity.

A totally new kind of education is needed in the world where fundamentally everybody is introduced into the silences of the heart – in other words into meditations – where everybody has to be prepared to be compassionate to one's own body, because unless you are compassionate to your own body, you cannot be compassionate to any other body. It is a living organism, and it has done no harm to you. It has been continuously in service since you were conceived and will be till your death. It will do everything that you would like to do, even the impossible, and it will not be disobedient to you.

It is inconceivable to create such a mechanism which is so obedient and so wise. If you become aware of all the functions of your body, you will be surprised. You have never thought what your body has been doing. It is so miraculous, so mysterious – but you have never looked into it. You have never bothered to be acquainted with your own body and you pretend to love other people. You cannot, because those other people also appear to you as bodies.

The body is the greatest mystery in the whole of existence. This mystery needs to be loved – its mysteries, its functionings to be intimately inquired into.

The religions have unfortunately been absolutely against the body. But it gives a clue, a definite indication that if a man learns the wisdom of the body and the mystery of the body, he will never bother about the priest or about God. He will have found the most mysterious within himself, and within the mystery of the body is the very shrine of your consciousness.

Once you have become aware of your consciousness, of your being, there is no God above you. Only such a person can be respectful towards other human beings, other living beings, because they all are as mysterious as he himself is ... different expressions, varieties which make life richer. And once a man has found consciousness in himself, he has found the key to the ultimate. Any education that does not teach you to love your body, does not teach you to be compassionate to your body, does not teach you how to enter into its mysteries, will not be able to teach you how to enter into your own consciousness.

The body is the door – the body is the stepping stone. And any education that does not touch the subject of your body and consciousness is not only absolutely incomplete, it is utterly harmful because it will go on being destructive. It is only the flowering of consciousness within you that prevents you from destruction. And that gives you a tremendous urge to create – to create more beauty in the world, to create more comfort in the world....

Man needs a better body, a healthier body. Man needs a more conscious, alert being. Man needs all kinds of comforts and luxuries that existence is ready to deliver. Existence is ready to give you paradise herenow, but you go on postponing it – it is always after death.

In Sri Lanka one great mystic was dying.... He was worshipped by thousands of people. They gathered around him. He opened his eyes: just a few more breaths would he take on the shore and he would be gone, and gone forever. Everybody was eager to listen to his last words. The old man said, “I have been teaching you for my whole life about blissfulness, ecstasy, meditateness. Now I am going to the other shore – I will not be

available anymore. You have listened to me, but you have never practiced what I have been telling you. You have always been postponing. But now there is no point in postponing, I am going. Is anyone ready to go with me?"

There was a great pindrop silence. People looked at each other thinking that perhaps this man who had been a disciple for forty years, *he* may be ready.... But he was looking at the others – nobody was standing up. Just from the very back a man raised his hand. The great mystic thought, "At least, one person is courageous enough."

But that man said, "Please let me make it clear to you why I am not standing up. I have only raised my hand. I want to know how to reach to the other shore, because today of course I am not ready. There are many things which are incomplete: a guest has come, my young son is getting married, and this day I cannot go – and you say from the other shore, you cannot come back. Some day, one day certainly, I will come and meet you. If you can just explain to us once more – although you have been explaining to us for your whole life – just once more how to reach the other shore? But please keep in mind that I am not ready to go right now. I just want to refresh my memory so that when the right time comes...."

That right time never comes. It is not only a story about that poor man, it is the story of millions of people, of almost all. They are all waiting for the right moment, the right constellation of stars.... They are consulting astrology, going to the palmist...inquiring in different ways what is going to happen tomorrow. Tomorrow does not happen – it never has happened. It is simply a stupid strategy of postponement. What happens is always today.

A right kind of education will teach people to live herenow, to create a paradise of this earth, not to wait for death to come, and not to wait for death to come, and not to be miserable till death stops your misery. Let death find you dancing and joyous and loving. It is a strange experience that if a man can live his life as if he is *already* in paradise, death cannot take away anything from that man's experience.

My approach is to teach you that this is the paradise, there is no paradise anywhere else, and no preparation is needed to be happy. No discipline is needed to be loving; just a little alertness, just a little wakefulness, just a little understanding.

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10. THE ROOTS OF TENSION

Bodily tension has been created by those who, in the name of religion, have been preaching anti-body attitudes. In the West, Christianity has been emphatically antagonistic toward the body. A false division, a gulf, has been created between you and your body; then your total attitude becomes tension creating. You cannot eat in a relaxed way, you cannot sleep in a relaxed way; every bodily act becomes a tension. The body is the enemy, but you cannot exist without it. You must remain with it, you must live with your enemy, so there is constant tension; you can never relax.

Body is not your enemy, nor is it in any way unfriendly or even indifferent to you. The very existence of the body is bliss. And the moment you take the body as a gift, as a divine gift, you will come back to the body. You will love it, you will feel it--and subtle are the ways of its feeling.

You cannot feel another's body if you have not felt your own, you cannot love another's body if you have not loved your own; it is impossible. You cannot care for another person's body if you have not cared for your own--and no one cares! You may say that you care, but I insist: no one cares. Even if you seem to care, you do not really care. You are caring for some other reason--for the opinion of others, for the look in someone else's eyes; you never care for your body for yourself. You do not love your body, and if you cannot love it, you cannot be in it.

Love your body and you will feel a relaxation such as you have never felt before. Love is relaxing. When there is love, there is relaxation. If you love someone--if, between you and him or you and her, there is love--then with love comes the music of relaxation. Then relaxation is there.

When you are relaxed with someone, that is the only sign of love. If you cannot be relaxed with someone, you are not in love; the other, the enemy,

is always there. That is why Sartre has said, "The other is hell." Hell is there for Sartre, it is bound to be. When there is no love flowing between the two, the other is hell, but if there is love flowing in between, the other is heaven. So whether the other is heaven or hell depends on whether there is love flowing in between.

Whenever you are in love, a silence comes. Language is lost; words become meaningless. You have much to say and nothing to say at the same time. The silence will envelop you, and in that silence, love flowers. You are relaxed. There is no future in love, there is no past; only when love has died is there a past. You only remember a dead love, a living love is never remembered; it is living, there is no gap to remember it; there is no space to remember it. Love is in the present; there is no future and no past.

If you love someone, you do not have to pretend. Then you can be what you are. You can put off your mask and be relaxed. When you are not in love, you have to wear a mask. You are tense every moment because the other is there; you have to pretend, you have to be on guard. You have to be either aggressive or defensive: it is a fight, a battle--you cannot be relaxed.

The bliss of love is more or less the bliss of relaxation. You feel relaxed, you can be what you are, you can be nude in a sense, as you are. You need not be bothered about yourself, you need not pretend. You can be open, vulnerable, and in that opening, you are relaxed.

This same phenomenon happens if you love your body; you become relaxed, you care about it. It is not wrong, it is not narcissistic to be in love with your own body. In fact, it is the first step toward spirituality.

The original source of all tension is becoming. One is always trying to be something; no one is at ease with himself as he is. The being is not accepted, the being is denied, and something else is taken as an ideal to become. So the basic tension is always between that which you are and that which you long to become.

You desire to become something. Tension means that you are not pleased with what you are, and you long to be what you are not. Tension is created between these two. What you desire to become is irrelevant. If you want to become wealthy, famous, powerful, or even if you want to be free, liberated, to be divine, immortal, even if you long for salvation, *moksha*, then too the tension will be there.

Anything that is desired as something to be fulfilled in the future, against you *as you are*, creates tension. The more impossible the ideal is, the more tension there is bound to be. So a person who is a materialist is ordinarily not so tense as one who is religious, because the religious person is longing for the impossible, for the far-off. The distance is so great that only a great tension can fill the gap.

Tension means a gap between what you are and what you want to be. If the gap is great, the tension will be great. If the gap is small, the tension will be small. And if there is no gap at all, it means you are satisfied with what you are. In other words, you do not long to be anything other than what you are. Then your mind exists in the moment. There is nothing to be tense about; you are at ease with yourself. To me, if there is no gap you are religious.

The gap can have many layers. If the longing is physical, the tension will be physical. When you seek a particular body, a particular shape – if you long for something other than what you are on a physical level – then there is tension in your physical body. One wants to be more beautiful. Now your body becomes tense. This tension begins at your first body, the physiological, but if it is insistent, constant, it may go deeper and spread to the other layers of your being.

If you are longing for psychic powers, then the tension begins at the psychic level and spreads. The spreading is just like when you throw a stone in the lake. It drops at a particular point, but the vibrations created by it will go on spreading into the infinite. So tension may start from any one of your seven

bodies, but the original source is always the same: the gap between a state that is and a state that is longed for.

If you have a particular type of mind and you want to change it, transform it – if you want to be more clever, more intelligent – then tension is created. Only if we accept ourselves totally is there no tension. This total acceptance is the miracle, the only miracle. To find a person who has accepted himself totally is the only surprising thing.

Existence itself is non-tense. Tension is always because of hypothetical, non-existential possibilities. In the present there is no tension; tension is always future-oriented. It comes from the imagination. You can imagine yourself as something other than you are. This potential that has been imagined will create tension. So the more imaginative a person is, the more tension is a possibility. Then the imagination has become destructive.

Imagination can also become constructive, creative. If your whole capacity to imagine is focused in the present, in the moment, not in the future, then you can begin to see your existence as poetry. Your imagination is not creating a longing; it is being used in living. This living in the present is beyond tension.

Animals are not tense, trees are not tense, because they do not have the capacity to imagine. They are below tension, not beyond it. Their tension is just a potentiality; it has not become actual. They are evolving. A moment will come when tension will explode in their beings and they will begin to long for the future. It is bound to happen. The imagination becomes active.

The first thing the imagination becomes active about is the future. You create images, and because there are no corresponding realities you go on creating more and more images. But as far as the present is concerned, you cannot ordinarily conceive of the imagination in relation to it. How can you be imaginative in the present? There seems to be no need. This point must be understood.

If you can be consciously present in the present, you will not be living in your imagination. Then the imagination will be free to create within the present itself. Only the right focus is needed. If the imagination is focused on the real, it begins to create. The creation may take any form. If you are a poet, it becomes an explosion of poetry. The poetry will not be a longing for the future, but an expression of the present. Or if you are a painter, the explosion will be of painting. The painting will not be of something as you have imagined it, but as you have known it and lived it.

When you are not living in the imagination, the present moment is given to you. You can express it, or you can go into silence.

But the silence, now, is not a dead silence that is practiced. This silence too is an expression of the present moment. The moment is so deep that now it can be expressed only through silence. Not even poetry is adequate; painting is not adequate. No expression is possible. Silence is the only expression. This silence is not something negative but, rather, a positive flowering. Something has flowered within you, the flower of silence, and through this silence all that you are living is expressed.

A second point is also to be understood. This expression of the present through the imagination is neither an imagination of the future nor a reaction against the past. It is not an expression of any experience that has been known. It is the experience of experiencing – as you are living it, as it is happening in you. Not a lived experience, but a living process of experiencing.

Then your experience and experiencing are not two things. They are one and the same. Then there is no painter. The experiencing itself has become the painting; the experiencing itself has expressed itself. You are not a creator. You are creativity, a living energy. You are not a poet; you are poetry. The experience is neither for the future nor for the past; it is neither from the future nor from the past. The moment itself has become eternity, and everything comes from it. It is a flowering....

If you can feel this non-tense moment in your body, you will know a well-being that you have not known before, a positive well-being.... Your body can be non-tense only when you are living a moment-to-moment existence. If you are eating and the moment has become eternity, then there is no past and no future. The very process of eating is all that is. You are not doing something; you have become the doing. There will be no tension; your body will feel fulfilled. Or if you are in sexual communion and the sex is not just a relief from sexual tension but, rather, a positive expression of love – if the moment has become total, whole, and you are in it completely – then you will know a positive well-being in your body.

If you are running, and the running has become the totality of your existence; if you *are* the sensations that are coming to you, not something apart from them but one with them; if there is no future, no goal to this running, running itself is the goal – then you know a positive well-being. Then your body is non-tense. On the physiological level, you have known a moment of non-tense living.

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11. KEYS FOR RELAXATION

The whole society is geared for work. It is a workaholic society. It does not want you to learn relaxation, so from the very childhood it puts in your mind anti-relaxation ideas.

I am not telling you to relax the whole day. Do your work, but find out some time for yourself, and that can be found only in relaxation. And you will be surprised that if you can relax for an hour or two hours out of each twenty-four hours, it will give you a deeper insight into yourself. It will change your behavior outwardly – you will become more calm, more quiet. It will change the quality of your work – it will be more artistic and more graceful. You will be committing fewer mistakes than you used to commit before, because now you are more together, more centered. Relaxation has miraculous powers.

It is not laziness. The lazy man may look, from the outside, as if he is not working at anything, but his mind is going as fast as it can; and the relaxed man – his body is relaxed, his mind is relaxed, his heart is relaxed. Just relaxation on all three layers – body, mind, heart – for two hours he is almost absent. In these two hours his body recovers, his heart recovers, his intelligence recovers, and you will see in his work all that recovery.

He will not be a loser – although he will not be frantic anymore, he will not be unnecessarily running hither and thither. He will go directly to the point where he wants to go. And he will do things that are needed to be done; he will not be doing unnecessary trivia. He will say only that which is needed to be said. His words will become telegraphic; his movements will become graceful; his life will become a poetry.

Relaxation can transform you to such beautiful heights – and it is such a simple technique. There is nothing much in it; just for a few days you will

find it difficult because of the old habit.... Relaxation...is bound to come to you. It will bring new light to your eyes, a new freshness to your being, and it will help you to understand what meditation is. It is just the first steps outside the door of the temple of meditation. With just deeper and deeper relaxation it becomes meditation.

Total relaxation is the ultimate. That's the moment when one becomes a buddha. That's the moment of realization, enlightenment, christ-consciousness. You cannot be totally relaxed right now. At the innermost core a tension will persist.

But start relaxing. Start from the circumference – that's where we are, and we can start only from where we are. Relax the circumference of your being – relax your body, relax your behavior, relax your acts. Walk in a relaxed way, eat in a relaxed way; talk, listen in a relaxed way. Slow down every process. Don't be in a hurry and don't be in haste. Move as if all eternity is available to you – in fact, it is available to you. We are here from the beginning and we are going to be here to the very end, if there is a beginning and there is an end. In fact, there is no beginning and no end. We have always been here and we will be here always. Forms go on changing, but not the substance; garments go on changing, but not the soul.

Tension means hurry, fear, doubt. Tension means a constant effort to protect, to be secure, to be safe. Tension means preparing for the tomorrow now, or for the afterlife – afraid tomorrow you will not be able to face the reality, so be prepared. Tension means the past that you have not lived really but only somehow bypassed; it hangs, it is a hangover, it surrounds you.

Remember one very fundamental thing about life: any experience that has not been lived will hang around you, will persist: "Finish me! Live me! Complete me!" There is an intrinsic quality in every experience that it tends and wants to be finished, completed. Once completed, it evaporates; incomplete, it persists, it tortures you, it haunts you, it attracts your

attention. It says, “What are you going to do about me? I am still incomplete – fulfill me!”

Your whole past hangs around you with nothing completed because nothing has been lived really, everything somehow bypassed, partially lived, only so-so, in a lukewarm way. There has been no intensity, no passion. You have been moving like a somnambulist, a sleepwalker. So that past hangs, and the future creates fear. And between the past and the future is crushed your present, the only reality.

You will have to relax from the circumference. The first step in relaxing is the body. Remember as many times as possible to look in the body, whether you are carrying some tension in the body somewhere – at the neck, in the head, in the legs. Relax it consciously. Just go to that part of the body, and persuade that part, say to it lovingly “Relax!”

And you will be surprised that if you approach any part of your body, it listens, it follows you – it is *your* body! With closed eyes, go inside the body from the toe to the head searching for any place where there is a tension. And then talk to that part as you talk to a friend; let there be a dialogue between you and your body. Tell it to relax, and tell it, “There is nothing to fear. Don’t be afraid. I am here to take care – you can relax.” Slowly, slowly, you will learn the knack of it. Then the body becomes relaxed.

Then take another step, a little deeper; tell the mind to relax. And if the body listens, mind also listens, but you cannot start with the mind – you have to start from the beginning. You cannot start from the middle. Many people start with the mind and they fail; they fail because they start from a wrong place. Everything should be done in the right order.

If you become capable of relaxing the body voluntarily, then you will be able to help your mind relax voluntarily. Mind is a more complex phenomenon. Once you have become confident that the body listens to you,

you will have a new trust in yourself. Now even the mind can listen to you. It will take a little longer with the mind, but it happens.

When the mind is relaxed, then start relaxing your heart, the world of your feelings, emotions – which is even more complex, more subtle. But now you will be moving with trust, with great trust in yourself. Now you will know it is possible. If it is possible with the body and possible with the mind, it is possible with the heart too. And then only, when you have gone through these three steps, can you take the fourth. Now you can go to the innermost core of your being – which is beyond body, mind, heart – the very center of your existence. And you will be able to relax it too. And that relaxation certainly brings the greatest joy possible, the ultimate in ecstasy, acceptance. You will be full of bliss and rejoicing. Your life will have the quality of dance to it.

The whole of existence is dancing, except man. The whole of existence is in a very relaxed movement – movement there is, certainly, but it is utterly relaxed. Trees are growing and birds are chirping and rivers are flowing, stars are moving: everything is going in a very relaxed way...no hurry, no haste, no worry, and no waste. Except man. Man has fallen a victim of his mind.

Man can rise above gods and fall below animals. Man has a great spectrum. From the lowest to the highest, man is a ladder.

Start from the body, and then go slowly, slowly deeper. And don't start with anything unless you have first solved the primary. If your body is tense, don't start with the mind. Wait. Work on the body. And just small things are of immense help.

You walk at a certain pace; that has become habitual, automatic. Now try to walk slowly. Buddha used to say to his disciples: "Walk very slowly, and take each step very consciously." If you take each step very consciously, you are bound to walk slowly. If you are running, hurrying, you will forget to remember. Hence Buddha walks very slowly.

Just try walking very slowly, and you will be surprised – a new quality of awareness starts happening in the body. Eat slowly, and you will be surprised – there is great relaxation. Do everything slowly... just to change the old pattern, just to come out of old habits.

First the body has to become utterly relaxed, like a small child, then only start with the mind. Move scientifically: first the simplest, then the complex, then the more complex. And then only can you relax at the ultimate core....

Relaxation is one of the most complex phenomena – very rich, multi-dimensional. All these things are part of it: let-go, trust, surrender, love, acceptance, going with the flow, union with existence, egolessness, ecstasy. All these are part of it, and all these start happening if you learn the ways of relaxation.

Your so-called religions have made you very tense, because they have created guilt in you. My effort here is to help you get rid of all guilt and all fear. I would like to tell you: there is no hell and no heaven. So don't be afraid of hell and don't be greedy for heaven. All that exists is *this* moment. You can make this moment a hell or a heaven – that certainly is possible – but there is no heaven or hell somewhere else. Hell is when you are all tense, and heaven is when you are all relaxed. Total relaxation is paradise.

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12. STRESS AND HYPERTENSION

Stress is not always wrong; it can be used in beautiful ways. It is not necessarily negative, but if we think that it is negative, that is not good, then we create problems. Stress in itself can be used as a stepping stone, it can become a creative form. But ordinarily we have been taught down the ages that stress is bad, that when you are in any kind of stress you become afraid. And your fear makes it even more stressful; the situation is not helped by it.

For example, there is some situation in the market and that is creating a stress. The moment you feel that there is some tension, some stress, you become afraid that this should not be so: “I have to relax.” Now, trying to relax will not help, because you cannot relax; in fact, trying to relax will create a new kind of stress. The stress is there and you are trying to relax and you cannot, so you are complicating the problem.

When stress is there use it as creative energy. First, accept it; there is no need to fight with it. Accept it, it is perfectly okay. It simply says, “The market is not going well, something is going wrong,” “You may be a loser”...or something. Stress is simply an indication that the body is getting ready to fight with it. Now you try to relax or you take pain-killers or you take tranquilizers; you are going against the body. The body is getting ready to fight a certain situation, a certain challenge that is there: enjoy the challenge!

Even if sometimes you can't sleep in the night there is no need to be worried. Work it out, use that energy that is coming up: walk up and down, go for a run, go for a long walk, plan what you want to do, what the mind wants to do. Rather than trying to go to sleep, which is not possible, use the situation in a creative way. It simply says that the body is ready to fight with the problem; this is no time to relax. Relaxation can be done later on.

In fact if you have lived your stress totally you will come to a relaxation automatically; you can go on only so far, then the body automatically relaxes. If you want to relax in the middle you create trouble; the body cannot relax in the middle. It is almost as if an Olympic runner is getting ready, just waiting for the whistle, the signal, and he will be off, he will go like the wind. He is full of stress; now that is no time to relax. If he takes a tranquilizer he will never be of any use in the race. Or if he relaxes there and tries to do TM he will lose all. He has to use his stress: the stress is boiling, it is gathering energy. He is becoming more and more vital and potential. Now he has to sit on this stress and use it as energy, as fuel.

When the runner has run he will fall into deep sleep; the problem is solved. Now there is no problem, the stress disappears of its own accord.

So try this too: when there is a stressful situation don't freak out, don't become afraid of it. Go into it, use it to fight with. A man has tremendous energy and the more you use it, the more you have of it.... When it comes and there is a situation, fight, do all that you can do, really go madly into it. Allow it, accept it and welcome it. It is good, it prepares you to fight. And when you have worked it out, you will be surprised: great relaxation comes, and that relaxation is not created by you. Maybe for two, three days you cannot sleep and then for forty-eight hours you can't wake up, and that it okay!

We go on carrying many wrong notions – for example, that every person has to sleep eight hours every day. It depends what the situation is. There are situations when no sleep is needed: your house is on fire, and you are trying to sleep. Now that is not possible and that should *not* be possible; otherwise who is going to put that fire out? And when the house is on fire, all other things are put side; suddenly your body is ready to fight the fire. You will not feel sleepy. When the fire is gone and everything settled you may fall asleep for a long period, and that will do.

Everybody does not need the same length of sleep either. A few people can do with three hours, two hours, four hours, five hours, six, eight, ten,

twelve. People differ, there is no norm. And about stress also people differ.

There are two kinds of people in the world: One can be called the racehorse type and the other is the turtle type. If the racehorse type is not allowed to go fast, to go into things with speed, there will be stress; he has to be given his pace. So if you are a racehorse, forget about relaxation and things like that; they are not for you. Those are for turtles like me! Just be a racehorse, that is natural to you, and don't think of the joys that turtles are enjoying; that is not for you. You have a different kind of joy. If a turtle starts becoming a racehorse he will be in the same trouble...!

So accept your nature. You are a fighter, a warrior; you have to be that way, and that's your joy. Now, no need to be afraid; go into it wholeheartedly. Fight with the market, compete in the market, do all that you really want to do. Don't be afraid of the consequences, accept the stress. Once you accept the stress it will disappear. And not only that, you will feel very happy because you have started using it; it is a kind of energy.

If you are a racehorse type, don't listen to people who say to relax; that is not for you. Your relaxation will come only after you have earned it by hard labor. One has to understand one's type. Once the type is understood there is no problem; then one can follow a clean-cut line.

Hypertension is a state of mind when you have become too much focused on rationality and you have forgotten your feelings. Hypertension comes out of an imbalance; too much trust in reason is the basis of all hypertension. People who live in their heads become hypertense. Relaxation comes through the heart. One should be capable of moving easily from the head to the heart, just as you move out of your house and inside your house. One should be fluid between head and heart. These are the two shores of the river that you are. You should not cling to one shore, otherwise life becomes lopsided.

The West suffers very much from hypertension, because it has forgotten the language of the heart, and only the heart knows how to relax because only the heart knows how to love. Only the heart knows how to enjoy, celebrate. Only the heart knows how to dance and sing. The head knows nothing of dance – the head condemns dance as stupid. The head knows nothing of poetry, the head condemns poetry.

Do you know that one of the greatest philosophers, Plato, thinking about his ultimate utopian republic, said that no poet should be allowed there? In his republic, in his ultimate state of society, poets should not be allowed. Why? – because he is afraid of poets. He says: Poets bring fantasies, poets bring dreams, poets bring confusion and mysticism, and we don't want any of it. We want a very clear-cut, logical, prosaic society. That society will be hypertense; everybody will be neurotic. In Plato's republic – if it ever happens, and there is every fear that it can happen – everybody will be a neurotic, and everybody will always be carrying his psychoanalyst with him. Wherever he moves, he will have to carry his psychoanalyst. That is already coming in the West.

I have heard: In a New York street two small boys were talking – as they have always talked down the centuries, but what they said was very new. One boy said to the other, “My psychoanalyst can lick your psychoanalyst any time.” Small boys, they have always talked that way: “My father can lick your father,” or “My house is bigger than your house,” or “My dog is stronger than your dog” – a small child's beginning of the ego. But, “My psychoanalyst can lick your psychoanalyst any time” – this is something new.

Three women were talking about their children. One was saying, “He is the topmost in the class. He always comes first.”

The second said, “That's nothing. My child is only seven but he can play music like a Mozart, like a Wagner.”

The third said, “That’s nothing. My child is only five and he goes to his psychoanalyst all alone.”

Hypertension is a state where you have lost balance. You cannot bring your heart to function in your life; logic has become all – and logic remains superficial. Logic, when it becomes all, only creates anxiety; it never gives any peace, it goes on bringing new problems. It never solves any problem – it cannot solve, it is not in its power – it only pretends, it only promises. It goes on saying, “I will deliver the goods,” but it never delivers them. Then problems go on accumulating and you don’t know how to get out of the problems, because you don’t know how to get out of the head. You don’t know how to play with children, how to love your woman, how to go and have a talk with the trees and sometimes have a dialogue with the stars. You have forgotten all, you are no longer a poet, you are no longer an alive heart.

And whenever any part of the body is repressed, that part takes revenge. If another part of the mind is repressed that part takes revenge. And the heart is the most vital part, the most fundamental part. One can live without the head, but one cannot live without heart. The head is a little superficial, it is a kind of luxury, but the heart is very essential. The head exists only in man, so it cannot be very essential. Animals live without it and live perfectly well in a far more silent and blissful way than man. Trees live without the head, and so do the birds and the children and the mystics.

The head is superficial. It has a certain function – use it, but don’t be used by it. Once you are being used by it you will become anxious: anxiety will come and life will become nauseating. It will just be a long, stretched-out pain, and you will not find any oasis anywhere in it; it will be a desert thing. Remember, the essential has not to be repressed. The non-essential has to follow the essential, has to become its shadow. You cannot deny *anything* without getting into trouble. Listen to this anecdote:

One day a flying saucer landed in Elsie Guntree's garden, right in the middle of her summer bloomers – which could have been quite painful if she had been wearing them. There was a whirring sound, and a strange purple man appeared through the hatch in the side of the saucer. Straight away he headed for Elsie's back door and knocked politely.

Elsie opened the door, and quickly taking in the situation said, "Are you from the flying saucer?"

"Mm," replied the man, as though in pain.

"Are you from Mars?" Elsie asked.

"Mm," went the man again, his face contorted.

"How long did it take you to get here? Ten years?" asked Elsie.

"Mm."

"Twenty years?"

"Mm," said the man, an agonized look on his face.

"Twenty years? You've been all that time in your flying saucer?"

"Mm," nodded the man, furiously.

"What can I do for you?" asked Elsie.

The little man opened his mouth, and with great difficulty said, "Can I use your toilet, please?"

Deny anything and it becomes overpowering. Now, for twenty years he has not been able to find a toilet and you are asking nonsense questions: “Where are you coming from?” and “Who are you?” and “How many...?” How can he answer all these things? His denied part is there with a vengeance.

Your heart has been denied for so many lives that when it erupts it is going to create great chaos in your life. First you suffer from the mind, its tensions, anxieties; and then you can suffer from the explosion of the heart. That’s what happens when a man breaks down. First he suffers from the tense state of the mind, and then one day the heart takes its revenge, erupts, and the man goes mad, goes berserk.

Both situations are bad. First the sanity was too much – that created the insanity. A really sane person is one who can live between sanity and insanity in absolute balance. A really sane person always has some insanity in him – he accepts it. A really rational person is one who respects irrationality too, because life is such. If you cannot laugh because of your reason – because “laughter is ridiculous” – then you are bound for trouble, you are destined for trouble. Yes, logic is good, laughter too is good – and laughter brings balance. It is good to be serious, it is good to be non-serious too, and there should be a constant balancing.

Have you seen a tightrope walker? He continuously balances himself. Sometimes he leans to the left with his staff, and then he comes to a point where if he leans a single moment more, he will fall. He immediately changes his balance, goes to the other side – to the right – leans to the right. Then again a moment comes when one single moment more and he will be gone; he again starts leaning to the left. That’s how he proceeds: leaning to the left, to the right, he keeps in between. That’s the beauty – leaning to the left and to the right, leaning toward both extremes, he keeps in between.

If you want to keep yourself in between you will have to lean toward both sides again and again. You are not to choose. If you choose, you will fall. If you have chosen the heart, you will fall; you will become hypertense. If you

choose the heart and forget the head completely, you will become mad. And if you want to choose anyhow, if you want to choose, then choose being mad. Choose the heart, because it is more essential.

But I am not saying that you should choose. If you insist and you say, “I *have* to choose,” then be mad rather than just dry and sane. Be of the heart. Love, love madly; sing, sing madly; dance, dance madly. That is far better than just becoming calculating, logical, rational, and just suffering nightmares.

But I am not saying...it is not *my* suggestion that you do that. My suggestion is to remain choiceless. ‘Choiceless awareness’ is the keyword. Remain choiceless, aware, and whenever you see that something is going off-balance, lean to the other side. Bring the balance again, and this is how one moves. Life is like tightrope walking.

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13. DEPRESSION, THE RICH MAN'S DISEASE

Man has always lived with hope, a future, a paradise somewhere far away. He has never lived in the present – his golden age is still to come. It kept him enthusiastic because greater things were going to happen; all his longings were going to be fulfilled. There was great joy in anticipation. He suffered in the present; he was miserable in the present. But all that was completely forgotten in the dreams that were going to be fulfilled tomorrow. Tomorrow has always been life-giving.

But the situation has changed. The old situation was not good because the tomorrow – the fulfillment of his dreams – never became true. He died hoping. Even in his death he was hoping for a future life – but he never actually experienced any rejoicing, any meaning. But it was tolerable. It was only a question of today: it will pass, and tomorrow is bound to come. The religious prophets, messiahs, saviors were promising him all pleasures – which are condemned here – in paradise. The political leaders, the social ideologists, the utopians were promising him the same thing – not in paradise but here on earth, somewhere far away in the future when the society goes through a total revolution and there is no poverty, no classes, no government and man is absolutely free and has everything that he needs.

Both are basically fulfilling the same psychological need. To those who were materialistic, the ideological, political, sociological utopians were appealing; to those who were not so materialistic, the religious leaders appealed. But the object of appeal was exactly the same: all that you can imagine, can dream of, can long for, will be absolutely fulfilled. With those dreams, the present miseries seemed to be very small.

There was enthusiasm in the world; people were not depressed. Depression is a contemporary phenomenon and it has come into being because now there is no tomorrow. All political ideologies have failed. There is no

possibility that man will ever be equal, no possibility that there will be a time when there will be no government, no possibility that all your dreams will be fulfilled.

This has come as a great shock. Simultaneously man has become more mature. He may go to the church, to the mosque, to the synagogue, to the temple – but they are only social conformities, because he does not want, in such a dark and depressed state, to be left alone; he wants to be with the crowd. But basically he knows there is no paradise; he knows that no savior is going to come.

Hindus have waited five thousand years for Krishna. He promised not only that he would come once, he promised that whenever there was misery, suffering, whenever vice was on top of virtue, whenever nice and simple and innocent people were exploited by the cunning and the hypocritical, he would come. But for five thousand years no sign has been seen of him.

Jesus has promised he will come, and when asked when, he said, “Very soon.” I can stretch “Very soon,” but not for two thousand years; that is too much.

The idea that our misery, our pain, our anguish will be taken away is no longer appealing. The idea that there is a God who cares for us seems to be simply a joke. Looking at the world, it doesn’t seem as if there is anybody who cares.

In fact, in England there are almost thirty thousand people who are devil worshippers – just in England, a small part of the world. And their ideology is worth looking at in reference to your question. They say that the devil is not against God, the devil is God’s son. God has abandoned the world, and now the only hope is to persuade the devil to take care as God is not taking care. And thirty thousand people are worshipping the devil as a son of God... and the reason is they feel that God has abandoned the world – he no longer cares about it. Naturally, the only way is to appeal to his son; if somehow he can be persuaded by rituals, by prayer, by worship, perhaps the

misery, the darkness, the sickness can be removed. This is a desperate effort.

The reality is that man has always lived in poverty. Poverty has one thing beautiful about it: it never destroys your hope, it never goes against your dreams, it always brings enthusiasm for tomorrow. One is hopeful, believing that things will be better: this dark period is already passing; soon there will be light. But that situation has changed. In the developed countries... and remember, the problem of depression is not in undeveloped countries – in the poor countries, people are still hopeful – it is only in the developed countries, where they have everything that they had always longed for. Now paradise will not do anymore; nor can a classless society help anymore. No utopia is going to be better. They have achieved the goal – and this achievement of the goal is the cause of depression. Now there is no hope: tomorrow is dark, and the day after tomorrow will be even darker.

All these things that they have dreamed of were very beautiful. They had never looked at the implications of them. Now that they have got them, they have got them with the implications. A man is poor, but he has an appetite. A man is rich, but he has no appetite. And it is better to be poor and have an appetite than to be rich and have no appetite. What are you going to do with all your gold, all your silver, all your dollars? You cannot eat them. You have everything, but the appetite has disappeared for which you have been struggling all along. You succeeded – and I have said again and again that nothing fails like success. You have reached a place that you wanted to reach, but you were not aware of the by-products. You have millions of dollars, but you cannot sleep....

When man reaches to the cherished goals, then he becomes aware that there are many things around them. For example, for your whole life you try to earn money, thinking that one day, when you have it, you will live a relaxed life. But you have been tense your whole life – tension has become your discipline – and at the end of life, when you have achieved all the money you wanted, you cannot relax. The whole life disciplined in tension and anguish and worry won't let you relax. So you are not a winner, you are a

loser. You lose your appetite, you destroy your health, you destroy your sensibility, your sensitiveness. You destroy your aesthetic sense – because there is no time for all these things which do not produce dollars.

You are running after dollars – who has time to look at the roses, and who has time to look at the birds on the wing, and who has time to look at the beauty of human beings? You postpone all these things so that one day, when you have everything, you will relax and enjoy. But by the time you have everything, you have become a certain kind of disciplined person – who is blind to roses, who is blind to beauty, who cannot enjoy music, who cannot understand dance, who cannot understand poetry, who can only understand dollars. But those dollars give no satisfaction.

This is the cause of depression. That's why it is only in the developed countries and only in the richer class of the developed countries – in the developed countries there are poor people also, but they don't suffer from depression – and now you cannot give a man any more hope to remove his depression because he has all, more than you can promise. His condition is really pitiable. He never thought of implications, he never thought of by-products, he never thought of what he would lose by gaining money. He never thought that he would lose everything that could make him happy just because he has always pushed all those things aside. He had no time, and the competition was tough and he had to be tough. At the end he finds his heart is dead, his life is meaningless. He doesn't see that there is any possibility in the future of any change, because "What more is there...?"

I used to stay in Sagar in a very rich man's house. The old man was very beautiful. He was the greatest *bidi* manufacturer in the whole of India. He had everything that you can imagine, but he was absolutely unable to enjoy anything. Enjoyment is something that has to be nourished. It is a certain discipline, a certain art – how to enjoy – and it takes time to get in contact with the great things in life. But the man who is running after money bypasses everything that is a door to the divine, and he ends up at the end of the road and there is nothing ahead of him except death.

His whole life he was miserable. He tolerated it, ignored it in the hope that things were going to change. Now he cannot ignore it and cannot tolerate it because tomorrow there is only death and nothing else. And the whole life's accumulated misery that he has ignored, the suffering that he has ignored, explodes in his being.

The richest man, in a way, is the poorest man in the world. To be rich and not to be poor is a great art. To be poor and to be rich is the other side of the art. There are poor people whom you will find immensely rich. They don't have anything, but they are rich. Their richness is not in things but in their being, in their multidimensional experiences. And there are rich people who have everything but are absolutely poor and hollow and empty. Deep inside there is just a graveyard.

It is not a depression of the society, because then it would affect the poor too; it is simply natural law, and man now will have to learn it. Up to now there was no need, because nobody had reached to a point where he had everything, while inside there was complete darkness and ignorance.

The first thing in life is to find meaning in the present moment.

The basic flavor of your being should be of love, of rejoicing, of celebration. Then you can do anything; dollars will not destroy it. But you put everything aside and simply run after dollars thinking that dollars can purchase everything. And then one day you find they cannot purchase anything – and you have devoted your whole life to dollars.

This is the cause of depression. And particularly in the West, the depression is going to be very deep. In the East there have been rich people, but there was a certain dimension available. When the road to richness came to an end, they did not remain stuck there; they moved into a new direction. That new direction was in the air, available for centuries. In the East the poor have been in a very good condition, and the rich have been in a tremendously good condition. The poor have learned contentment so they do not bother about running after ambition. And the rich have understood

that one day you have to renounce it all and go in search of truth, in search of meaning.

In the West, at the end, the road simply ends. You can go back, but going back will not help your depression. You need a new direction. Gautam Buddha, Mahavira, or Parshvanath – these people were at the peak of richness, and then they saw that it is almost a burden. Something else has to be found before death takes you over – and they were courageous enough to renounce all. Their renunciation has been misunderstood. They renounced it all because they did not want to bother a single second more for money, for power – because they have seen the top, and there is nothing there. They went to the very highest rung of the ladder and found that it leads nowhere; it is just a ladder leading nowhere. While you are somewhere in the middle, or lower than the middle, you have a hope because there are other rungs higher than you. There comes a point when you are on the highest rung and there is only suicide or madness – or hypocrisy: you go on smiling till death finishes you, but deep down you know that you have wasted your life.

In the East, depression has never been a problem. The poor learned to enjoy whatsoever little they had, and the rich learned that having the whole world at your feet means nothing – you have to go in a search for meaning, not for money. And they had precedents: for thousands of years people have gone in search of truth and have found it. There is no need to be in despair, in depression, you just have to move into an unknown dimension. They have never explored it, but as they start exploring the new dimension – it means a journey inwards, a journey to their own self – all that they have lost starts returning.

The West needs a great movement of meditation very urgently; otherwise, this depression is going to kill people. And these people will be the talented ones – because they achieved power, they achieved money, they achieved whatsoever they wanted...the highest degrees in education. These are the talented people, and they are all feeling despair.

This is going to be dangerous because the most talented people are no longer enthusiastic about life, and the untalented are enthusiastic about life but they don't even have the talents to get power, money, education, respectability. They don't have the talents, so they are suffering, feeling handicapped. They are turning into terrorists, they are turning towards unnecessary violence just out of revenge – because they cannot do anything else. But they can destroy. And the rich are almost ready to hang themselves from any tree because there is no reason for them to live. Their hearts have stopped beating long ago. They are just corpses – well decorated, well honored, but utterly empty and futile.

The West is really in a far worse condition than the East, although to those who don't understand it seems that the West is in a better condition than the East because the East is poor. But poverty is not as big of a problem as is the failure of richness; then a man is really poor. An ordinary poor man at least has dreams, hopes, but the rich man has nothing.

What is needed is a great meditation movement reaching to every person.

And in the West these people who are depressed are going to psychoanalysts, therapists and all kinds of charlatans who are themselves depressed, more depressed than their patients – naturally, because the whole day they are hearing about depression, despair, meaninglessness. And seeing so many talented people in such a bad state, they themselves start losing their spirit. They cannot help; they themselves need help.

The function of my school is going to be to prepare people with meditative energy and send them into the world just as examples for those who are depressed. If they can see that there are people who are not depressed – but on the contrary, who are immensely joyous – perhaps a hope may be born into them. Now they can have everything and there is no need to worry. They can meditate.

I don't teach renunciation of your wealth or of anything. Let everything be as it is. Just add one thing more to your life. Up to now you have been

adding only things to your life. Now add something to your being – and that will do the music, that will do the miracle, that will do the magic, that will create a new thrill, a new youth, a new freshness.

It is not unsolvable. The problem is big, but the solution is very simple.

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14. FOOD AND HEALTH

No animal eats like man; every animal has its chosen food. If you bring buffaloes in the garden and leave them, they will eat only a particular grass. They will not go on eating everything and anything – they are very choosy. They have a certain feeling about their food. Man is completely lost, has no feeling about his food. He goes on eating everything and anything. In fact you cannot find anything which is not eaten somewhere or other by man. In some places, ants are eaten. In some places, snakes are eaten. In some places, dogs are eaten. Man has eaten everything. Man is simply mad. He does not know what is in resonance with his body and what is not. He is completely confused.

Man, naturally, should be a vegetarian, because the whole body is made for vegetarian food. Even scientists concede to the fact that the whole structure of the human body shows that man should not be a non-vegetarian. Man comes from the monkeys. Monkeys are vegetarians – absolute vegetarians. If Darwin is true then man should be a vegetarian. Now there are ways to judge whether a certain species of animal is vegetarian or non-vegetarian: it depends on the intestine, the length of the intestine. Non-vegetarian animals have a very small intestine. Tigers, lions – they have a very small intestine, because meat is already a digested food. It does not need a long intestine to digest it. The work of digestion has been done by the animal. Now you are eating the animal's meat. It is already digested – no long intestine is needed. Man has one of the longest intestines: that means man is a vegetarian. A long digestion is needed, and much excrement will be there which has to be thrown out.

If man is not a non-vegetarian and he goes on eating meat, the body is burdened. In the East, all the great meditators – Buddha, Mahavira – they have emphasized the fact, not because of any concept of nonviolence, that is a secondary thing, but because if you really want to move in deep

meditation your body needs to be weightless, natural flowing. Your body needs to be unloaded; and a non-vegetarian's body is very much loaded.

Just watch what happens when you eat meat: when you kill an animal what happens to the animal when he is killed? Of course, nobody wants to be killed. Life wants to prolong itself; the animal is not dying willingly. If somebody kills you, you will not die willingly. If a lion jumps on you and kills you, what will happen to your mind? The same happens when you kill a lion. Agony, fear, death, anguish, anxiety, anger, violence, sadness – all these things happen to the animal. All over his body violence, anguish, agony spreads. The whole body becomes full of toxins, poisons. All the body glands release poisons because the animal is dying very unwillingly. And then you eat the meat – that meat carries all the poisons that the animal has released. The whole energy is poisonous, then those poisons are carried in your body.

And that meat which you are eating belonged to an animal body. It had a specific purpose there. A specific type of consciousness existed in the animal's body. You are on a higher plane than the animal's consciousness, and when you eat the animal's meat your body goes to the lowest plane, to the lower plane of the animal. Then there exists a gap between your consciousness and your body, and a tension arises, an anxiety arises.

One should eat things that are natural – natural for you. Fruits, nuts, vegetables – eat as much as you can. And the beauty is that you cannot eat these things more than is needed. Whatsoever is natural always gives you a satisfaction, because it satiates your body, saturates you. You feel fulfilled. If something is unnatural it never gives you a feeling of fulfillment. Go on eating ice cream: you never feel that you are satiated. In fact the more you eat, the more you feel like eating. It is not a food. Your mind is being tricked. Now you are not eating according to the body need, you are eating just to taste it. The tongue has become the controller.

The tongue should not be the controller. It does not know anything about the stomach. It does not know anything about the body. The tongue has a

specific purpose to fulfill: to taste food. Naturally, the tongue has to judge, that is the only thing, which food is for the body – for my body – and which food is not for my body. It is just a watchman on the door; it is not the master. And if the watchman on the door becomes the master, then everything will be confused.

Now advertisers know well that the tongue can be tricked, the nose can be tricked. And they are not the masters. You may not be aware: much food research goes on in the world, and they say if your nose is closed completely and your eyes closed, and then you are given an onion to eat, you cannot tell what you are eating. You cannot tell onion from apple if the nose is closed completely because half of the taste comes from the smell, is decided by the nose, and half is decided by the tongue – and these two have become the controllers. Now they know: whether ice cream is nutritious or not is not the point. It can carry a flavor, it can carry some chemicals that fulfill the tongue but are not needed for the body.

Man is confused – more confused than buffaloes. You can not convince buffaloes to eat ice cream. Try!

A natural food... and when I say ‘natural’ I mean that which your body needs. The need of a tiger is different; he has to be very violent. If you eat the meat of a tiger you will be violent, but where will your violence be expressed? You have to live in human society, not in a jungle. Then you will have to suppress the violence. Then a vicious circle starts. When you suppress violence, what happens? When you feel angry, violent, a certain poisonous energy is released, because that poison creates a situation where you can be really violent and kill somebody. The energy moves towards your hands; the energy moves towards your teeth – these are the two places from where animals become violent. Man is part of the animal kingdom.

When you are angry, energy is released – it comes to the hands and to the teeth, to the jaw – but you live in a human society and it is not always profitable to be angry. You live in a civilized world, and you cannot behave like an animal. If you behave like an animal, you will have to pay too much

for it – and you are not ready to pay that much. Then what do you do? You suppress the anger in the hand; you suppress the anger in your teeth – you go on smiling a false smile, and your teeth go on accumulating anger.

I have rarely come to see people with a natural jaw. It is not natural – blocked, stiff – because too much anger is there. If you press the jaw of a person, the anger can be released. Hands become ugly. They lose grace, they lose flexibility, because too much anger is suppressed there. People who have been working on deep massage, they have come to know that when you touch the hands deeply, massage the hands, the person starts becoming angry. There is no reason. You are massaging the man and suddenly he starts feeling angry. If you press the jaw, persons become angry again. They carry accumulated anger.

These are the impurities in the body: they have to be released. If you don't release them the body will remain heavy. Yoga exercises exist to release all sorts of accumulated poisons in the body. Yoga movements release them; and a yogi's body has a suppleness of its own. Yoga exercises are totally different from other exercises. They don't make your body strong; they make your body more flexible. And when your body is more flexible, you are strong in a very different sense: you are younger. They make your body more liquid, more flowing – no blocks in the body. The whole body exists as an organic unity, in a deep rhythm of its own. It is not like noise in the market, it is like an orchestra. A deep rhythm inside, no blocks, then the body is pure. Yoga exercises can be tremendously helpful.

Everybody is carrying much rubbish in the stomach, because that is the only space in the body where you can suppress things. There is no other space. If you want to suppress anything it has to be suppressed in the stomach. If you want to cry – your wife has died, your beloved has died, your friend has died – but it doesn't look good, looks as if you are a weakling, crying for a woman, you suppress it. Where will you put that crying? Naturally, you have to suppress it in the stomach. That is the only space available in the body, the only hollow place, where you can force it.

If you suppress in the stomach...and everybody has suppressed many sorts of emotions: of love, of sexuality, of anger, of sadness, of weeping – even of laughter. You cannot laugh a belly laugh. It looks rude, looks vulgar – you are not cultured then. You have suppressed everything. Because of this suppression, you cannot breathe deeply, you have to breathe shallowly. If you breathed deeply then those wounds of suppression, they would release their energy. You are afraid. Everybody is afraid to move in the stomach.

Every child, when born, breathes through the belly. Look at a child sleeping: the belly goes up and down – never the chest. No child breathes from the chest; they breathe from the belly. They are completely free now, nothing is suppressed. Their stomachs are empty, and that emptiness has a beauty in the body. Once the stomach has too much suppression in it, the body is divided in two parts, the lower and the higher. Then you are not one; you are two. The lower part is the discarded part. The unity is lost; a duality has entered into your being. Now you cannot be beautiful, you cannot be graceful. You are carrying two bodies instead of one – and there will always remain a gap between the two. You cannot walk beautifully. Somehow you have to carry your legs. In fact, if the body is one, your legs will carry you. If the body is divided in two then you have to carry your legs.

You have to drag your body. It is like a burden – you cannot enjoy it. You cannot enjoy a good walk, you cannot enjoy a good swim, you cannot enjoy a fast run – because the body is not one. For all these movements, and to enjoy them, the body needs to be reunited. A unison has to be created again: the stomach will have to be cleansed completely.

For the cleansing of the stomach very deep breathing is needed, because when you inhale deeply and exhale deeply, the stomach throws all that it is carrying. In exhalations, the stomach releases itself. Hence the importance of *pranayam*, of deep rhythmic breathing. The emphasis should be on the exhalation so that everything that the stomach has been unnecessarily carrying is released. And when the stomach is not carrying emotions inside, if you have constipation it will suddenly disappear. When you are

suppressing emotions in the stomach there will be constipation because the stomach is not free to have its movements. You are controlling it deeply; you can't allow it freedom. So if emotions are suppressed, there will be constipation. Constipation is more a mental disease than a physical one. It belongs to the mind more than it belongs to the body.

But remember, I am not dividing mind and body in two. They are two aspects of the same phenomenon. Mind and body are not two things. In fact to say 'mind and body' is not good: 'mind-body' will be the right expression. Your body is a psychosomatic phenomenon. Mind is the subtlest part of the body, and body is the grossest part of the mind. And they both affect each other; they run parallel. If you are suppressing something in the mind, the body will start a suppressing journey. If the mind releases everything, the body also releases everything. That's why I emphasize catharsis very much. Catharsis is a cleansing process.

These are all austerities: fasting; natural eating; deep, rhythmic breathing; yoga exercises; living a more and more natural, flexible, supple life; creating less and less suppressed attitudes; allowing the body to have its own say, following the wisdom of the body....

When the body is pure, you will see tremendous new energies arising, new dimensions opening before you, new doors suddenly opening, new possibilities. The body has much hidden power. Once it is released, you will not be able to believe it, that the body carried so many things in it, and so close.

According to the mystic traditions of the East, all that you think you are is nothing but food. Your body is food, your mind is food, your soul is food. Beyond the soul there is certainly something which is not food. That something is known as *anatta*, no-self. It is utter emptiness. Buddha calls it *shunya*, the void. It is pure space. It contains nothing but itself; it is contentless consciousness.

While the content persists, the food persists. By food is meant that which is ingested from the outside. The body needs physical food; without it, it will start withering away. This is how it survives; it contains nothing but physical food.

Your mind contains memories, thoughts, desires, jealousies, power trips, and a thousand and one things. All that is also food; it is food on a little more subtle plane. Thought is food. Hence when you have nourishing thoughts your chest expands, when you have thoughts which give you energy you feel good. Somebody says something good about you, a compliment, and look what happens to you: you are nourished. And somebody says something wrong about you, and watch: it is as if something has been snatched away from you, you are weaker than you were before.

The mind is food in a subtle form. The mind is nothing but the inner side of the body; hence what you eat affects your mind. If you eat non-vegetarian food you will have a particular kind of mind; if you eat vegetarian food you will certainly have a different kind of mind.

Do you know this immensely important fact about Indian history? India never attacked any country in its whole history of ten thousand years. Never – not a single aggressive act. How was it possible? Why? The same humanity exists here as exists everywhere else. But it is just that a different kind of body created a different mind.

You can watch it yourself. Eat something and watch, eat something else and watch. Keep notes, and you will become aware and surprised to find that each thing that you digest is not only physical, it has a psychological part to it. It makes your mind vulnerable to certain ideas, to certain desires. Hence, down the ages, there has been a search for a kind of food that will not strengthen the mind but will help it to finally dissolve; a kind of food which, instead of strengthening the mind, will strengthen meditation, no-mind. No fixed and certain rules can be given, because people are different and each one has to decide for himself.

And watch what you allow into your mind. People are completely unaware; they go on reading everything and anything, they go on looking at the TV, any silly, stupid thing. They go on listening to the radio, they go on chitchatting, chattering with people, and they are all pouring rubbish into each other's heads. Rubbish is all that they have.

Avoid such situations in which you are unnecessarily burdened with rubbish. You already have too much as it is; you need to be unburdened of it. And you go on collecting it as if it is something precious. Talk less, listen only to the essential, be telegraphic in talking and listening. If you talk less, if you listen less, slowly, slowly you will see that a cleanliness, a feeling of purity, as if you have just taken a bath, will start arising within you. That becomes the necessary soil for meditation to arise. Don't go on reading all kinds of nonsense.

Once I used to live in a house where the neighbor was a madman who was very much interested in newspapers. He would come every day to collect all the newspapers from me. If sometimes he was ill or I was not at home, then he would come later on. Once it happened, for ten days I was away. And when I came back he came again to collect all the newspapers. I said to him, "But these are old now – ten days old."

He said, "What does it matter? It is the same rubbish! Only the dates change."

It must have been a very sane moment in that madman's life. Yes, there are insane moments in so-called sane people's lives, and vice versa. He was telling the truth, saying, "It is the same old nonsense. What does it matter? I have time, and I have to remain occupied."

I asked him, "What did you do for these ten days?" He said, "I was reading the old newspapers – reading them again and again and again."

Leave a few gaps in your mind unoccupied. Those moments of unoccupied consciousness are the first glimpses of meditation, the first penetrations of

the beyond, the first flashes of no-mind. And then if you can manage to do this, the other thing is to choose physical food which does not help aggression and violence, which is not poisonous.

Now even scientists agree with this, that when you kill an animal, out of fear he releases all kinds of poisons. Death is not easy. When you are killing an animal, out of fear a great trembling arises inside. The animal wants to survive: all kinds of poisons are released.

When you are in fear you also release poisons in the body. Those poisons are helpful: they help you to either fight or take flight. Sometimes it happens that in anger you can do things which you could never have imagined yourself doing. You can move a rock which ordinarily you could not have even shaken, but anger is there and poison is released. In fear, people can run so fast that even Olympic runners will be left behind. Just think of yourself running if somebody is behind you with a dagger to kill you. You will do the best you can do, your whole body will be geared to function at its optimum.

When you kill an animal there is anger, there is anxiety, there is fear. Death is facing him: all the glands of the animal release many kinds of poisons. Hence the modern idea is that before killing an animal, make him unconscious, give him anesthesia. In modern butcheries, anesthesia is being used. But that does not make much difference, only a very superficial difference, because at the deepest core where no anesthesia can ever reach, death has to be encountered. It may not be conscious, the animal may not be aware of what is happening, but it is happening as if in a dream. He is passing through a nightmare. And to eat meat is to eat poisoned food.

Avoid anything that is poisoned on the physical plane, avoid anything that is poisoned on the mental plane. And on the mental plane things are more complicated. If you think you are a Hindu, you are poisoned; if you think you are a Mohammedan, you are poisoned. If you think you are a Christian, a Jaina, a Buddhist, you are poisoned. And you have been poisoned slowly – so slowly that you have become attuned to it. You are addicted to it. You

have been spoon-fed since the very first day; from your mother's breast, you have been poisoned. All kinds of conditionings are poisons. To think of oneself as a Hindu is to think of oneself opposed to humanity. To think of oneself as German, as Chinese, is to think of oneself opposed to humanity; is to think in terms of enmity, not friendship.

Think of yourself only as a human being. If you have any intelligence, think of yourself only as a simple human being. And when your intelligence grows a little more you will drop even the adjective 'human'. You will think of yourself only as a being. And the being includes all – the trees and the mountains and the rivers and the stars and the birds and the animals.

Become bigger, become huge. Why are you living in tunnels? Why are you creeping into small dark black holes? But you think you are living in great ideological systems. You are not living in great ideological systems, because there *are* no great ideological systems. No idea is great enough to contain a human being; being-hood cannot be contained by any concept. All concepts cripple and paralyze.

Don't be a Catholic and don't be a communist – just be a human being – these are all poisons, these are all prejudices. And down the ages you have been hypnotized into these prejudices. They have become part of your blood, your bones, your very marrow. You will have to be very alert to get rid of all this poisoning.

Your body is not poisoned as much as your mind is. The body is a simple phenomenon, it can be easily cleaned. If you have been eating non-vegetarian foods it can be stopped, it is not such a big deal. And if you stop eating meat, within three months your body will be completely free of all the poisons created by non-vegetarian foods. It is simple. Physiology is not very complicated. But the problem arises with psychology. A Jaina monk never eats any poisoned food, never eats anything non-vegetarian. But his mind is polluted and poisoned by Jainism as nobody else's is.

The real freedom is freedom from any ideology. Can't you simply live without any ideology? Is an ideology needed? Why is an ideology needed so much? It is needed because it helps you to remain stupid, it is needed because it helps you to remain unintelligent. It is needed because it supplies you ready-made answers and you need not find them on your own.

The real man of intelligence will not cling to any ideology—for what? He will not carry a load of ready-made answers. He knows that he has enough intelligence so that whatever situation arises, he will be able to respond to it. Why carry an unnecessary load from the past? What is the point of carrying it?...

If you change your poisonous foods you will be surprised: a new intelligence will be released in you. And this new intelligence will make it possible not to go on stuffing yourself with nonsense. This new intelligence will make you capable of dropping the past and its memories, of dropping unnecessary desires and dreams, dropping jealousies, angers, traumas and all kinds of psychological wounds.

Because you cannot drop psychological wounds, you become victims of psycho-fraud. The world is full of psychoanalysts of many kinds, they come in all shapes and sizes. The world is full of all kinds of psychotherapies. But why are so many psychotherapies needed? They are needed because you are not intelligent enough to heal your own wounds. Instead of healing them, instead of opening them to the winds and to the sun, you go on hiding them. You need psychotherapists to help you to open your wounds to the sun so that they can be healed, so that they can be allowed to heal. But it is very difficult to find a real psychotherapist. Out of a hundred psychotherapists, ninety-nine are psycho-frauds, not psychotherapists.

You will be surprised to know that more psychotherapists and psychoanalysts commit suicide than people in any other profession. The number is almost double. Now, what kind of people are these? And how were they going to help others? What were they doing their whole lives helping people? More psychoanalysts go mad, insane, than people in any

other profession of the world. The number is almost double. Why? And they were helping other people towards sanity, when they themselves were insane. There is every possibility that they became interested in psychotherapy because of their insanity. It was an effort to find a cure for themselves. And you will be surprised to know that psychotherapists of one kind go for psychotherapy to psychotherapists of another kind. The Freudian goes to the Jungian, the Jungian goes to the Freudian, and so on and so forth. This is a very strange situation.

If intelligence is released in you, you will be able to do all that is needed. You will be able to heal your own wounds, you will be able to see your own traumas, you need not go to a primal therapist.

I am allowing all kinds of therapies in my commune. In fact, in no other place in the world are so many psychotherapies available – sixty in all. Why am I allowing these therapies? Just because of you, because you are not yet ready to release your intelligence. As the commune goes deeper and deeper into inner realizations, therapies can be dropped. When the commune has really bloomed, there will be no need of any therapy. Then love is therapy, intelligence is therapy. Then living day to day, moment to moment, aware and alert, is therapy. Then all kinds of things that you do during the day, cleaning and cooking and washing, they are all therapy.

Therapies are here only for the time being. The day I become convinced that now the major part of you has gone beyond therapies, therapies will disappear, because then the major part will be able to pull the minor part into intelligence also.

We are trying to create an intelligent kind of life. I am not much of a religious person, I am not a saint, I have nothing to do with spirituality. All those categories are irrelevant about me. You cannot categorize me, you cannot pigeonhole me. But one thing can be said, that my whole effort is to help you release the energy called love-intelligence. If love-intelligence is released, you are healed.

And the third kind of poisoned food is spiritual. That's what the self is. The self needs continuous attention: it feeds on attention, attention is its food. It is not only the politician who hankers for attention, more and more attention from more and more people – your so-called saints are doing the same. There is no difference between saints and politicians and actors, no difference at all. Their basic need is the same – attention: “More people should pay attention to me, more people should look up to me.” That becomes food for the ego, and it is the subtlest kind of poisoned food....

Physical, psychological, spiritual.... Let your physiological body be pure of all poisons and toxins, and your mind be unburdened of all kinds of rubbish and junk. And let your soul be free from the idea of the self. When the soul is free from the idea of “I” you have arrived at that inner space called no-self, *anatta*. That is freedom, that is nirvana, that is enlightenment. You have come home. Now there is nowhere to go; now you can settle, rest and relax. Now you can enjoy the millions of joys that are being showered upon you by existence.

When these three poisoned foods are dropped, you become empty. But this emptiness is not a negative kind of emptiness. You are empty in the sense that all poisons, all contents, are gone. But you are full – full of something that cannot be named, full of something which devotees call “God.”

There are two types of food. One is that which you like, which you have a fancy for, about which you fantasize. There is nothing wrong in it, but you will have to learn a small trick about it. There are foods that have a tremendous appeal. The appeal is not because you see that the food is available. You go into a hotel, into a restaurant, and you see certain foods – the smell coming from the back room, the color and the aroma of the food. You were not thinking about the food and suddenly you are interested in it – this is not going to help. This is not your real desire. You can eat this thing and it will not satisfy you. You will eat and eat and nothing will come out of it; no satisfaction will come out of it. And satisfaction is the most important thing. It is the dissatisfaction that creates the obsession.

Simply meditate every day before you take food. Close your eyes and just feel what your body needs – whatsoever it is! You have not seen any food – no food is available; you are simply feeling your own being, what your body needs, what you feel like, what you hanker for.

Dr. Leonard Pearson calls this, ‘humming food’ – food that hums to you. Go and eat as much of it as you want, but stick to it. The other food he calls, ‘beckoning food’: when it becomes available, you become interested in it. Then it is a mind thing and it is not your need. If you listen to your humming food, you can eat as much as you want and you will never suffer, because it will satisfy you. The body simply desires that which it needs; it never desires anything else. That will be satisfactory, and once there is satisfaction, one never eats more. The problem arises only if you are eating foods which are beckoning foods: you see them available and you become interested and you eat. They cannot satisfy you because there is no need in the body for them. When they don’t satisfy you, you feel unsatisfied. Feeling unsatisfied, you eat more, but howsoever much you eat, it is not going to satisfy because there is no need in the first place.

The first type of desire has to be fulfilled, then the second will disappear. What people are doing is that they never listen to the first, so the second becomes a problem. If you listen to the humming food, the beckoning food will disappear. The second is a problem only because you have completely forgotten that you have to listen to your inner desire, and people have been taught not to listen to it. They have been taught, “Eat this, don’t eat that” – fixed rules. The body knows no fixed rules.

They have found that if small children are left alone with food, they will eat only that which is needed for their body; and they were surprised. Many psychological findings are available now; they were simply surprised. If a child is suffering from some disease, and if apple is good for that disease, the child will choose the apple. All other foods are available but the child will go to the apple.

That's what all animals are doing; only man has forgotten the language. You bring a buffalo and leave her in the garden. The whole garden is there – all the greenery is available; she will not bother. The flowers and the trees may be beckoning but she won't bother with them. She will go to the grass that hums to her, and she will choose only certain grass that is her need. You cannot deceive a buffalo; you can only deceive man.

Man has fallen even below buffaloes. You cannot befool a donkey – he will eat his food. Man is befooled. Everywhere through advertisements, colored pictures, TV, movies, you are being attracted and distracted from your humming body. Some company is interested in selling something to you.

That is in the favor of the company, it is beneficial to the company, not to you.

Some Coca-Cola company is interested in selling Coca-Cola to you. It has nothing to do with your body; it allures you. Wherever you go, there is Coca-Cola; Coca Cola seems to be one of the most universal things. Even in Soviet Russia—nothing else American is allowed, but Coca-Cola is there. From everywhere the bottle is calling you, beckoning, "Come here." And suddenly you start feeling thirsty. That thirst is false. I'm not saying don't drink Coca-Cola – but let it hum; make it a point.

It will take a few days, even a few weeks for you to come to feel what appeals to you. Eat as much as you want of what appeals to you. Don't bother about what others say. If ice cream appeals to you, eat ice cream. Eat to your satisfaction, to your heart's desire, and then suddenly you will see that there is satisfaction. And when you feel satisfied, the desire to stuff disappears. It is an unsatisfied state that makes you stuff yourself more and more and still to no purpose. You feel full and still unsatisfied, so the problem arises.

So first start learning something which is natural and which will come because we have only forgotten; it is there in the body. When you are going to take your breakfast, close your eyes and see what you want; what your

desire really is. Don't think about what is available; simply think what your desire is, and then go and find that thing and eat it. Eat as much as you want. For a few days just go with it. By and by you will see that now no food beckons you.

The second thing: when you eat, chew it well. Don't swallow it in a hurry, because if it is oral, you enjoy it in the mouth, so why not chew it more? If you take ten bites of something you can enjoy one bite, chew it ten times more. It will almost be like taking ten bites if your enjoyment is only of the taste.

It happened once that a man drank some hot coffee somewhere in Japan and he burned his throat inside. Some complication arose and his throat was completely cut from inside; the passage had to be closed otherwise the man was going to die. The doctors fixed a pipe into his stomach so he had to chew the food, throw it into the pipe, and the pipe would take it into the stomach.

The man was surprised because he continued to enjoy his food as much as before. And even the doctors were surprised. They were at first feeling very sympathetic towards him because the poor man would no longer enjoy his food. But the man continued to enjoy it. In fact he started to enjoy it more because now he would chew it and if he did not want to take it into the stomach, he would simply throw it out. Now he could eat as much as he wanted. There was no need to take it into the stomach; the mouth and the stomach were completely separate.

So whenever you are eating, chew more, because the enjoyment is just above the throat. Below the throat there is no taste – nothing of the sort – so why be in a hurry? Just chew it more, taste it more. And to make this taste more intense, do all that can be done. When you are eating something, first smell it. Enjoy the smell of it because half the taste consists of smell.

Many experiments have been done. If your nose is completely closed and then something is given to you, you cannot taste it. Then you will

understand that the taste was more smell than taste. If your eyes are closed, you cannot taste it even that much, because the color, the appeal to the eyes, is no longer there. They have done beautiful experiments: eyes closed, nose completely closed, and then they give you something; you cannot even tell what it is. They may give you onion and you cannot say that it is onion because much depends on the smell. That's why when you have a cold you cannot enjoy food, because the smell is not there, the taste is not there. When people are suffering from a cold they start eating spicy food because only then can they feel a little tingling.

So smell the food, look at the food. There is no hurry...take time. Make it a meditation. Even if people think you have gone mad, don't be worried. Just look at it from all sides. Touch it with closed eyes, touch it with your cheek. Feel it in every way; smell it again and again. Then take a small bite and chew it, enjoy it; let it be a meditation. A very small quantity of food will be enough and will give you more satisfaction.

?I hate being overweight but can't lose any weight for very long in spite of all the diets I have tried....

You have a very perfectionistic idea about how the body should be, how you should be. You have a very clear-cut goal, and because of that clear-cut goal you fall short and you cannot accept yourself, you go on rejecting. And out of that rejection, you feel miserable.

Just destroy those goals and ideals: those ideals and goals that you are keeping in your mind of how things should be, how you should be. Drop them! And there is nothing missing, nothing is lacking; your energy can start flowing. Once you are in the moment, your body will start losing weight. It is continuous antagonism with the body that is making it fat, because when you are continuously against the body the body feels insecure, and out of insecurity it goes on eating.

It is like a child who cannot trust its mother. If the child cannot trust the mother, once he has the mother's breast he will not leave it because he cannot trust; he does not know when he will get the breast again. It is not

certain, he cannot remain secure in it – so he will grab. He will go on drinking as much as he can. He will stuff himself because the future is uncertain. When the child knows the mother loves him and knows the mother will be available – whenever she is needed she will be available – he does not bother to stuff himself. He can rest, he can eat as much as he needs in that moment, there is no need to hoard.

In fact fat is a hoarding; for some uncertain future one goes on hoarding. A man can live three months without food, one can gather that much fat. It is an old, ancient habit, biological. There were times, thousands of years back, when man was a hunter and the food was not certain. One day it was there, and in abundance, and for days together it was not there at all. Man carries that biological habit. That is associated with insecurity. Now there is no problem – at least not in America: you have enough food. For the first time society has enough food. Americans should not be fat at all. Indians can be allowed to be fat because the food is not certain.

What I am saying is that now food is available, good food, good nourishment, there is no physical need to eat more, but now psychological insecurity triggers the mechanism of the body, and the body starts feeling insecure. It knows only one way of how to avoid insecurity, and that is to eat more, to go on eating and stuff itself. It becomes an occupation.

Drop the ideals! There is nothing that you have to improve; you are perfectly beautiful as you are. And start living! Rather than thinking that you will live in the future when you are perfect, when you are like this, like that, you will live when you have attained a certain standard according to your mind.... But life is herenow and slipping out of the hands. Tomorrow there is death – only today there is life...it is always today.

Start living and start enjoying. The more you enjoy, the less you will eat. A really happy person does not eat much. It is out of misery, out of pain, out of emptiness, out of a meaninglessness that one wants to grab on to something – at least food, something.

The body has accumulated much wisdom, the body is very wise. If you eat too much the body says, “Stop!” The mind is not so wise. The mind says, “The taste is beautiful – a little more.” And if you listen to the mind, then the mind becomes destructive to the body, this way or that. If you listen to the mind, first it will say, “Go on eating,” because mind is foolish, a child. He does not know what he is saying. He is a new arrival, he has no learning. He is not wise, he is still a fool. Listen to the body. When the body says, “Hungry” – eat. When the body says, “Stop” – stop.

If you listen to the mind, it is as if a small child is leading an old man – they will both fall in a pit. If you listen to the mind, then first you will be in the senses too much; and then you will get fed up. And every sense will bring you misery, every sense will bring you more anxiety, conflict, pain. If you eat too much there will be pain and there will be vomiting, and the whole body will be disturbed. Then the mind says, “Eating is bad, so go on a fast.” And a fast is also dangerous. If you listen to the body it will never overeat, it will never undereat – it will simply follow the Tao.

A few scientists have been working on this problem and they have discovered a very beautiful phenomenon: small children eat whenever they feel hungry, they go to sleep whenever they feel that sleep is coming – they listen to their bodies. But parents disturb them, they go on forcing: “It is dinnertime, or lunchtime, or this and that, or sleeping-time – go!” They don’t allow their bodies. So one experimenter tried leaving children on their own. He was working with twentyfive children. They were not forced to go to sleep, they were not forced to get up. They were not forced at all for six months. And a very deep understanding came.

They slept well. They had less dreams – no nightmares, because nightmares were coming from the parents who were forcing them. They ate well, but never too much – never less than necessary, never more than necessary. They enjoyed eating and sometimes they would not eat at all. When the body was not feeling well they would not eat, and they never fell ill because of eating. And one more thing, which no one ever suspected, came to be

understood, and it was miraculous. Only Sosan can understand, or Lao Tzu or Chuang Tzu, because they are the masters of Tao. This was such a discovery: they came to understand that if a child was ill, then he would not eat particular foods. Then they tried to understand why he was not eating those foods. The foods were analyzed and it was found that for that disease, those foods were dangerous. How did the child decide? – just the body.

When the child was growing he would eat more of whatsoever was needed for his growth. Then they analyzed and they found that these ingredients were helpful and the food would change, because the needs changed. One day a child would eat something and the next day the same child would not eat it. And the scientists felt that there is a bodywisdom.

If you allow the body to have its say, you are moving on the right path, the great way. And this is so not only with food – this is so with the whole life. Your sex goes wrong because of your mind, your stomach goes wrong because of your mind. You interfere with the body. Don't interfere! Even if you can do it for three months – don't interfere, and suddenly you will become so healthy, and a well-being will descend on you.

? How does fasting help the body's well-being?

Whenever you are on a fast the body has no more work of digestion. In that period the body can work in throwing out dead cells, toxins. It is just as one day, Sunday or Saturday, you are on a holiday and you come home and you clean the whole day. The whole week you were so engaged and so busy you couldn't clean the house. When the body has nothing to digest, you have not eaten anything, the body starts a selfcleaning. A process starts spontaneously and the body starts throwing out all that is not needed, which is like a load. Fasting is a method of purification. Once in a while a fast is beautiful – not doing anything, not eating, just resting. Take as much liquid as possible and just rest, and the body will be cleaned.

Sometimes, if you feel that a longer fast is needed, you can do a longer fast also – but be deep in love with the body. And if you feel the fast is harming the body in any way, stop it. If the fast is helping the body, you will feel

more energetic; you will feel more alive; you will feel rejuvenated, vitalized. This should be the criterion: if you start feeling that you are getting weaker, if you start feeling that a subtle trembling is coming into the body, then be aware – now the thing is no longer a purification, it has become destructive. Stop it.

But one should learn the whole science of it. In fact one should do fasting near somebody who has been fasting for long and who knows the whole path very well, who knows all the symptoms: if it becomes destructive what will start happening; if it is not destructive then what will happen. After a real, purifying fast you will feel new, younger, cleaner, weightless, happier; and the body will be functioning better because now it is unloaded. But fasting comes only if you have been eating wrongly. If you have not been eating wrongly there is no need for fasting. Fasting is needed only when you have already done the wrong with the body – and we all have been eating wrongly.

I am not a believer in fasting, I believe in feasting. My whole approach is that of celebration. I am not against your pleasures – they are not all, one should go beyond them, but in themselves they are beautiful. A man should not deny anything, because the denied part will take revenge. The moment you start denying you go against Tao. Tao is to be natural – a feast and not a fast. A fast can be used only when it comes naturally.

Sometimes animals fast. Sometimes you may have observed your dog fasting: you put the food down and he will not eat. But he is not a Jaina, he is not a believer in fasting; he does not feel like eating. It is not a question of principle, it is not a philosophy. He is ill, his whole being is against eating – rather than eat, he would like to vomit. He will go and eat grass and vomit. He would like to relieve himself, his stomach is not in a condition to digest any more. But he is not a faster. It is natural.

So, if sometimes you feel that the fast comes naturally – not as a law, not as a principle, not as a philosophy to be followed, as a discipline to be

imposed, but out of your natural feel for it – good. Then, too, remember always that your fast is in the service of feasting, so that you can eat well again. The purpose of fasting is as a means, never as an end; and that will happen rarely, once in a while. And if you are perfectly aware while you are eating, and enjoying it, you will never eat too much.

My insistence is not on dieting but on awareness. Eat well, enjoy it tremendously. Remember, the rule is: if you don't enjoy your food you will have to eat more to compensate. If you enjoy your food you will eat less, there will be no need to compensate. If you eat slowly, tasting every bit of it, chewing well, you are completely absorbed in it. Eating should be a meditation.

I am not against taste because I am not against the senses. To be sensitive is to be intelligent, to be sensitive is to be alive. Your so-called religions have tried to de-sensitize you, to make you dull. They are against taste, they would like you to make your tongue absolutely dull so you don't taste anything. But that is not a state of health; the tongue becomes dull only in illness. When you have a fever, the tongue becomes dull. When you are healthy the tongue is sensitive, alive, throbbing, pulsates with energy. I am not against taste, I am for taste. Eat well, taste well; the taste is divine.

And so, exactly like taste, you have to look at beauty and enjoy; you have to listen to music and enjoy; you have to touch the rocks and leaves and human beings – the warmth, the texture – and enjoy. Use all your senses, use them to their optimum, then you will really live and your life will be aflame. It will not be dull, it will be aflame with energy and vitality. I am not for those people who have been teaching you to kill your senses; they are against the body.

And remember, the body is your temple, the body is a divine gift. It is so delicate and it is so beautiful and it is so wonderful – to kill it is to be ungrateful to God. God has given you taste; you have not created it, it is not anything to do with you. God has given you eyes and God has made this psychedelic world so colorful, and he has given you eyes. Let there be a

great communion between the eye and the color of the world.... Everything is in a tremendous harmony. Don't break this harmony.

These so-called *mahatmas* are just on ego-trips, and the best way to feel that you are great is to be against the body. Children do it. The child feels that the motion is coming; he holds it, he feels powerful because he feels his will: he will not yield to the body. His bladder is full and he holds it. He wants to show the body "I'm not your servant, I'm your master." But these are destructive habits.

Listen to the body. The body is not your enemy, and when the body is saying something, do accordingly, because the body has a wisdom of its own. Don't disturb it, don't go on a mind-trip. That's why I don't teach you any dieting, I teach you only awareness. Eat with full awareness, eat meditatively, and then you will never eat more and you will never eat less. More is as bad as less. Too much eating is bad, just like too much fasting; these are extremes. Nature wants you to be balanced, to be in a sort of equilibrium, to be in the middle, neither less nor more. Don't go to the extreme.

To go to the extreme is to be neurotic. So there are two types of neurotics about food: those who go on eating, not listening to the body – the body goes on crying and screaming "Stop!" and they go on. These are neurotic people. And then there is the other variety: the body goes on screaming "I am hungry!" and they are on a fast. Neither is religious, both are neurotic, both are pathological – they need treatment, they need to be hospitalized. A religious person is one who is balanced: in whatsoever he is doing, he is always in the middle. He never goes to the extreme because all extremes will create tensions, anxieties. When you eat too much there is anxiety because the body is burdened. When you don't eat enough then there is anxiety because the body is hungry. A religious person is one who knows where to stop; and that should come out of your awareness, not out of a certain teaching.

If I tell you how much to eat, that is going to be dangerous because that will be just an average. Somebody is very thin and somebody is very fat, and if I tell you how much to eat – “three *chappatis*” – then for somebody it may be too much and for somebody it may be nothing. So I don’t teach rigid rules, I simply give you a sense of awareness. Listen to your body: you have a different body. And then there are different types of energies, different types of involvement. Somebody is a professor in a university; he does not exert much energy as far as his body is concerned. He will not need much food, and he will need a different kind of food. Somebody is a laborer; he will need much food, and a different kind of food. Now a rigid principle is going to be dangerous. No rule can be given as a universal rule.

George Bernard Shaw has said that there is only one golden rule, that there are no golden rules. Remember it, there is no golden rule – there cannot be, because each individual is so unique that nobody can prescribe. So I simply give you a sense.... And my sense is not of principles, of laws; my approach is of awareness, because today you may need more food and tomorrow you may not need that much food. It is not only a question of you being different from others – every day of your life is different from every other day. The whole day you have rested, you may not need much food. The whole day you have been in the garden digging the hole, you may need much food. One should be just alert and one should be capable of listening to what the body is saying. Go according to the body.

Neither is the body the master, nor is the body the slave; the body is your friend – befriend your body. The one who goes on eating too much and the one who goes on dieting are both in the same trap. They are both deaf; they don’t listen to what the body is saying....

Eat for the joy of it; then you are man, human, a higher being. Love for the joy of love; then you are man, a higher being. Listen for the joy of listening and you will be freed from the confinement of instincts.

I am not against happiness, I am all for it. I am a hedonist, and this is my understanding: all the great spiritual people of the world have always been

hedonists. If somebody is not a hedonist and pretends to be a spiritual person, he is not – then he is a psychopath, because happiness is the very goal, the very source, the very end of all things. God is seeking happiness through you, in millions of forms. Allow him all the happiness that is possible and help him to go to higher peaks, higher reaches, of happiness. Then you are religious, and then your temples will become places of celebration and your churches will not be so sad and ugly, so somber, so dead, like graveyards. Then there will be laughter and there will be song and there will be dance and there will be great rejoicing.

Religion has suffered very much because of these people who have been teaching self-torture. Religion has to be freed from all this nonsense. Great rubbish has become attached to religion. The essential religion is nothing but joy. So whatsoever gives you joy is virtuous; whatsoever makes you sad, unhappy, miserable is a sin. Let that be the criterion.

And I don't give you rigid rules because I know how the human mind functions. Once a rigid rule is given, you forget awareness and you start following the rigid rule. A rigid rule is not the question – you can follow the rule and you will never grow.

Listen to a few anecdotes:

Benny arrived home to find the kitchen a mess of broken crockery.

“What happened?” he asked his wife.

“There's something wrong with this cookbook,” she explained. “It says that an old cup without a handle will do for the measuring – and it's taken me eleven tries to get a handle off without breaking the cup.”

Now if the cookbook says that, it has to be done. Human mind is foolish – remember it. Once you have a rigid rule, you follow it.

The mob was meeting the big guy, and what the big guy said, went. The buzzer rang and the servant went over to answer the door. He peeked through the slot in the frame, and, recognizing the visitor, allowed the panel to swing back.

“Leave your umbrella at the door,” the servant told the visitor.

“I ain’t got one,” answered the visitor.

“Then get back home and get one. The boss told me everyone must leave their umbrella at the door. Otherwise I am not going to allow you in.”

A rule is a rule....

It was a desperate chase but the police-car was catching up to the bank-robbers when suddenly it swerved into a gas station, from which point the cop driving phoned his chief.

“Did you catch them?” the chief asked excitedly.

“They were lucky,” replied the cop. “We were closing the gap, only half a mile away, when I noticed our five hundred miles were up and we had to stop and change our oil.”

What can you do when the oil has to be changed after each five hundred miles and five hundred miles are up? You have to change the oil first.

I never give you rigid rules because I know how stupid human mind is and can be. I simply give you a feel, a sense of direction. Be aware and live

through awareness.

Ordinarily you are living a very unconscious life. You eat too much because you are unconscious – you don't know what you are doing. You become jealous, you become possessive, because you are unconscious and you don't know what you are doing. You get mad in anger, you become almost possessed of the devil when you are in a rage, and you do things which you don't know that you are doing.

Jesus said on the cross – the last of his words, but of tremendous import – he said: “Father forgive these people because they don't know what they are doing.” Now Christianity has never interpreted these tremendous words rightly. Jesus' message is simple. He is saying: These people are unconscious people. They don't know awareness at all, so they cannot be responsible. Whatever they are doing, they are doing in sleep; they are somnambulists, sleep-walkers. Please forgive them. They cannot be held responsible.

So when you eat too much, I pray to God, “Father, forgive this man. He does not know what he is doing.” When you fast, I again have to pray to God, “Forgive this man because he does not know what he is doing.” The real question is not of doing but of bringing an awareness into your being, and that awareness will change everything. You are like drunkards.

I have heard: Mike told Pat he was going to a wake, and Pat offered to tag along. On the way Pat suggested a nip or two and they both got well sloshed. As a result Mike couldn't remember the address of the wake. “Where is your friend's house?” Pat asked.

“I forgot the number, but I'm sure this is the street.”

They had walked along for a few minutes when Mike squinted at a house that he thought was it. So they staggered in but the hall was dark. They opened the door and discovered a living room, which was also dark except for the faint glimmer of candles sitting on the piano. They went down in

front of the piano, knelt and prayed. Pat stopped long enough to look at the piano. “Mike,” he said “I don’t know your friend, but he sure had a fine set of teeth.”

This is the situation. This is how man is. The only thing that I would like to give to you is a taste of awareness. That will change your whole life. It is not a question of disciplining you, it is a question of making you luminous from within.

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15. PAIN

You are in pain – what is really happening inside? Analyze the whole phenomenon: the pain is there, and there is this consciousness that pain is there. These are the two points: the pain is there, and there is this *consciousness* that the pain is there. But there is no gap, and somehow, “I am in pain” – this feeling happens – “I am in pain.” And not only this – sooner or later, “I am the pain” begins, happens, starts to be the feeling.

“I *am* pain; I am *in* pain; I am *aware of* the pain” – these are three different, very different states. The witnessing consciousness says, “I am *aware of* the pain.” This much can be allowed, because then you transcend pain. The awareness transcends – you are different from the pain, and there is a deep separation. Really, there has never been any relation; the relation begins to appear only because of the nearness, because of the intimate nearness of your consciousness and all that happens around.

Consciousness is so near when you are in pain – it is just there by the side, very near. It has to be; otherwise, the pain cannot be cured. It has to be just near to feel it, to know it, to be aware about it. But because of this nearness, you become identified, and one. This is a safety measure again; this is a security measure, a natural security. When there is pain you must be near; when there is pain your consciousness *must* go in a rush towards the pain – to feel it, to do something about it.

You are on the street and suddenly you feel a snake there – then your whole consciousness just becomes a jump. No moment can be lost, not even in thinking what to do. There is no gap between being aware and the action. You must be very near; only then this can happen. When your body is suffering pain, disease, illness, you must be near; otherwise, life cannot survive. If you are far off and the pain is not felt, then you will die. The pain must be felt immediately – there should be no gap. The message must be

received immediately, and your consciousness must go to the spot to do something. That's why nearness is a necessity. But because of this necessity, the other phenomenon happens: so near, you become one; so near, you begin to feel, "This is me – this pain, this pleasure." Because of nearness there is identification: you become anger, you become love, you become pain, you become happiness.

There are two ways to disassociate yourself from these false identities. You are not what you have been thinking, feeling, imagining, projecting; what you are is simply the fact of being aware. Whatsoever happens, you remain just the awareness. You are awareness – that identity cannot be broken, that identity cannot be negated. All else can be negated and thrown; awareness remains the ultimate substratum, the ultimate base. You cannot deny it, you cannot negate it, you cannot disassociate yourself from it.

So this is the process: That which cannot be thrown, that which cannot be made separate from you, is you; that which can be separated, you are not. The pain is there; a moment later it may not be there – but you will be. Happiness has come, and it will go; it has been, and it will not be – but you will be. The body is young, then the body becomes old. All else comes and goes – guests come and go – but the host remains the same. So the Zen mystics say: Do not be lost in the crowd of the guests. Remember your host-ness. That host-ness is awareness. That host-ness is the witnessing consciousness. What is the basic element that remains always the same in you? Only be that, and disidentify yourself from all that comes and goes. But we become identified with the guest. Really the host is so occupied with the guest, he forgets.

Mulla Nasruddin has given a party for some friends and some strangers. The party is very boring, and half the night is just lost and it goes on. So one stranger, not knowing that Mulla is the host, says to him, "I have never seen such a party, such nonsense. It seems never-ending, and I am so bored that I would like to leave."

Mulla says, “You have said what I was going to say to you. I myself have never seen such a boring and nonsense party before, but I was not so courageous as you are. I was also thinking to leave it and just run away.” So they both run.

Then, in the street Mulla remembers and says, “Something has gone wrong, because now I remember: I am the host! So please excuse me, I have to go back.”

This is happening to us all. The host is lost, the host is forgotten every moment. The host is your witnessing self. Pain comes and pleasure follows; there is happiness, and there is misery. And each moment, whatsoever comes you are identified with it, you become the guest.

Remember the host. When the guest is there, remember the host. And there are so many types of guests: pleasurable, painful; guests you would like, guests you would not like to be your guests; guests you would like to live with, guests you would like to avoid – but all guests. Remember the host. Constantly remember the host. Be centered in the host. Remain in your host-ness; then there is a separation. Then there is a gap, an interval – the bridge is broken. The moment this bridge is broken, the phenomenon of renunciation happens. Then you are in it, and not of it. Then you are there in the guest, and still a host. You need not escape from the guest – there is no need.

You have been avoiding a thousand and one pains in your life. By avoiding you cannot destroy them – they go on accumulating. You go on swallowing your pains; they remain in your system. That’s why any kind of spiritual or psychological growth is painful – when you start growing, when you decide to grow, you have to face all the pains that you have repressed. You cannot just bypass them.

You have been brought up in a wrong way. Unfortunately, until now, not a single society has existed on the earth which has not been repressive of pain. All societies depend on repression. Two things they repress: one is pain, another is pleasure. And they repress pleasure also because of pain. Their reasoning is that if you are not too happy you will never become too unhappy; if joy is destroyed you will never be deep in pain. To avoid pain they avoid pleasure. To avoid death they avoid life.

And the logic has something in it. Both grow together – if you want to have a life of ecstasy you will have to accept many agonies. If you want the peaks of the Himalayas then you will also have the valleys. But nothing is wrong with the valleys; your approach just has to be different. You can enjoy both – the peak is beautiful, so is the valley. And there are moments when one should enjoy the peak and there are moments when one should relax in the valley.

The peak is sunlit, it is in a dialogue with the sky. The valley is dark, but whenever you want to relax you have to move into the darkness of the valley. If you want to have peaks you will need to grow roots into the valley – the deeper your roots go, the higher your tree will grow. The tree cannot grow without roots and the roots have to move deep into the soil.

Pain and pleasure are intrinsic parts of life. People are so much afraid of pain that they repress pain, they avoid any situation that brings pain, they go on dodging pain. And finally they stumble upon the fact that if you really want to avoid pain you will have to avoid pleasure. That's why your monks avoid pleasure – they are afraid of pleasure. In fact they are simply avoiding all possibilities of pain. They know that if you avoid pleasure then naturally great pain is not possible; it comes only as a shadow of pleasure. Then you walk on the plain ground – you never move on the peaks and you never fall into the valleys. But then you are living dead, then you are not alive.

Life exists between this polarity. This tension between pain and pleasure makes you capable of creating great music; music exists only in this tension. Destroy the polarity and you will be dull, you will be stale, you will

be dusty – you won't have any meaning and you will never know what splendor is. You will have missed life.

The man who wants to know life and live life has to accept and embrace death. They come together, they are two aspects of a single phenomenon. That's why growth is painful. You have to go into all those pains that you have been avoiding. It hurts. You have to go through all those wounds that somehow you have managed not to look at. But the deeper you go into pain, the deeper is your capacity to go into pleasure. If you can go into pain to the uttermost limit, you will be able to touch heaven.

I have heard: A man came to a Zen master and asked, "How shall we avoid heat and cold?"

Metaphorically, he is asking, "How should we avoid pleasure and pain?" That is the Zen way of talking about pleasure and pain: heat and cold. "How shall we avoid heat and cold?"

The master answered, "Be hot, be cold."

To be free of pain the pain has to be accepted, inevitably and naturally. Pain is pain – a simple painful fact – but suffering is only and always the refusal of pain, the claim that life should not be painful. It is the rejection of a fact, the denial of life and of the nature of things. Death is the mind and mind's dying. Where there is no fear of death, who is there to die?

Man is unique among creatures in his knowledge of death and in his laughter. Wonderfully then, he can even make of death a new thing: he can die laughing. It is only man who knows laughter; no other animal laughs. It is only man who knows death; no other animal knows death – animals simply die, they are not conscious of the phenomenon of death.

Man is aware of two things which no animal is: one is laughter, another is death. Then a new synthesis is possible. It is only man who can die laughing – he can join the consciousness of death and the capacity to laugh. And if you can die laughing, only then will you give a valid proof that you must have lived laughing. Death is the final statement of your whole life – the conclusion, the concluding remark. How you have lived will be shown by your death, how you die. Can you die laughing? Then you were a grown-up person. If you die crying, weeping, clinging, then you were a child. You were not grown-up, you were immature. If you die crying, weeping, clinging to life, that simply shows you have been avoiding death and you have been avoiding all pains, all kinds of pains.

Growth is facing the reality, encountering the fact, whatsoever it is.

And let me repeat: Pain is simply pain; there is no suffering in it. Suffering comes from your desire that the pain should not be there, that there is something wrong in pain. Watch, witness, and you will be surprised. You have a headache: the pain is there but suffering is not there. Suffering is a secondary phenomenon, pain is primary. The headache is there, the pain is there; it is simply a fact. There is no judgment about it. You don't call it good or bad, you don't give it any value; it is just a fact. The rose is a fact, so is the thorn. The day is a fact, so is the night. The head is a fact, so is the headache. You simply take note of it.

Buddha taught his disciples that when you have a headache simply say twice "Headache, headache." Take note. But don't evaluate, don't say "Why? Why has this headache happened to me? It should not happen to me." The moment you say, "It should not," you bring suffering in. Now suffering is created by you, not by the headache. Suffering is your antagonistic interpretation, suffering is your denial of the fact.

And the moment you say, "It should not be," you have started avoiding it, you have started turning yourself away from it. You would like to be occupied in something so that you can forget it. You turn the radio or the television on or you go to the club or you start reading or you go and start

working in the garden – you divert yourself, you distract yourself. Now that pain has not been witnessed; you have simply distracted yourself. That pain will be absorbed by the system.

Let this key be very deeply understood. If you can witness your headache without taking any antagonistic attitude, without avoiding it, without escaping from it; if you can just be there, meditatively there – “Headache, headache” – if you can just simply see it, the headache will go in its time. I am not saying that it will go miraculously, that just by your seeing it will go. It will go in its time. But it will not be absorbed by your system, it will not poison your system. It will be there, you will take note of it, and it will be gone. It will be released.

When you witness a certain thing in yourself it cannot enter into your system. It always enters when you avoid it, when you escape from it. When you become absent then it enters into your system. Only when you are absent can pain become part of your being – if you are present your very presence prevents it from becoming part of your being.

And if you can go on seeing your pains you will not be accumulating them. You have not been taught the right clue, so you go on avoiding. Then you accumulate so much pain, you are afraid to face it, you are afraid to accept it. Growth becomes painful – it is because of wrong conditioning. Otherwise growth is not painful, growth is utterly pleasant.

When the tree grows and becomes bigger do you think there is pain? There is no pain. Even when a child is born, if the mother accepts it there will be no pain. But the mother rejects it; the mother is afraid. She becomes tense, she tries to hold the child inside – which is not possible. The child is ready to go out into the world, the child is ready to leave the mother. He is ripe, the womb cannot contain him any more. If the womb contains him any more the mother will die and the child will die. But the mother is afraid. She has heard that it is very painful to give birth to a child – birth pangs, birth pain. She is afraid, and out of fear she becomes tense and closed.

Otherwise – in primitive societies those tribes still exist – childbirth is so simple, with no pain at all. On the contrary, you will be surprised, the greatest ecstasy happens to the woman in childbirth – not pain, not agony at all, but the greatest ecstasy. No sexual orgasm is so satisfying and so tremendous as the orgasm that happens to the woman when she gives birth to the child naturally. The whole sexual mechanism of the woman pulsates as it cannot pulsate in any lovemaking. The child is coming from the deepest core of the woman. No man can ever penetrate a woman to that core. And the pulsation arises from the inside. The pulsation is a must – that pulsation will come like waves, great tidal waves of joy. Only that will help the child to come out, only that will help the passage to open for the child. So there will be great pulsation and the whole sexual being of the woman will have tremendous joy. But what actually has happened to humanity is just the opposite: the woman comes to feel the greatest agony of her life. And this is a mind creation, this is wrong upbringing. The birth can be natural if you accept it.

And so it is with your birth. Growth means you are being born every day. Birth does not end the day you were born – on that day it simply starts, it is only a beginning. The day you left the womb of your mother you were not born, you *started* being born; that was just the beginning. And a man goes on being born till he dies. It is not that you are born in a single moment. Your birth process continues for seventy, eighty, ninety years, however long you live. It is a continuum. And every day you will feel joy – growing new leaves, new foliage, new flowers, new branches, rising higher and higher and touching new altitudes. You will be getting deeper, higher, you will be reaching to peaks. Growth will not be painful. But growth is painful – it is because of you, your wrong conditioning. You have been taught not to grow; you have been taught to remain static, you have been taught to cling to the familiar and the known. That's why each time the known disappears from your hands you start crying. A toy has been broken, a pacifier has been taken away....

Remember, only one thing is going to help you: awareness—nothing else. Growth will remain painful if you don't accept life in all its ups and downs.

The summer has to be accepted and the winter too. This is what I call meditation. Meditation is when you are emptied of all that is old and told and done to death. Then you see. Or rather, then there is seeing: the birth of the new.

Suffering is your interpretation. You have become too much identified with it. That is your decision. You can disidentify, and the suffering disappears. Your suffering is like a nightmare: in the dream you think a great rock has fallen on your chest, it is crushing you to death. Out of fear you awake...and all that you find is nothing – your own hands resting on your chest. But the weight of your hands triggered imagination in you: it became a rock, and you started feeling very, very frightened. And because of the fear, you are awakened... and now you laugh. Ask the buddhas, ask the awakened ones, and they say there is no suffering in the world – people are fast asleep and dreaming all kinds of sufferings.

But I know the difficulty: if you have a physical problem, if you are blind, how can you believe that this is only a dream? If you are crippled, how can you believe that this is only a dream? But have you not watched? – every night you dream, and every morning you know that it was a dream and all nonsense – and again you will dream, and in dream again you will believe that this is truth. How many dreams have you dreamed in your life? Millions of dreams! Each night you are dreaming almost without break; just for a few minutes the dreaming stops, and then again another cycle of dreaming starts.

Millions of dreams you have dreamed. And every morning you have laughed and you have said it was unreal, but you have not learnt much. Tonight again when you dream, the same fallacy will persist: you will know that this is truth – in dream you will know this is true. The day you can remember in your dream that this is a dream, immediately the dream disappears...because you have brought awareness into your life.

It looks very difficult to trust that all that you are suffering is just a dream created by yourself – but it is so, because all those who have become awakened say so. Not a single awakened person has said otherwise. And in lucid moments of awareness you will also feel the same. This is my suggestion for those who have some kind of serious disease or disability: your problem cannot be solved only by an intellectual discussion – your problem can be only dissolved, not solved. Your problem can only be dissolved by becoming more aware.

One of my friends, an old friend, fell from a staircase and broke both his legs. I went to see him; he was in tremendous pain. And he was a very active person although he was very old, seventy-five – but very active, almost young, and running so much after this and that, and doing this and that, that it was impossible for him to rest on the bed. And the doctors had said that for three months at least he had to be only in bed. This was more of a calamity than the two broken legs.

When I saw him, he started crying. I had never seen that man cry – he is a strong man, a very strong man, almost a man of steel, and has seen all kinds of things in his life, is a very seasoned man. I asked him, “You, and crying – what is the matter with you?”

He said, “Just bless me so that I can die. I don’t want to live anymore – three months just in bed! Can you imagine? This is torture. Just three days have passed and it feels almost as if for three years I have been in bed. You know me,” he said, “I cannot rest. Just bless me so that I can die soon! I don’t want to live anymore. These three months and then the doctors say I will remain crippled my whole life – so what is the point?”

I said to him, “You please do a meditation. I will sit by your side, you just do a simple meditation: that you are not the body.”

He was dubious. He said, “What is that going to do to me? I have heard all that you say about meditation, but I cannot meditate because I cannot sit silently.”

I said, “Now there is no question of sitting silently – you are already in the bed. This is a blessing! Just close your eyes and I will teach you a meditation. And I bless you to die, because if you want to die then perfectly good. But my blessing may work, may not work, so meanwhile you meditate.”

He understood the point: “There is nothing to do... so why not meditate?” A simple meditation I told him: “You simply go in, look at the body from the inside, say ‘It is not me – the body is far away, far away, going distant and more distant and more distant. I am a watcher on the hills, and the body is down there in the dark valley, and the distance is immense.’”

Half an hour passed. I had to leave, and he was in such a meditation that I didn’t want to disturb him, but I didn’t want to leave him either because I wanted to know what was happening, what he would say. So I had to shake him. He said, “Don’t disturb me!”

I said, “But I have to leave.”

He said, “You can leave, but don’t disturb me – it is so beautiful. The body is really lying so far away, miles and miles away; I have left it in the valley and I am sitting on the top of the hill, a sunlit hill. It is so beautiful, and I don’t feel any pain either.” And those three months proved the most valuable time of his life. Those three months made him a totally different man. He is still crippled, cannot walk, has to remain mostly in the bed – but you cannot find a more blissful person. He radiates bliss. Now he says it was not a curse – it was a blessing.

Suffering can be transformed into a blessing. Who knows ? – you might be transforming your blessings into sufferings.

If you have a headache, doctors will give you aspirin. Aspirin is not a cure, it simply makes you unaware of the symptom. The aspirin does not destroy

the headache; it simply does not allow you to know about it. It confuses you. The headache remains there but you are no longer aware of it. It creates a kind of oblivion.

But why in the first place was the headache there? Ordinary medicine does not bother about it. If you go to a doctor he is not going to be bothered why in the first place you have a headache. You have a headache! – the problem is simple for him: “The symptom is there, take this medicine – some drug, some chemical – and that symptom will disappear.” The headache may disappear and you may have a disturbed stomach the next day; another symptom has come up.

Man is one; man is a totality – an organic unity. You can push a problem from one side, it will assert itself from another side. It may take time to come to the other side, to travel to that point, but it is bound to come. And then pushed from that side it moves to another side ... and man has many sides. It goes on being pushed from one corner to another.

Out of all this you become more and more ill rather than healthy. And sometimes it happens that a very small disease becomes a big disease. For example, if the headache is not allowed, and the stomachache is not allowed, and the backache is not allowed, and *no* ache is ever allowed, immediately the ache comes and you take something and you stop it.... If for years together you have gone on with this repression – this is repression – then one day all that disease gathers together, asserts itself in a more organized way. It can become cancer. All that has gathered together and now it asserts itself almost like an explosion.

Why have we not yet been able to find a drug for cancer? Maybe cancer is an expression of all the repressed diseases of man. We know how to repress single diseases up to now; now this is not a single disease, this is a very collective attack. It is a total attack – *all* the diseases have gone together, joined hands together. They have made an army ... and they attack you. That's why drugs are failing; there seems to be no possibility right now that any drug will be found.

Cancer is a new disease. It does not exist in primitive societies. Why? – it has to be asked why it does not exist in primitive societies – because the primitive man does not repress, there is no need. It is a *rebellion* of your very system. If you don't repress, there is no need for any rebellion. Small things happen and go.

The religious attitude is to look, not for the symptom but for the source. That's what I call "the psychology of the buddhas." If you have a headache, that is not your illness, that is not your disease. In fact, that is a signal from your body that something is going wrong in the source – run to the source! Find out what is going wrong. The head is simply giving you a signal, a danger signal, an alarm: "Listen to the body. Something is going wrong, you are doing something which is not right, which is destroying the harmony of the body. Don't do it anymore; otherwise the headache will go on reminding you."

The headache is not the disease, and the headache is not your enemy – it is your friend. It is in your service. It is very, very essential for your existence that the body should make you alert when something goes wrong. Rather than changing that wrong, you simply put the alarm off – you take an aspirin. This is absurd. This is what is happening in medicine and this is what is happening in psychotherapies – symptomatic treatment.

That's why the essential is missing. The essential is: look into the source. Next time you have a headache try a small meditation technique, just experimentally, then you can go on to bigger diseases and bigger symptoms.

When you have a headache just try a small experiment. Sit silently and watch it, look into it – not as if you are looking at an enemy, no. If you are looking at it as your enemy, you will not be able to look rightly. You will avoid – nobody looks at the enemy directly; one avoids, one tends to avoid. Look at it as your friend. It is your friend, it is in your service. It is saying, "Something is wrong – look into it." Just sit silently and look into the

headache with no idea of stopping it, with no desire that it should disappear, no conflict, no fight, no antagonism. Just look into it, into what it is.

Watch, so if there is some inner message the headache can give it to you. It has a coded message. And if you look silently you will be surprised. If you look silently three things will happen. First: the more you look into it, the more severe it will become. And then you will be a little puzzled: “How is it going to help if it is becoming more severe?” It is becoming more severe because you have been avoiding it. It was there but you were avoiding it; you were already repressing – even without the aspirin you were repressing it. When you look into it, repression disappears. The headache will come to its natural severity. Then you are hearing it with unplugged ears, no wool around your ears; it will be very severe.

First thing: it will become severe. If it is becoming severe, you can be satisfied that you are looking rightly. If it does not become severe, then you are not looking yet; you are still avoiding. Look into it – it becomes severe. That is the first indication that yes, it is in your vision.

The second thing will be that it will become more pinpointed; it will not be spread over a bigger space. First you were thinking, “It is my whole head aching.” Now you will see it is not the whole head, it is just a small spot. That is also an indication that now you are gazing more deeply into it. The spread feeling of the ache is a trick – that is a way to avoid it. If it is in one point then it will be more severe. So you create an illusion that it is the whole head which is aching, spread all over the head, then it is not so intense at any point. These are tricks that we go on playing.

Look into it, and the second step will be that it comes to be smaller and smaller and smaller. And a moment comes when it is just the very point of a needle – very sharp, immensely sharp, very painful. You have never seen such pain in the head – but very much confined to a small spot. Go on looking into it.

And then the third and most important thing happens. If you go on looking at this point when it is very severe and confined and concentrated at one point, you will see many times that it disappears. When your gaze is perfect it will disappear. And when it disappears you will have the glimpse of where it is coming from – what the cause is. It will happen many times. Again it will be there. Your gaze is no longer that alert, that concentrated, that attentive – it will come back. Whenever your gaze is *really* there, it will disappear; and when it disappears, hidden behind it is the cause. And you will be surprised: your mind is ready to reveal what the cause is.

A thousand and one causes there can be. There are different causes. The same alarm is given because the alarm system is simple. There are not many alarm systems in your body. For different causes the same alarm is given. You may have been angry lately and you have not expressed it. Suddenly, like a revelation, it will be standing there. You will see all your anger that you have been carrying, carrying ... like pus inside you. Now this is too much, and that anger wants to be released. It needs a catharsis. Cathart! – and immediately you will see the headache has disappeared. And there was no need for the aspirin, no need for any treatment.*

And when the anger has disappeared, a totally different quality of well-being will arise in you that can never arise out of the aspirin. Aspirin represses – anger remains hidden inside you, violence goes on raging inside you. You only keep the alarm shut, that's all. Nothing changes, only the alarm is no longer there.

This goes on and on, and it becomes more and more accumulated. It may give you ulcers, it may give you tuberculosis – one day it can give you cancer. When a great quantity gathers, there are qualitative changes. There is a certain limit for the body to tolerate anything, beyond that limit it starts feeling ill. So is the case with mind. And never think of body and mind as two separate things; they are not. Man is body-mind, psychosomatic.

*

OSHO DYNAMIC MEDITATION

Osho has developed a number of meditation techniques to help in catharsis. Perhaps the best known is his Dynamic Meditation. The Dynamic Meditation lasts one hour and is in five stages. Music is available to support each of the five stages, and to serve as a guide for those who are doing the meditation. It can be done alone, but the energy will be more powerful if it is done in a group. It is an individual and inner experience, so you should remain oblivious of others around you and keep your eyes closed throughout, preferably using a blindfold. It is best to have an empty stomach and wear loose, comfortable clothing.

First stage: 10 minutes

Breathing rapidly in and out through the nose, let breathing be intense and chaotic. The breath should move deeply into the lungs. Be as fast as you can in your breathing, making sure breathing stays deep. Do this as totally as you possibly can; without tightening up your body, make sure neck and shoulders stay relaxed. Continue on, until you literally become the breathing, allowing breath to be chaotic (that means not in a steady, predictable way). Once your energy is moving, it will begin to move your body. Allow these body movements to be there, use them to help you build up even more energy. Moving your arms and body in a natural way will help your energy to rise. Feel your energy building up; don't let go during the first stage and never slow down.

Second stage: 10 minutes

Follow your body. Give your body freedom to express whatever is there EXPLODE! Let your body take over. Let go of everything that needs to be thrown out. Go totally mad.... Sing, scream, laugh, shout, cry, jump, shake, dance, kick, and throw yourself around. Hold nothing back, keep

your whole body moving. A little acting often helps to get you started. Never allow your mind to interfere with what is happening. Remember to be total with your body.

Third stage: 10 minutes

Leaving your shoulders and neck relaxed, raise both arms as high as you can without locking the elbows. With raised arms, jump up and down shouting the mantra HOO! ...HOO !...HOO! as deeply as possible, coming from the bottom of your belly. Each time you land on the flats of your feet (making sure heels touch the ground), let the sound hammer deep into the sex center. Give all you have, exhaust yourself completely.

Fourth stage: 15 minutes

STOP! Freeze where you are in whatever position you find yourself. Don't arrange the body in any way. A cough, a movement, anything will dissipate the energy flow and the effort will be lost. Be a witness to everything that is happening to you.

Fifth stage: 15 minutes

Celebrate!... with music and dance express whatsoever is there. Carry your aliveness with you throughout the day.

[Instructions developed for use at Osho Commune International, Pune, India. For more information see the back of the book.]

Osho himself has said this about Dynamic Meditation:

Remain a witness. Don't get lost. It is easy to get lost. While you are breathing you can forget. You can become one with the breathing so much

that you can forget the witness. But then you miss the point. Breathe as fast, as deep as possible, bring your total energy to it, but still remain a witness. Observe what is happening, as if you are just a spectator, as if the whole thing is happening to somebody else, as if the whole thing is happening in the body and the consciousness is just centered and looking. This witnessing has to be carried in all the three steps. And when everything stops, and in the fourth step you have become completely inactive, frozen, then this alertness will come to its peak.

This is a meditation in which you have to be continuously alert, conscious, aware, whatsoever you do. If you feel pain, be attentive to it, don't do anything. Attention is the great sword – it cuts everything. You simply pay attention to the pain.

For example, you are sitting silently in the last part of the meditation, unmoving, and you feel many problems in the body. You feel that the leg is going dead, there is some itching in the hand, you feel that ants are creeping on the body. Many times you have looked and there are no ants. The creeping is inside, not outside. What should you do? You feel the leg is going dead? – be watchful, just give your total attention to it. You feel itching? – don't scratch. That will not help. You just give your attention. Don't even open your eyes. Just give your attention inwardly, and just wait and watch. Within seconds, the itching will have disappeared. Whatsoever happens – even if you feel pain, severe pain in the stomach or in the head. It happens because in meditation the whole body changes. It changes its chemistry. New things start happening and the body is in a chaos. Sometimes the stomach will be affected, because in the stomach you have suppressed many emotions, and they are all stirred. Sometimes you will feel like vomiting, nauseous. Sometimes you will feel a severe pain in the head because the meditation is changing the inner structure of your brain. Passing through meditation, you are really in a chaos. Soon, things will settle. But for the time being, everything will be unsettled.

So what are you to do? You simply see the pain in the head, watch it. You be a watcher. You just forget that you are a doer, and by and by, everything

will subside, and will subside so beautifully and so gracefully that you cannot believe unless you know it. Not only does the pain disappear from the head – because the energy which was creating pain, if watched, disappears – the same energy becomes pleasure. The energy is the same.

Pain or pleasure are two dimensions of the same energy. If you can remain silently sitting and paying attention to distractions, all distractions disappear. And when all distractions disappear, you will suddenly become aware that the whole body has disappeared.

Editor's note: Osho has warned against turning this witnessing approach to pain into another fanaticism. If unpleasant physical symptoms – aches and pains or nausea – persist beyond three or four days of daily meditation, there is no need to be a masochist – seek medical advice. This applies to all OSHO meditation techniques.

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16. SLEEP

In sleep we reach the same place we do in meditation. The only difference is that in sleep we are unconscious, while in meditation we are fully conscious. If someone were to become fully aware, even in his sleep, he would have the same experience as in meditation.

For example, if we were to put a person under anesthetic, and in his unconscious state bring him on a stretcher to a garden where flowers are in full bloom, where fragrance is in the air, where the sun is shining and the birds are singing, the man would be completely unaware of all this. After we brought him back and he was out of the anesthesia, if we asked him how he liked the garden, he would not be able to tell us anything. Then, if you were to take him to the same garden when he was fully conscious, he would experience everything present there when he had been brought in before. In both cases, although the man was brought to the same place...he was unaware of the beautiful surroundings in the first instance, while in the second instance he would be fully aware of the flowers, the fragrance, the song of the birds, the rising sun. So, although you will undoubtedly reach as far in an unconscious state, to reach some place in an unconscious state is as good as not reaching there at all.

In sleep, we reach the same paradise we reach in meditation, but we are unaware of it. Each night we travel to this paradise, and then we come back – unaware. Although the fresh breeze and the lovely fragrance of the place touch us, and the songs of the birds ring in our ears, we are never aware of it. And yet, in spite of returning from this paradise totally unaware of it, one might say, “I feel very good this morning. I feel very peaceful – I slept well last night.”

What do you feel so good about? Having slept well, what good happened? It cannot be only because you slept, surely you must have been somewhere;

something must have happened to you. But in the morning you have no knowledge of it, except for a vague idea of feeling good. One who has had a deep sleep at night gets up refreshed in the morning.

This shows the person has reached a rejuvenating source in sleep – but in an unconscious state. One who is unable to sleep well at night finds himself more tired in the morning than he was the previous evening. And if a person does not sleep well for a few days it becomes difficult for him to survive, because his connection with the source of life is broken. He is unable to reach the place it is essential he should....

In New York, at least thirty percent of the people cannot sleep without tranquilizers. Psychologists believe that if this condition prevails for the next hundred years, not a single person will be able to sleep without medication. People have completely lost sleep. If a man who has lost sleep were to ask you how you go to sleep, and your answer were, "All I do is put my head on the pillow and fall asleep," he will not believe you. He will find this impossible and suspect there must be some trick he doesn't know to it – because he lays his head on the pillow too, and nothing happens.

God forbid, but a time may come, after a thousand or two thousand years, when everyone will have lost natural sleep, and people will refuse to believe that, a thousand or two thousand years before their time, people simply rested their heads on their pillows and fell asleep. They will take this as fiction, a mythical story from the *ancient past*. They will not believe it to be true. They will say, "This is not possible, because if that isn't true about us, how can it be true about anyone else?"

I am drawing your attention to all of this because three or four thousand years ago people would close their eyes and go into meditation as easily as you go to sleep today. Two thousand years from now it will be difficult to sleep in New York – it is difficult even today. It is becoming difficult to sleep in Bombay – it is just a matter of time. Today it is hard to believe there was a time when a man could close his eyes and go into meditation –

because now, when you sit with your eyes closed, you reach nowhere; inside, thoughts keep hovering around and you remain where you are.

In the past, meditation was as easy for those who were close to nature as sleep is for those who live close to nature. First meditation disappeared; now sleep is on its way out. Those things are first lost which are conscious; after that, those things are lost which are unconscious. With the disappearance of meditation the world has almost become irreligious, and when sleep disappears the world will become totally irreligious. There is no hope for religion in a sleepless world.

You will not believe how closely, how deeply, we are connected to sleep. How a person will live his life depends totally on how he sleeps. If he does not sleep well, his entire life will be a chaos: all his relationships will become entangled, everything will become poisonous, filled with rage. If, on the contrary, a person sleeps deeply, there will be freshness in his life – peace and joy will continuously flow in his life. Underlying his relationships, his love, everything else, there will be serenity. But if he loses sleep, all his relationships will go haywire. He will have messed up life with his family, his wife, his son, his mother, his father, his teacher, his students – all of them. Sleep brings us to a point in our unconscious where we are immersed in God – although not for too long. Even the healthiest person only reaches to his deeper level for ten minutes of his nightly eight hours' sleep. For these ten minutes he is so completely lost, drowned in sleep, that not even a dream exists.

Sleep is not total as long as one is dreaming – one keeps moving between the states of sleep and wakefulness. Dreaming is a state in which one is half-asleep and halfawake. To be in a dream means, even though your eyes are closed, you are not asleep; external influences are still affecting you. The people you met during the day, you are still with them at night in your dreams. Dreams occupy the middle state between sleep and wakefulness. And that you don't remember in the morning that you dreamed all night is beside the point. Much research on sleep is being carried out in America.

Some ten big laboratories have been experimenting on thousands of people for about eight to ten years.

Americans are showing interest in meditation because they have lost sleep. They think that perhaps meditation may bring their sleep back, that it may bring some peace into their lives. That's why they look upon meditation as nothing more than a tranquilizer. When Vivekananda first introduced meditation in America, a physician came to him and said, "I enjoyed your meditation immensely. It is absolutely a non-medicinal tranquilizer. It's not a medicine and yet it puts one to sleep – it's great." Yogis are not the reason their influence is growing so much in America – the lack of sleep is the real cause. People's sleep is in a mess, and consequently life in America is filled with heaviness, depression, tension. And so in America we see the growing need for tranquilizers – somehow, to bring sleep to people.

Each year, millions of dollars are being spent on tranquilizers in America. Ten big laboratories are conducting research on thousands of people who are being paid to undergo nights of rather uncomfortable, painful sleep. All kinds of electrodes and thousands of wires are attached to people's bodies, and they are examined from all angles to find out what is happening inside them. One incredible discovery these experiments have revealed is that man dreams almost the whole night. Waking up, some people said they didn't dream, while some said they did. But in fact, all of them dreamed. The only difference was that those with better memories remembered dreaming, while those with weaker memories could not recall dreaming. But it was found that a completely healthy person was able to slip into a deep, dreamless sleep for ten minutes.

Dreams can be scanned through machines. Nerves in the brain remain active during our dreaming state, but as the dream stops, the nerves cease to be active as well, and the machine indicates a gap has occurred. The gap shows that, at that time, the man was neither dreaming nor thinking – he was lost somewhere.

It is interesting that the machines keep recording movement inside the man while he is in the dreaming state, but as soon as he falls into dreamless sleep, the machine shows a gap. They don't know where the man disappeared in that gap. So, dreamless sleep means the man has reached a place beyond the machine's range. It is in this gap that man enters the divine. The machine is unable to detect this space in between, this gap. The machine records the internal activity as long as the man is dreaming – then comes the gap and the man disappears somewhere. And then, after ten minutes, the machine starts recording again. It is difficult to say where the man was during that ten-minute interval. American psychologists are very intrigued by this gap; hence they consider sleep the biggest mystery.

You sleep every day, yet you have no idea what sleep is. A man sleeps all through his life, and yet nothing changes – he knows nothing about sleep. The reason you don't know anything about sleep is that when sleep is there, *you* are not. Remember, you *are* only as long as sleep is not, and so you come to know only as much as the machine knows. Just as in the face of the gap the machine stops and is unable to reach where the man has been transported, you cannot reach there either – because you are no more than a machine as well.

Since you do not come across the gap either, sleep remains a mystery; it remains beyond your reach. This is so because a man falls into wakeless sleep only when he ceases to exist in his 'I-am-ness'. And therefore, as the ego keeps growing, sleep becomes less and less. An egoistic person loses his capacity to sleep because his ego, the 'I', keeps asserting itself twenty-four hours a day. It is the 'I' that wakes up, the same 'I' that walks on the street. The 'I' remains so present the entire twenty-four hours that at the moment of falling asleep, when the time approaches to drop the 'I', one is unable to get rid of it. Obviously, it becomes difficult to fall asleep. As long as the 'I' exists, sleep is impossible. And as long as the 'I' exists, entering into existence is impossible.

Entering into sleep and entering into existence are exactly one and the same thing; the only difference is that through sleep one enters into existence in

an unconscious state, while through meditation one enters into existence in a conscious state. But this is a very big difference. You may enter existence through sleep for thousands of lives, yet you will never come to know existence. But if, even for a moment, you enter meditation you will have reached the same place you have reached in deep sleep for thousands and millions of lives – although always in an unconscious state – and it will transform your life totally.

The interesting thing is, once a person enters meditation, enters the emptiness where deep sleep takes him, he never remains unconscious – even when he is asleep.

Ananda lived with Buddha for many years, for years he slept near Buddha. One morning he asked Buddha, “For years I have been watching you sleep. Not once do you ever change sides; you sleep the whole night in the same position. Your limbs stay where they were when you laid down at night; there is not the slightest movement. Many times I have got up at night to check whether you have moved. I have stayed up nights watching you – your hands, your feet, rest in the same position; you never ever change sides. Do you keep some kind of a record of your sleep the whole night?”

“I don’t need to keep any record,” Buddha replied. “I sleep in a conscious state, so I find no need to change sides. I can if I want to. Turning from one side to another is not a requirement of sleep, it’s a requirement of your restless mind.” A restless mind cannot even rest in one place for a single night, let alone during the day. Even sleeping at night, the whole time the body shows its restlessness.

If you watch a person asleep at night you will see he is continuously restless the whole time. You will find him moving his hands in much the same way he does when he is awake during the day. In his dream at night, you will find him running and panting in much the same way it happens with someone during the day – he feels out of breath, tired. At night, in dreams, he fights in much the same way he fights during the day. He is filled with passion during the day, at night as well. There is no fundamental difference

between the day and the night of such a person, except that at night he lies down exhausted, unconscious; everything else continues to function as usual. So Buddha said, “I can change sides if I want to, but there is no need.”

But we don't realize.... A man sitting in a chair keeps jiggling his legs. Ask him, “Why are your legs jiggling like that? It's understandable if they move when you walk, but why are they moving when you are sitting in a chair?” No sooner do you say this than the man will stop immediately. Then he won't even move for a second, but he will have no explanation as to why he was doing it. It shows how restlessness within causes agitation in the entire body. Inside is the restless mind; it cannot be still, in one position, even for a moment. It will keep the whole body fidgeting: the legs will move, the head will shake; even sitting the body will change sides.

That's why, even for ten minutes, you find it so difficult to sit still in meditation. And from a thousand different spots the body urges you to twitch and turn. We do not notice this until we sit with awareness in meditation. We realize then what sort of a body this is; it doesn't want to remain still in one position even for a second. The confusion, the tension, and the excitement of the mind stir up the entire body.

For about ten minutes everything disappears in wakeless sleep – although these ten minutes are available only to one who is completely healthy and peaceful, not to everyone. Others get this kind of sleep anywhere from one to five minutes; most people get only two, or one minute of deep sleep. The little juice we receive in that one minute of reaching to the source of life we apply to making our next twenty-four hours work. Whatever little amount of oil the lamp receives in that short period, we utilize it to carry on our lives for a full twenty-four hours. The lamp of one's life burns on whatsoever amount of oil it receives then. This is the reason the lamp burns so slow – not enough oil is collected to make the lamp of life burn brightly, so it can become a flaming torch.

Meditation brings you slowly to the source of life. Then it is not that you keep taking a handful of nourishment out of it, you are simply *in* the source itself. Then it is not that you refill your lamp with more oil – then the entire ocean of oil becomes available to you. Then you begin to live in that very ocean. With that kind of living, sleep disappears – not in the sense that one doesn't sleep anymore but in the sense that even when one is asleep, someone within remains wide awake. Then dreams no longer exist. A yogi stays awake, he sleeps, but he never dreams – his dreams disappear totally. And when dreams disappear, thoughts disappear. What we know as thoughts in the wakeful state are called dreams in the sleeping state. There is only a slight difference between thoughts and dreams: thoughts are slightly more civilized dreams, while dreams are a little primitive in nature. Of the two, one is the original thought.

In fact, children, or the aboriginal tribes, can think only in pictures, not in words. Man's first thoughts are always in pictures. For example, when a child is hungry he does not think in words, "I am hungry." A child can visualize the mother's breast; he can imagine himself sucking the breast. He can be filled with the desire to go to the breast, but he cannot form the words. The word formation starts much later; pictures appear first....

The language of words is handy during the day, but it is not useful at night. We again become primitive at night. We disappear in sleep as we are. We lose our degrees, university educations, everything. We are transported to a point where the original man once stood. That's why pictures emerge at night in sleep, and words appear during the day. If we want to make love during the day, we can think in terms of words, but at night there is no way to express love except through images.

Thoughts do not seem as alive as dreams. In dreams the whole image appears before you. That's why we enjoy watching a movie based on a novel more than reading the novel itself. The only reason for this is that the novel is in the language of words, while the movie is in the language of images. In the same manner, you feel greater joy being here and listening to me live. You would not feel the same joy listening to this talk on a tape,

because here the image is present, on tape there are only words. The language of images is nearer to us, more natural. At night words turn into pictures; that's the difference there is.

The daydreams disappear, thoughts disappear too; the day thoughts disappear, dreams disappear as well. If the day is empty of thoughts, the night will be empty of dreams. And remember, dreams don't allow you to sleep, and thoughts don't allow you to sleep, and thoughts don't allow you to awaken. Make sure you understand both things: dreams do not let you sleep, and thoughts do not let you awaken. If dreams disappear, sleep will be total; if thoughts disappear, awakening will be total. If the awakening is total and the sleep is total, then not much difference exists between the two. The only difference is in keeping the eyes open or closed, and in the body being at work or at rest. One who is totally awakened sleeps totally, but in both states his consciousness remains exactly the same. Consciousness is one, unchangeable; only the body changes. Awake, the body is at work; asleep, the body is at rest.

A friend has asked why God is not attained in sleep. My answer is: he can be attained if you can remain awake even in your sleep. And so my method of meditation is a sleeping method – sleeping in awareness, entering into sleep with awareness. That's why I ask you to relax your body, to relax your breathing, to calm down your thoughts. All this is a preparation for sleep. Therefore, it so often happens that some friends go to sleep during meditation – obviously; this is a preparation for sleep. And, while preparing for it, they don't know when they go to sleep. That's why I repeat the third suggestion: stay awake inside, remain conscious within; let the body be totally relaxed, let the breathing be totally relaxed, more relaxed than it normally is while sleeping. But stay awake within. Within, let your awareness burn like a lamp so you don't fall asleep.

The initial conditions of meditation and sleep are the same, but there is a difference in the final condition. The first condition is that the body should be relaxed. If you suffer from insomnia, the first thing a doctor will teach you is relaxation. He will ask you to do the same thing I am asking: relax

your body, don't let any tension remain in your body; let your body be totally loose, just like cotton fluff. Have you ever noticed how a dog or a cat sleeps? They sleep as if they are not. Have you ever noticed a baby sleeping? There is no tension anywhere – its arms and legs remain unbelievably loose. Watch a youth and an old man – you will find everything tense in them. So the doctor would ask them to relax.

The same condition applies to sleep: the breathing should be relaxed, deep and slow. You must have noticed that while jogging, the breathing becomes faster. Similarly, when the body exerts itself at work, the breathing becomes faster and the blood circulation increases. For sleeping, the blood circulation should slow down – the situation should be just the opposite to jogging – and then the breathing will relax. So the second condition is: relax your breathing....

So the conditions for meditation are primarily the same as those applicable to sleep: relax your body, relax your breathing, let go of thoughts. And so, for sleep as well as for meditation, the initial conditions are equally true. The difference is in the final condition. In the former you remain in deep sleep; in meditation you remain fully awake – that's all.

So there is a deep relationship between sleep and meditation. However, there is one very significant difference between the two: the difference between a conscious and an unconscious state. Sleep is unawareness, meditation is awakening.

When you are just falling into sleep at night, just ready to fall into sleep, go backwards through the memories of the whole day – *backwards*. Do not start from the morning. Start right from where you are, just on the bed – the last item, and then go back. Then go back by and by, step by step, just to the first experience in the morning when you first became awake. Go back, and remember continuously that you are not getting involved.

For example, in the afternoon someone insulted you. See yourself, the form of yourself, being insulted by someone – but you remain just an observer. Do not get involved; do not get angry again. If you get angry again, then you are identified. Then you have missed the point of meditation. Do not get angry. He is not insulting *you*, he is insulting the form that was in the afternoon. That form has gone now.

You are just like a river flowing: the forms are flowing. In the childhood you had one form, now you do not have that form. That form has gone. River-like, you are changing continuously. So when in the night you are meditating backwards on the happenings of the day, just remember that you are a witness: do not get angry. Someone was praising you: do not get elated. Just look at the whole thing as if you are looking indifferently at a film. And backwards is very helpful – particularly for those who have any trouble with sleep.

If you have any trouble with sleep, insomnia, sleeplessness, if you find it difficult to fall into sleep, this will help deeply. Why? Because this is an unwinding of the mind. When you go back you are unwinding the mind. In the morning you start winding, and the mind becomes tangled in many things, in many places. Unfinished and incomplete, many things will remain on the mind, and there is no time to let them settle at the very moment that they happen.

So in the night go back. This is an unwinding process. And when you will be getting back to the morning when you were just on your bed, to the first thing in the morning, you will again have the same fresh mind that you had in the morning. And then you can fall asleep like a very small child....

So many persons suffer a particular disease, and nothing physiological, nothing medical helps; the disease continues. The disease seems to be psychological. What to do about it? To say to someone that his disease is psychological is no help. Rather, it may prove harmful because no one feels good when you say his disease is psychological. What can he do then? He feels he is helpless.

This going backwards is a miraculous method. If you go back slowly – slowly unwinding the mind to the first moment when this disease happened, if by and by you go back to when for the first time you were attacked by the disease, if you can unwind to that moment, you will come to know that this disease is basically a complex of certain other things, certain psychological things. By going back those things will bubble up.

If you pass through that moment when the disease first attacked you, suddenly you will become aware of what psychological factors contributed to it. And you are not to do anything: you are just to be aware of those psychological factors and go on backwards. Many diseases simply disappear from you because the complex is broken. When you have become aware of the complex, then there is no need of it. You are cleaned of it – purged.

This is a deep catharsis. And if you can do it daily, you will feel a new health, a new freshness coming to you. And if we can teach children to do it daily, they will never be burdened by their past. They will not need ever to go to the past. They will be always here and now. There won't be any hang up; nothing will be hovering over them from the past.

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17. AGING

The Western mind is conditioned by the idea that you have only one life – seventy years – and youth will never come again. In the West, the spring comes only once; naturally, there is a deep desire to cling as long as possible, to pretend in every possible way that you are still young.

In the East the older person was always valued, respected. He was more experienced, he had seen many, many seasons coming and going; he had lived through all kinds of experiences, good and bad. He had become seasoned; he was no longer immature. He had a certain integrity that comes only with age. He was not childish, carrying his teddy bears; he was not young, still fooling around thinking that this was love.

He had passed through all these experiences, had seen that beauty fades; he had seen that everything comes to an end, that everything is moving towards the grave. From the very moment he left the cradle, there was only one way – and it was from cradle to the grave. You cannot go anywhere else; you cannot go astray even if you try. You will reach to the grave whatever you do.

The old man was respected, loved; he had attained a certain purity of the heart because he had lived through desires, and seen that every desire leads to frustration. Those desires are past memories. He had lived in all kinds of relationships, and had seen that every kind of relationship turns into hell. He had passed through all the dark nights of the soul. He had attained a certain aloofness – the purity of an observer. He was no longer interested in participating in any football game. Just living his life, he had come to a transcendence; hence, he was respected, his wisdom was respected.

But in the East, the idea has been that life is not just a small piece of seventy years in which youth comes only once. The idea has been that, just

as in existence everything moves eternally – the summer comes, the rains come, the winter comes, and the summer again; everything moves like a wheel – life is not an exception. Death is the end of one wheel and the beginning of another. Again you will be a child, and again you will be young, and again you will be old. It has been so since the beginning, and it is going to be so to the very end – until you become so enlightened that you can jump out of the vicious circle and can enter into a totally different law. From individuality, you can jump into the universal. So there was no hurry, and there was no clinging.

The West is based on the Judaic tradition which believes in only one life. Christianity is only a branch of the Judaism. Jesus was a Jew, born a Jew, lived a Jew, died a Jew; he never knew that he was a Christian. If you meet him somewhere and greet him with, “Hello, Jesus Christ,” he will not recognize who you are addressing because he never knew that his name is Jesus and he never knew that he is Christ. His name was Joshua, a Hebrew name, and he was a messiah of God, not a Christ. Jesus Christ is a translation in Greek from Hebrew. Mohammedanism is also a by-product of the same tradition – the Jewish. These three religions believe in one life. To believe in one life is very dangerous because it does not give you chances to make mistakes, it does not give you chances to have enough experience of anything; you are always in a hurry.

The whole Western mind has become the mind of a tourist who is carrying two, three cameras, and rushing to photograph everything because he only has a three-week visa. And in three weeks, he has to cover the whole country – all the great monuments. There is no time for him to see them directly; he will see them at home, at ease, in his album. Whenever I remember the tourists, I see the old women rushing from one place to another – from Ajanta to Ellora, from Taj Mahal to Kashmir – in a hurry, because life is short.

It is only the Western mind which has created the proverb that time is money. In the East things go slowly; there is no hurry – one has the whole

of eternity. We have been here and we will be here again, so what is the hurry? Enjoy everything with intensity and totality.

So, one thing: because of the idea of one single life, the West has become too concerned about being young, and then everything is done to remain young as long as possible, to prolong the process. That creates hypocrisy, and that destroys an authentic growth. It does not allow you to become really wise in your old age, because you *hate* old age; old age reminds you only of death, nothing else. Old age means the full stop is not far away; you have come to the terminus – just one whistle more, and the train will stop.

I had an agreement with my grandfather. He loved his feet to be massaged, and I had told him, “Remember, when I say ‘comma,’ that means be alert; the semicolon is coming close. When I say ‘semicolon,’ get ready, because the full stop is coming close. And once I say ‘full stop,’ I mean it.” So he was so much afraid of “comma,” that when I would say, “Comma,” he would say, “It is okay, but let the semi-colon be a little longer. Don’t make it short and quick!”

Old age simply reminds you, in the West, that a full stop is coming close – prolong the semicolon-colon. And who are you trying to deceive? If you have recognized that youth is no longer there, you can go on deceiving the whole world but you are not young, you are simply being ridiculous.... People are trying to remain young, but they don’t know that the very fear of losing youth does not allow you to live it in its totality.

And secondly, the fear of losing youth does not allow you to accept old age with grace. You miss both youth – its joy, its intensity – and you also miss the grace, and the wisdom, and the peace that old age brings. But the whole thing is based on a false conception of life. Unless the West changes the idea that there is only one life, this hypocrisy, this clinging, and this fear cannot be changed.

In fact, one life is not all; you have lived many times, and you will live many times more. Hence, live each moment as totally as possible; there is

no hurry to jump to another moment. Time is not money, time is inexhaustible; it is available to the poor as much as to the rich. The rich are not richer as far as time is concerned, and the poor are not poorer. Life is an eternal incarnation.

What appears on the surface is very deep-rooted in the religions of the West. They are very miserly in giving you only seventy years. If you try to work it out, almost one-third of your life will be lost in sleep, one-third of your life will have to be wasted in earning food, clothes, housing. Whatever little is left has to be given to education, football matches, movies, stupid quarrels, fights. If you can save, in seventy years' time, seven minutes for yourself, I will count you a wise man. But it is difficult to save even seven minutes in your whole life; so how can you find yourself? How can you know the mystery of your being, of your life? How can you understand that death is not an end? Because you have missed experiencing life itself, you are going to miss the great experience of death, too; otherwise, there is nothing to be afraid of in death. It is a beautiful sleep, a dreamless sleep, a sleep that is needed for you to move into another body, silently and peacefully. It is a surgical phenomenon; it is almost like anesthesia. Death is a friend, not a foe.

Once you understand death as a friend, and start living life without any fear that it is only a very small time span of seventy years – if your perspective opens to the eternity of your life – then everything will slow down; then there is no need to be speedy. In everything, people are simply rushing. I have seen people taking their office bag, pushing things into it, kissing their wife, not seeing whether she is their wife or somebody else, and saying good-bye to their children. This is not the way of living! And where are you reaching with this speed?

I have heard about a young couple who had purchased a new car, and they were going full speed. The wife was asking the husband again and again, "Where are we going?" – because women are still old-minded: "Where are we going?"

The man said, “Stop bothering me, just enjoy the speed we are going at. The real question is not where we are going; the real question is at what great speed are we going?”

Speed has become more important than the destination, and speed has become more important because life is so short. You have to do so many things, that unless you do everything with speed, you cannot manage. You cannot sit silently even for a few minutes – it seems a wastage. In those few minutes you could have earned a few bucks.

Just wasting time closing your eyes, and what is there inside you? If you really want to know, you can go to any hospital and see a skeleton. That is what is inside you. Why are you unnecessarily getting into trouble by looking in? Looking in, you will find a skeleton. And once you have seen your skeleton, life will become more difficult; kissing your wife, you know perfectly well what is happening – two skeletons. Somebody just needs to invent X-ray glasses, so people can put on X-ray glasses and see all around skeletons laughing. Most probably, he will not be alive to take his glasses off; so many skeletons laughing is enough to stop anybody’s heartbeat. “My God, this is the reality! And this is what all these mystics have been telling people, ‘Look inwards’ – avoid them!”

The West has no tradition of mysticism. It is extrovert: Look outward, there is so much to see. But they are not aware that inside there is not only the skeleton, there is something more within the skeleton. That is your consciousness. By closing your eyes you will not come across the skeleton, you will come across your very life source. The West needs a deep acquaintance with its own life source, then there will be no hurry. One will enjoy when life brings youth, one will enjoy when life brings old age and one will enjoy when life brings death. You simply know one thing – how to enjoy everything that you come across, how to transform it into a celebration. I call the authentic religion the art of transforming everything into a celebration, into a song, into a dance.

An old man walked into a health clinic and told the doctor, “You have got to do something to lower my sex drive.”

The doctor took one look at the feeble old man and said, “Now, now sir, I have got the feeling that your sex drive is all in your head.”

“That’s what I mean, sonny,” the old man said. “I have got to lower it a little.”

Even the old man is wanting to be a playboy. It shows one thing with certainty – that he has not lived his youth with totality. He has missed his youth, and he is still thinking about it. Now he cannot do anything about it, but his whole mind is continuously thinking about the days he had in youth which have not been lived; at that time he was in a hurry.

If he had lived his youth he would be free in his old age of all repressions, sexuality; there would be no need for him to drop his sexual instinct. It disappears, it evaporates in living. One just has to live uninhibited, without any interference from your religions, from your priests, and it disappears; otherwise, when you are young you are in church, and when you are old, you are reading the playboy by hiding it in your Holy Bible. Every Holy Bible is used only for one purpose, hiding magazines like Playboy, so you are not caught by children – it is embarrassing.

I have heard of three men, old men. One was seventy, the other was eighty and the third was ninety. They were all old friends, retired, who used to go for a walk and sit on a bench in the park, and have all kinds of gossips. One day the youngest of the three, the seventy-year-old man, looked a little sad. The second one, the eighty-year-old, asked, “What is the matter? You are looking very sad.”

He said, “I am feeling very guilty. It will help me to unburden myself if I tell you. It is an incident: A beautiful lady was taking a bath – she was a

guest in our house – and I was looking through the keyhole and my mother caught hold of me.”

Both the old friends laughed; they said, “You are an idiot. Everybody does such things in childhood.”

He said, “It is not a question of childhood, it happened today.”

The second man said, “Then it is really serious. But I will tell you something that has been happening to me for three days, and I am keeping it like a stone, a rock on my heart.

Continuously for three days my wife has refused to make love to me.”

The first man said, “That is really very bad.”

But the third, the oldest laughed and he said, “First you ask him what he means by making love.”

So he asked, and the second old man said, “Nothing much. Don’t make me feel more embarrassed. It is a simple process. I hold my wife’s hand and press it three times, then she goes to sleep and I go to sleep. But for three days, whenever I try to hold her hand, she says, ‘Not today, not today! Feel ashamed; you are old enough – not today!’ So for three days I have not made love.”

The third old man said, “This is nothing. What has been happening to me I must confess, because you are young and it will help you in your future. Last night, as the night was passing and the morning was coming closer, I started to make preparations to make love to my wife and she said to me, ‘What are you trying to do, you idiot?’ I said, ‘What am I trying to do? I am simply trying to make love to you,’ and she said, ‘This is the third time in the night; neither you sleep nor you allow me to sleep. Love, love, love!’ So I think it seems I am losing my memory. Your problems are nothing; I have lost my memory.”

If you listen to old people, you will be surprised; they are talking only of things which they should have lived, but the time has passed when it was possible to live them. At that time they were reading the Holy *Bible* and listening to the priest. Those priests and those holy scriptures have corrupted people, because they have given them ideas against nature and they cannot allow them to live naturally. If we need a new humanity, we will have to erase the whole past and start everything anew. And the first basic principle will be: allow everybody, help everybody, teach everybody to live according to his nature, not according to any ideals, and live totally and intensely without any fear. Then children will enjoy their childhood, the young people will enjoy their youth and the old people will have the grace that comes naturally, out of a whole life lived naturally.

Unless your old age is graceful and wise and full of light and joy, contentment, fulfillment, a blissfulness...in your very presence, unless flowers blossom and there is a fragrance of eternity, then it is certain that you have not lived. If it is not happening that way, that means somewhere you have gone astray, somewhere you have listened to the priests, who are the corrupters, the criminals, somewhere you have gone against nature – and nature takes revenge. And its revenge is to destroy your old age and make it ugly, ugly to others and ugly in your own eyes; otherwise old age has a beauty which even youth cannot have.

Youth has a maturity, but it is unwise. It has too much foolishness in it; it is amateurish. Old age has given the last touches to the paintings of one's own life. And when one has given the last touches, one is ready to die joyously, dancingly. One is ready to welcome death.

18. DEATH WITH DIGNITY

What is a natural death? It is a significant question, and there are many possible implications in it. The simplest and the most obvious is that a man dies without any cause; he simply becomes old, older, and the change from old age to death is not through any disease. Death is simply the ultimate old age – everything in your body, in your brain, has stopped functioning. This will be the ordinary and obvious meaning of a natural death.

But to me natural death has a far deeper meaning: one has to live a natural life to attain a natural death. Natural death is the culmination of a life lived naturally, without any inhibition, without any repression – just the way the animals live, the birds live, the trees live, without any split... a life of let-go, allowing nature to flow through you without any obstructions from your side, as if you are absent and life is moving on its own. Rather than you living life, life lives you, you are secondary; then the culmination will be a natural death. According to my definition only an awakened man can die a natural death; otherwise all deaths are unnatural because all lives are unnatural.

How can you arrive at a natural death, living an unnatural life? Death will reflect the ultimate culmination, the crescendo of your whole life. In a condensed form, it is all that you have lived. So only very few people in the world have died naturally because only very few people have lived naturally. Our conditionings don't allow us to be natural. Our conditionings, from the very beginning, teach us that we have to be something more than nature, that just to be natural is to be animal; we have to be supernatural. And it seems very logical. All the religions have been teaching this – that to be man means going above nature – and they have convinced centuries of humanity to go above nature. Nobody has succeeded in going above nature. All that they have succeeded in is destroying their natural, spontaneous beauty, their innocence. Man need not transcend nature. I say unto you, man has to fulfill nature – which no animal can do. That is the difference.

The religions were cunning, cheating and deceiving people. They made the distinction that animals are natural and you have to be supernatural. No animal can do fasting; you cannot convince any animal that fasting is something divine. The animal only knows that it is hungry, and there is no difference between fasting and being hungry. You cannot convince any animal to go against nature.

This gave an opportunity to the so-called religious people, because man has the capacity at least to fight against nature. He will never be victorious, but he can fight. And in fighting he will not be destroying nature; he will be destroying only himself. That's how man has destroyed himself – all his joy, all his love, all his grandeur – and has become not something higher than animals, but something lower, in every possible way. Perhaps you have never thought about it: no animal in the wild is homosexual. The very idea, and the whole world of animals will burst into laughter. It is simply stupid! But in a zoo, where females are not available, animals turn into homosexuals out of sheer necessity.

But man has turned the whole world into a zoo: millions and millions of people are homosexuals, lesbians, sodomists, and what-not – all kinds of perversions. And who is responsible? The people who were teaching you to go beyond nature, to attain supernatural divineness....

Whenever you enforce something, the result is not going to bring a betterment. In many spheres, by different religions, it has been tried to make man something above nature. The result has been, without any exception, failure. You are born as a natural being. You cannot go above yourself. It is just like trying to lift yourself off the ground by pulling your legs. You may hop a little, but sooner or later you are going to fall to the ground, and you may have a few fractures. You cannot fly.

And that's what has been done. People have been trying to raise themselves above nature, which means above themselves. They are not separate from nature, but the idea suited their egos: you are not animals so you have to be

above nature; you cannot behave like animals. People have even tried to make animals not behave like animals; they have tried to make them go a little above nature.

In the Victorian age in England dogs were clothed when people used to take them for a walk. The dogs had coats to prevent them being natural, to prevent them being naked and nude – which is suitable to animals. These kind of people are trying to raise their dogs a little higher than animals.

You will be surprised to know that in the Victorian age in England, even the legs of chairs were covered – for the simple reason that they were called legs, and legs should be covered. Bertrand Russell, who lived almost one century – a long life – remembers in his childhood that seeing the feet of a woman was enough to get sexually excited. The dresses were made in such a way that they covered the feet; you could not see the feet.

It was believed, even just one hundred years ago, that the women of the royal family don't have two legs. Royalty has to be somehow different than ordinary, common humanity, and nobody had seen – and there was no possibility to see – whether their legs were separate from each other. But the ego...neither did those royal people make it clear: "This is nonsense, we are as human as you are." The ego prevented them. If the people are putting them on a higher pedestal, then why bother? – just remain royal. That was one of the reasons why royal families would not allow anybody, a commoner, to be married into the royal family, because he may expose the whole thing: "These people are just as human as everybody else; there is nothing royal about them." But for centuries they maintained the idea.

I would also like you to be different from the animals, but not in the sense that you can go above nature – no. You can go deeper into nature, you can be more natural than animals. They are not free, they are in a deep coma; they cannot do anything other than what their ancestors have been doing for millennia.

You can be more natural than any animal. You can go to the abysmal depths of nature, and you can go to the very heights of nature, but you will not be going beyond in any way. You will be becoming more natural, you will be becoming more multidimensionally natural. To me the religious man is not one who is above nature, but is the man who is totally natural, fully natural, who has explored nature in all its dimensions, who has not left anything unexplored.

Animals are prisoners; they have a certain limited area of being. Man has the capacity, the intelligence, the freedom to explore. And if you have explored nature totally, you have come home – nature is your home. And then death is a joy, is a celebration. Then you die without any complaint; you die with deep gratitude, because life gave you so much, and death is simply the ultimate height of all that you have lived.

It is just like before the flame of a candle goes out it burns brightest. The natural man, before he dies, lives brightest for a moment; he is all light, all truth. To me this is natural death. But it has to be earned, it is not given to you. The opportunity is given to you, but you have to explore, you have to earn, you have to deserve.

Even to see the death of an authentic man, just to be near him while he is dying, you will be filled suddenly with a strange joy. Your tears will not be of sadness, sorrow; they will be of gratitude and blissfulness – because when a man dies naturally, living his life fully, he spreads his being into the whole of nature. Those who are present and close to him are bathed... a sudden freshness, a breeze, a new fragrance and a new feeling that death is not something bad, that death is not something to be afraid of, that death is something to be earned, to be deserved.

I teach you the art of life. But it can be called also the art of death. They are both the same.

In the Western mind, illness, disease, suffering and death are all together – packed in one package. From there problems arise.

Death is beautiful; illness is not, suffering is not, disease is not. Death is beautiful. Death is not a sword that cuts your life, it is like a flower – an ultimate flower – that blooms at the last moment. It is the peak. Death is the flower on the tree of life. It is not the end of life but the crescendo. It is the ultimate orgasm. There is nothing wrong in death; it is beautiful – but one needs to know how to live and how to die. There is an art of living and there is an art of dying, and the second art is of more value than the first art. But the second can be known only when you have known the first. Only those who know how to live rightly know how to die rightly. And then death is a door to the divine.

So, the first thing: please keep death apart. The medical profession should only think of illness, disease and suffering. They need not fight against death. That is creating trouble in the Western mind, in the Western hospitals, in Western medicine. People are fighting against death. People are almost vegetating in the hospitals, just alive on drugs. They are forced to live unnecessarily when they would have died naturally. Through medical support their death is being postponed. They are of no use, life is of no use to them; the game is over, they are finished. Now to keep them alive is just to make them suffer more. Sometimes they may be in a coma, and a person can be in a coma for months and years. But because there is an antagonism towards death it has become a great problem in the Western mind: what to do when a person is in a coma and will never recover, but can be kept alive for years? He will be a corpse, just a breathing corpse, that's all. He will simply vegetate, there will be no life. What is the point? Why not allow him to die? There is the fear of death. Death is the enemy – how to surrender to the enemy, to death?

So there is great controversy in the Western medical mind. What to do? Should a person be allowed to die? Should a person be allowed to decide whether he wants to die? Should the family be allowed to decide whether they would like him to die? – because sometimes the person may be

unconscious and cannot decide. But is it right to help somebody to die? Great fear arises in the Western mind. To die? That means you are murdering the person! The whole of science exists to keep him alive. Now this is stupid! Life in itself has no value unless there is joy, unless there is dance, unless there is some creativity, unless there is love – life in itself is meaningless. Just to live is meaningless. A point comes when one has lived, a point comes when it is natural to die, when it is beautiful to die. Just as when you have been doing work the whole day, a point comes when you fall asleep; death is a kind of sleep – a deeper sleep. You will be born again in a newer body with a newer mechanism, with new facilities, with new opportunities, new challenges. This body is old and one has to leave it; it is just a dwelling....

In the East we have a different outlook: death is not the enemy but the friend. Death gives you rest. You have become tired, you have lived your life, you have known all the joys that can be known in life, you have burned your candle totally. Now go into darkness, rest for a while and then you can be born again. Death will revive you again in a fresher way.

So the first thing: Death is not the enemy

The second thing: Death is the greatest experience in life if you can die consciously. And you can die consciously only if you are not afraid of it. If you are against it you become very panicky, very afraid. When you are so afraid that you cannot tolerate that fear, there is a natural mechanism in the body which releases drugs into the body and you become unconscious. There is a point beyond which endurance will not be possible; you become unconscious. So millions of people die unconsciously and miss a great moment, the greatest of all. It is *samadhi*, it is *satori*, it is meditation happening to you. It is a natural gift.

If you can be alert and you can see that you are not the body... You will have to see, because the body will disappear. Soon you will be able to see that you are not the body, you are separate. Then you will see you are separating from the mind too; then the mind will disappear. And then you

will be just a flame of awareness, and that is the greatest benediction there is. So don't think of death as illness, disease and human suffering.

The freedom to choose your death should be accepted as a birthright of every human being. A limit can be put to it, for example, seventy-five years. After the age of seventy-five the hospitals should be ready to help anybody who wants to get rid of their body. Every hospital should have a place for dying people, and those who have chosen to die should be given special consideration and help. Their death should be beautiful.

Every hospital should have a teacher of meditation.

The person who is going to die should be given one month and will be allowed...if he changes his mind he can go back, because nobody is forcing him. Emotional people who want to commit suicide cannot remain emotional for one month – emotionality can be momentary. Most of the people who commit suicide, if they had waited one moment longer, they would not have committed suicide at all. It is out of anger, out of jealousy, out of hatred or something that they forget the value of life.

The whole problem is that the politicians think accepting euthanasia means suicide is no longer a crime. No, it does not mean that. Suicide is still a crime.

Euthanasia will be with the permission of the medical board. One month's rest in the hospital – every kind of help that can be given to the person to become calm and quiet... all friends coming to meet him, his wife, his children, because he is going on a long journey. There is no question of preventing him – he has lived long, and he does not want to go on living, his work is finished.

And he should be taught meditation in this one month, so that he can do meditation while death comes. And for death, medical help should be given so it comes like a sleep – slowly, slowly, side by side with meditation, sleep going deeper. We can change thousands of people's deaths into

enlightenment. And there is no fear of suicide, because he is not going to commit suicide; if somebody tries to commit suicide he will still be committing a crime. He is asking permission. With the permission of the medical board... and he has one month's time in which he can change his mind at any moment. On the last day he can say, "I don't want to die" – then he can go home. There is no problem in it: it is his decision.

Right now there is a very strange situation in many countries. People try to commit suicide: if they succeed, good; if they don't succeed, then the court gives them the death sentence. Strange! – they themselves were doing that. They were caught in the middle. Now for two years a trial will go on; judges and advocates will be arguing, and this and that, and finally the man has to be hanged, again. He was doing that in the very first place, by himself! Why all this nonsense?

Euthanasia is becoming more and more a need, because with medical science progressing people are living longer. Scientists have not come across any skeleton from five thousand years ago of a person who was more than forty years old when he died. Five thousand years ago the longest a person was going to live was forty, and out of ten children born nine were going to die within two years – only one would survive – so life was immensely valuable.

Hippocrates gave the oath to the medical profession that you have to help life in every case. He was not aware – he was not a seer – he had not the insight to see that a day could come when out of ten children, all ten would survive. Now that is happening. On the one hand, nine more children are surviving; and on the other hand, medical science helps people to live longer – ninety years, one hundred years is not rare. In developed countries it is very easy to find a ninety-year-old person or a one-hundred-year-old person.

In the Soviet Union there are people who have reached one hundred and fifty years, and there are a few thousand people who have reached one hundred and eighty years of age – and they are still working. But now life

has become boring. One hundred and eighty years, just think of it, doing the same thing – even the bones will be hurting – and yet they still have no possibility of death. Death still seems to be far away – they are still working and healthy.

In America there are thousands of people in the hospitals just lying in their beds with all kinds of instruments connected to them. Many are on artificial breathing machines. What is the point if the person himself cannot breathe? What do you expect him to do? And why are you burdening the whole nation with this person when there are many people dying on the streets, starving?

Thirty million people in America are on the streets without shelter, without food, without clothes, and thousands of people are taking up hospital beds, doctors, nurses – their work, their labor, medicines. Everybody knows they will die sooner or later, but as long as you can you should keep them alive. They *want* to die. They shout that they want to die, but the doctor cannot help in that. These people certainly need some rights; they are being forced to live, and force is in every way undemocratic.

So I want it to be a very rational thing. Make it seventy-five years or eighty years; then life is lived enough. The children are grown up... when you are eighty your children will be fifty, fifty-five; *they* are getting old. Now there is no need for you to be bothered and worried. You are retired; now you are simply a burden, you don't know what to do.

And that is why old people are so irritable – because they don't have any work, they don't have any respect, they don't have any dignity. Nobody bothers about them, nobody takes note of them. They are ready to fight and be angry and shout. These are simply their frustrations that are showing; the real thing is they want to die. But they cannot even say it. It is unchristian, it is irreligious – the very idea of death.

They should be given freedom, but not only to die; they should be given the freedom of one month's training in how to die. In that training meditation

should be a basic part; physical care should be a basic part. They should die healthy, whole, silent, peaceful – slowly slipping deep into sleep. And if meditation has been joined with sleep they may die enlightened. They may know that only the body is left behind, and they are part of eternity.

Their death will be better than the ordinary death, because in the ordinary death you don't have the chance of becoming enlightened. In fact more and more people will prefer to die in the hospitals, in the special institutes for death where every arrangement is made. You can leave life in a joyous, ecstatic way, with great thankfulness and gratitude.

I am all for euthanasia but with these conditions.

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19. AIDS

I do not know anything about even first aid, and you have asked me about the last AIDS! But it seems I will have to say something about it. And in a world where people who know nothing about themselves can talk about God, people who know nothing about the geography of the earth can talk about heaven and hell, it is not inconceivable for me to say something about AIDS, although I am not a physician. But neither is the disease now called AIDS just a disease. It is something more, something beyond the limitation of the medical profession.

As I see it, it is not a disease in the same category as other diseases; hence the danger of it. Perhaps it will kill twothirds of humanity. It is, basically, the incapability to resist diseases. One slowly, slowly finds oneself vulnerable to all kinds of infections, and one has no inner resistance to fight those infections.

To me it means humanity is losing the will to live. Whenever a person loses the will to live his resistance falls immediately, because the body follows the mind. The body is a very conservative servant of the mind; it serves the mind in a religious way. If the mind loses the will to live it will be reflected in the body by the dropping of resistance against sickness, against death. Of course the physician will never bother about the will to live – that's why I thought it better that I say something.

It is going to become such an enormous problem all over the world that any insight from any dimension can be of immense help. Just in the beginning it was thought to be a homosexual disease. From all around the world researchers supported the idea that it was something homosexual – it was found that it happens more in men than in women. But now researchers say that AIDS is not a homosexual disease at all, that it is also a heterosexual disease, and it happens if people go on changing partners – mixing with

many women, with many men, continually changing partners. This continuous changing is the cause of the disease.

Homosexuality has nothing to do with it, according to the research.

To me it is very significant. It has nothing to do with either heterosexuality or with homosexuality. It has certainly something to do with sex. And why has it something to do with sex? – because the will to live is rooted in sex. If the will to live disappears, then sex will be the most vulnerable area of life to invite death.

Remember perfectly well that I am not a medical man, and whatever I am saying is from a totally different point of view. But there is much more possibility of what I am saying being true than what these so-called researchers are saying, because their research is superficial. They think only of cases; they collect data, facts.

That is not my way – I am not a fact-collector. My work is not of research but of insight. I try to see into every problem as deeply as possible. I simply ignore the superficial, which is the area of the researchers. My work you can call insearch, but not research. I try to penetrate deeply, and I see clearly that sex is the phenomenon most related to the will to live. If the will to live declines, sex will be vulnerable; then it is not a question of heterosexuality or homosexuality.

As it appears to me, the disease is spiritual. Man has come to a point where he finds the way ends. Going back is meaningless because all that he has seen, lived, shows him there was nothing in it; it has all proved meaningless. Going back has no meaning; going ahead there is no road: facing him is the abyss. In this situation if he loses the desire, the will to live, it is not unexpected.

It has been experimentally proved that if a child is not brought up by loving people – the mother, the father, the other small children in the family – if the child is not brought up by loving people, you can give him every

nourishment but somehow his body goes on shrinking. You are giving everything necessary – medical needs are fulfilled, much care is being taken – but the child goes on shrinking. Is it a disease? Yes, to the medical mind everything is a disease; something must be wrong. They will go on researching the facts, why it is happening. But it is not a disease.

The child's will to live has not even arisen. It needs loving warmth, joyful faces, dancing children, the warmth of the mother's body – a certain milieu which makes him feel that life has tremendous treasures to be explored, that there is so much joy, dance, play; that life is not just a desert, that there are immense possibilities. He should be able to see those possibilities in the eyes around him, in the bodies around him. Only then will the will to live spring up – it is almost like a spring. Otherwise, he will shrink and die – not with any physical disease, he will simply shrink and die.

I have been to orphanages; one of my friends, Rekhchand Parekh, in Chanda, Maharashtra, used to run an orphanage – nearabout one hundred to one hundred and ten orphans were there. And orphans would come, two days old, three days old; people would just leave them in front of the orphanage. He wanted me to come to see the orphanage. I said, "Sometime later on I will see it, because I know whatever is there will make me unnecessarily sad." But he insisted, so one time I went, and what I saw.... They were taking every care, he was pouring his money on those children, but they were all ready to die just any moment. Doctors were there, nurses were there, medical facilities were there, food was there, everything was there. He had given his own beautiful bungalow – he had moved to a smaller bungalow – a beautiful garden and everything was there; but the will to live was not there.

I told him, "These children will go on dying slowly."

He said, "You are telling me? I have been running this orphanage for twelve years; hundreds have died. We have tried every possible way to keep them alive, but nothing seems to work. They go on shrinking and one day simply they are no longer there."

If there had been a disease the doctor could help, but there was no disease; simply, the child had no desire to live. When I said this to him it became clear to him. He immediately, that very day, gave the orphanage to the government, and he said, “I have been trying to help these children for twelve years; now I know it is not possible. What they need I cannot give, so it is better that the government takes it over.” He said to me, “I had come to this point many times, but I am not an articulate man so I could not figure out what it was. But in a vague way I was feeling that something was missing and that goes on killing them.”

AIDS is the same phenomenon at the other end. The orphan child shrinks and dies because his will to live never sprouts, never springs up, never becomes a flowing current. AIDS is at the other end: you suddenly feel you are an existential orphan. This existential feeling of being an orphan causes your will to live to disappear. And when the will to live disappears, sex will be the first thing to be affected because your life starts with sex; it is a by-product of sex.

So while you are living, throbbing, hoping, ambitious, and the tomorrow remains the utopia – so that you can forget all the yesterdays which were meaningless, you can forget today which is also meaningless...but tomorrow when the sun rises and everything will be different... All the religions have been giving you that hope.

Those religions have failed. Although you go on keeping the label – Christian, Jew, Hindu – it is only a label. Inside, you have lost hope, the hope has disappeared. Religions could not help; they were pseudo. Politicians could not help. They were never intending to help; it was just a strategy to exploit you. But how long can this false utopia – political or religious – help you? Sooner or later, one day man will become mature; and that’s what is happening. Man is becoming mature, aware that he has been cheated by the priests, by the parents, by the politicians, by the pedagogues. He has been simply cheated by everybody, and they have been feeding him on false hopes. The day he matures and realizes this, the desire to live falls

apart. And the first thing wounded by it will be your sexuality. To me that is AIDS.

When your sexuality starts shrinking you are really hoping that something will happen and you will go into eternal silence, into eternal disappearance. Your resistance is not there. AIDS has no other symptoms except that your resistance goes on dropping. At the most you can live two years if you are fortunate and don't get accidentally infected. Each infection will be incurable, and each infection will be weakening you more and more. Two years is the longest the AIDS patient can live; and he may disappear sometime before that. And no treatment is going to help, because no treatment can bring back your will to live.

What I am doing here is multidimensional. You are not fully aware of what I am trying to do; perhaps you may become aware only when I am gone. I am trying to give you not a hope in the future – because that has failed – I am trying to give you a hope herenow. Why bother about tomorrow ?... because tomorrow has not helped. For centuries the tomorrow has been keeping you somehow dragging, and it has failed you so many times that now you cannot go on clinging to it. That would be sheer stupidity. Those who are clinging to it still are only proving that they are retarded in their minds.

I am trying to make this very moment fulfillment, a contentment so deep that there is no need for the will to live. The will to live is needed because you are not alive. The will keeps picking you up: you go on slipping down, the will keeps picking you up. I am not trying to give you a new will to live, I am simply trying to teach you to live without any will, to live joyously. It is the tomorrow that goes on poisoning you. Forget yesterdays, forget tomorrows. This is our day – let us celebrate it and live it. And just by living it you will be strong enough so that without the will to live you will be able to resist all kinds of diseases, all suicidal attitudes.

Just being fully alive is such a power that not only can you live, you can make others aflame, afire.

This has been a well-known fact. When there are great epidemics have you not wondered why the doctors and nurses and others don't get infected? They are human beings just like you, and they are overworked, more vulnerable to infection because they are continually tired. When there is an epidemic you cannot insist on a five-hour day or six-hour day, and a five-day week. An epidemic is an epidemic; it does not bother about your holidays and your overtime. You have to work – people work sixteen hours, eighteen hours, every day, for months. Still, the doctors, the nurses, the Red Cross people, they don't get infected.

What is the problem? Why are others getting infected? These are similar kinds of people. If just having a Red Cross on your shirt...then put the Red Cross on everybody's shirt; on every house the Red Cross. If the Red Cross is preventing infection it would be so easy – but that is not the thing.

No, these people are so much involved in helping others, they don't have any tomorrow. This moment is so involving, they don't have any yesterday. They don't have any time to think or even worry, "I may get infected." Their involvement... When millions of people are dying, can you think of yourself, and your life, and your death? Your whole energy is moving to help people, to do whatever you can do. You have forgotten yourself, and because you have forgotten yourself you cannot be infected. The person who could have been infected is absent: he is so involved in doing something, he is so lost in some work.

It does not matter whether you are painting or sculpting, or you are serving a dying human being – it does not matter what you are doing, what matters is: Are you totally involved in the herenow? If you are involved in the herenow you are completely out of the area where infection is possible. When you are so much involved, your life becomes such a torrential force. And you will see: even a lazy doctor, in a time of epidemic, when hundreds of people are dying, suddenly forgets his laziness. An old doctor suddenly forgets his age....

Only meditation can release your energy herenow. And then there is no need for any hope, for any utopia, for any paradise anywhere. Each moment is a paradise unto itself. But as far as my qualifications are concerned, I am not qualified to say anything about AIDS. I have never even taken the course on first aid. So please forgive my entering into something which is not my business. But I go on doing that, and I am going to continue to do that.

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20. A LOOK INTO THE FUTURE

The possibilities given by genetic engineering are absolutely fascinating, and there is no need to feel any fear about it. In fact, what we have been doing for millions of years is mass production – accidental mass production.

Do you know what kind of a child you are going to give birth to? Do you know if he will be blind, crippled, retarded, sick, weak, vulnerable to all kinds of diseases for his whole life? Does your lover know what he is doing? While you are making love you have no conception, not even a possibility of guessing. You are giving birth to children just like animals, and you don't feel scared about it, you don't feel any fear about it. And you see the whole world full of retarded people, crippled, blind, deaf, dumb. All this rubbish! Who is responsible for it? And is it not mass production?

My conception of giving scientific birth to a child is that, conscious, alert, knowingly, we are bringing a visitor to the earth. We know who he is, what he is and what he is to become finally; how long he will live, how much intelligence he will have. We are discarding all possibilities of blind children, deaf children, dumb children, retarded in any way – physically, psychologically – and you are feeling fear? Don't be stupid.

The scientific birth of a child is not animalistic. You are transcending the animal by giving birth to a child scientifically. It is fascinating, the greatest, most fascinating thing around. We can manage it, it is already a scientific reality. We can manage healthier people, who will live as long as we want, and we can give them as much intelligence as is needed for their work.

A couple comes to a scientific lab and tells them that they want a child like Albert Einstein, but better than him, living two hundred years; and he should never suffer any disease, he should be strong. The scientific lab finds

the right egg from the bank, the right semen from the bank, and the child is produced in a test-tube with all precautions.

You will have to adopt the child, you cannot produce the child. Production of children is animalistic. Adoption of children of your own imagination... Everybody wants a Shakespeare to be born, wants their child to be a great poet, a great musician, a great dancer. Every mother thinks that her child is going to be in some way a superhuman being, and every mother is frustrated – the child turns out to be just rotten. He just gets lost in this whole crowd on an overpopulated planet. This is mass production. But adopting a child, you can contemplate on all the qualities that you need. You can ask the advice of the experts as to what other qualities will be helpful in his life, how much he will be capable of love... You want a Romeo? – you can get a Romeo. It is only a question of chemistry. Romeo has more male hormones than anybody else, he is richer; that's why one woman is not enough for him.

You want a poet who will transcend all the poets of the past? A scientist in comparison to whom all the scientists of the past will look like pygmies? A musician who brings the unknown, the invisible, through sounds to you? A poet who sings songs of joy and celebration as nobody else has ever done? You can ask anything, and they have just to work out, calculate which female egg, which male semen will produce such a human being. That semen is not yours, that egg is not your wife's; you adopt the child. In this way you can get what humanity has always dreamed about: the birth of the superman, a man who is made almost of steel. Your Muhammad Ali the Great will not be able to face him – just one punch on his nose and he will be finished.

What makes you afraid? Don't you want to get above animals? The desire that it will be your semen, that it will be your wife's egg, is simply ugly. Children belong to the universe. What speciality has it got that it is your semen? What is the point of creating a crippled person, just because it is your semen? Science can manage to raise you above animality – and it is not mass production, it will be just the opposite. There is not going to be an

assembly line the way cars are produced. It is going to be very individual because every couple has the choice and the freedom to decide what kind of child they want.

How has the idea of mass production come into your mind? Do you think everybody would like the same kind of child? You are wrong. Do you think science labs will go on producing children according to their own desire, and you have to adopt them? Then it will be mass production. I am not for it. You are absolutely free to choose. Right now you are absolutely blind and doing whatsoever you are doing in utter darkness. You are simply a slave of blind biology.

Don't you want freedom from blind biology? Don't you want to go above this stupid attachment to the idea that the child is born out of your semen and your wife's egg? Those eggs don't know to whom they belong. And what is special about your semen? You don't know anything about it. You are completely unaware of what kind of people are struggling within you to be born. You have no choice, you are simply a slave.

What I am saying about scientific birth makes you go beyond slavery, blindness, darkness. It makes you in a certain way more spiritual, because you are no longer concerned that your semen, your wife's egg, are absolutely needed for your child. You give your requirements; you adopt the child. And you can ask experts what will be the best for the child. Would you not like your child to be a unique genius? For futile attachments you are satisfied with a crippled child. And giving birth to a crippled child, a blind child, are you doing any favor to the child? He will never forgive you! You are responsible. And he will have to live a life which is not life at all.

My vision gives total freedom to you and, of course, great responsibility. Right now you are producing children without any responsibility. You have means available to determine what color the child should be, what kind of face – Greek, Roman?... You can create children who will look like sculptures, utterly beautiful, with genius in some dimension of life, living a life of love, intelligent enough to discard all the priests and all the

politicians. They will not become followers of a leader, they will be enough unto themselves.

Right now, what are you doing? First you create in blindness, darkness, a child, not knowing what he is going to turn out like. Then you force him to become a slave by making him a Christian, Hindu, Mohammedan, or politically giving him a certain ideology – socialism, fascism, communism. And he is not intelligent enough to rebel against all these slaveries.

The child of my vision will be absolute freedom. He will not belong to any political party, he will not belong to any organized religion. He will have his own religion, he will have his own political ideology. What is the need for him to hang around Karl Marx and be a communist? He can think better than Karl Marx – and Karl Marx is not a great thinker. He can live so long that he is not in a hurry about anything; patient, ready to wait – he has time enough. Just think of Albert Einstein living three hundred years. He would have given miracles to the world. But because he was living in an accidental body, he had to die.

We can discard disease, old age. We can program life in every way. We can even program the life of the child, so that when *he* wants to die only then will he die; otherwise he can go on living. If he feels that there are still juices that he has not tasted, if he feels there are still dimensions that he has not explored, if he feels that more time is needed, then he is the master to decide how long to live.

Up to now, you have lived seventy years on average – that includes people who live one hundred and fifty years in some places of the world. In Russia there are people who have passed one hundred and fifty years, and they are still young. There are people in a certain part of Kashmir, which Pakistan has invaded, who live very easily to one hundred and fifty, sixty, seventy. And it is a surprising fact – I have been to those people – a one-hundred-and-fifty-year-old person is just working in the field the same way he was working when he was fifty, with the same strength, with the same gusto.

All that is needed is better planning, better crossbreeding. It is a known and applied fact about animals. Do you see the many kinds of beautiful dogs around the earth? – small, big, powerful, or just beautiful. Just to see them jump around you is such a joy. Do you think they came out of blind nature? No, for centuries we have been crossbreeding dogs.

You know it as a fact – the whole world accepts it – that a man should not get married to his own sister. Why? That should be the most simple thing, to get married to your own sister. You love her already, you have been together since birth, you know each other. But why have all cultures prohibited it? All cultures have said that marriage should be with distant people, people who don't come from the same family tree, because the bigger the distance, the better the product. If a white American marries a Negro, the child will be far better than a white American marrying another white American, or a Negro marrying another Negro, because the distance between those two is immense – different centuries. They have grown in different atmospheres, their programming is totally different from each other. So when these two totally different cultures, traditions, conventions, lifestyles meet, they give birth to a better man, who has a double heritage: the heritage of the Negroes and the heritage of the white Americans.... In a scientific lab it will be possible to find eggs and semen cells as distant as possible. And we can create through that crossbreeding a totally new man.

There is nothing scary about it. It is not mass production. The couple has to say what kind of person they would like to have as their child. It avoids all accidents. And we will be creating the universal man – not the Chinese, not the Indian, not the English, but the universal man. So please, just feel fascinated, don't feel scared and afraid. There is nothing to be afraid of.

You have seen the way children have been produced in the past. For millions of years you have been doing the same thing – what is the outcome? The outcome decides the value of what you have been doing. Once in a while there is an Albert Einstein or a Bertrand Russell – once in a while! This is not right. It should be the ordinary phenomenon, usual. Once in a while perhaps there will be a person who is born out of some

unawareness, unalertness on the part of the scientist; otherwise everybody should be a genius. Just think: the whole world full of people like Rabindranath, Jean-Paul Sartre, Jaspers, Heidegger! And we can prevent people like Adolph Hitler, Mussolini, Joseph Stalin from being born, because they have been calamities here. We can close the door completely on all Genghis Khans, Tamerlanes, Nadir Shahs – all those ugly monsters whose whole life consisted of killing people, destroying people, burning people.

The way we have lived has not proved right. We have only a crowd of pygmies all around – *this* is what you should be scared of! But having a garden of geniuses, creative people, a garden from where we have removed all fanatics, idiots, politicians – in short, we have taken out all that was poisonous, all pollution... There is so much in the idea. Now, how many people are suffering because they have a snubbed nose? Their whole life they feel inferior. How many people are suffering because they have *only* a nose? If you look at them, everything else is so small and the nose is so big...

I have heard: one millionaire had a very big nose and very small eyes, but he was the richest man in the community. People used to laugh behind him, but nobody ever dared... He was invited by a family for dinner. The family was concerned about only one thing: their child, who was a born philosopher, asked about everything.

From the morning they were teaching him, “You can ask anything, but when the rich man comes, you are not to ask about his nose.” They told him so many times that he became immensely interested: “What is so great about his nose?” They had never prevented him from asking any question. Why was this nose so important? He was really excited, eagerly waiting for the millionaire to come. When he came in, the child laughed. He said to his parents, “He has only a nose, nothing else! And why were you preventing me...? He is a rare specimen!” He destroyed the whole effort.

But people... almost everyone is suffering from something or other. Somebody is suffering from his color, somebody is suffering from his tallness; somebody is too tall, somebody is too small. What have you produced? *This* is mass production – accidental, produced in darkness. At least human beings – who are the crown in existence – should not suffer anymore from an inferiority complex. The only way is scientific production of children. And there are immense possibilities in it.

For example, if the child is produced in a scientific lab they can produce a similar child simultaneously. The other child will be kept in the lab growing simultaneously; exactly as the one who has gone out to be adopted by a family, the other will be growing in the scientific lab. Just the existence of the other gives great opportunities. For example, you get a fractured leg. Now no need to bother to fix the fracture – the leg from the other fellow can be taken and given to you. Something goes wrong, berserk, in your head – now there is no need for all the psychologists, psychoanalysts, psychiatrists. Your head is just removed, you get a fresh head. The other person will remain in anesthesia his whole life, in a deep freeze. He will not know anything of what is happening. He is just there in case something goes wrong with you – and many things go wrong in life, even with every precaution. Something can always go wrong; life is a long affair. You may have a car accident...now, that cannot be prevented by scientific reproduction of children....

But all depends on whether we have courage enough to rise over our fearful selves. We have to rise above the scary feeling. Be fascinated with the new man! The new man must have a new kind of birth. The new man must have a new kind of life, a new kind of love, a new kind of death. He will be new in every possible way. He will replace the old models who are overcrowding the earth – junkyards. They are not needed.

It is a simple process of programming the first cell. And only the first cell can be programmed, because then it goes on reproducing itself – that is an autonomous process. You can program it for everything. Right now it is difficult; it is programmed for all kinds of diseases, it is programmed for

death, old age. You can't have any control over it. There is no way to change the program now, because all the cells have the same program. If they are programmed for a particular disease that you get by inheritance, you will suffer from that disease. It could have been changed, but only in the first meeting of the male and the female cells. Everything can be programmed, and an exact copy of you can be kept in the lab. If your heart is not functioning well, the new heart is available – which will fit you exactly, because it comes from your copy, your twin.

Any new thing scares, but it scares only cowards. Any new thing fascinates, but it fascinates only the brave ones. Be brave, because we need a new, brave world.

? Do you see experiments on human life, such as artificial birth and the exchange of hearts and brains, as an advance, or as an action against nature?

It all depends who is going to do it. If the politicians are going to do it, or the so-called religions are going to do it, then it is against nature. They cannot do anything natural, they are against nature. But if it is being done by an international academy of scientists – I say *international* academy of scientists – it can be a tremendous, progressive step, and it will not be against nature. It will be nature's growth. But it all depends on who is doing it. The experiments themselves are neutral. No experiment has any vested interest, it is neutral. You can use poison to kill you; the same poison can be used by medical people to save you. It all depends who is doing it.

For example, the discovery of atomic energy was a step of tremendously great progress, a quantum leap. We had found a key to transform the earth into paradise – so much energy in such a small atom. And they are in everything... just in a dewdrop there are millions of atoms. Any atom, if it is exploded, releases so much energy that you can make the whole earth live in luxury. Or you can create Hiroshima and Nagasaki – thousands of people dead within seconds. But because atomic energy, after its invention, went into the hands of the politicians, it became a servant of death. Now there are even more advanced nuclear weapons which can destroy the whole earth.

The already existing weapons are enough to destroy this earth seven times. One simply wonders why nations are going to develop more and more nuclear power. Seven times destroying the earth is not enough? In fact, you can destroy the earth only once.

But scientific progress falls into the hands of the politicians because only they can provide enough finance to make these discoveries possible. The scientists of the whole world should think it over: their genius is being used by idiots! The scientists should disconnect themselves from any nation – whether it is the Soviet Union or America. They should create an international academy of sciences. And it is not difficult. If all the scientists of the world are together, finances can be made available, and these discoveries can help man tremendously....

Science should not be the monopoly of any nation, any country. The whole idea is stupid. How can science be monopolized? And every country is trying to monopolize the scientists, keep their inventions secret. This is against humanity, against nature, against existence. Whatever a genius discovers should be in the service of the whole.

You are asking whether discoveries like changing human hearts or human brains are progressive steps. They are of great importance to bring a new humanity on the earth. If Einstein's body is no longer capable of living, do you think it would not be good if his whole brain is transplanted into a young, healthy man? The new man will become an Einstein, because all the genius of Einstein is transplanted to a younger body.

This way bodies may go on changing, but we can keep the genius of Albert Einstein growing for centuries. And if a man in a seventy-year life can give so much, you can imagine if his brain continues for centuries how much benefit it will be for humanity, for the whole universe. This is really a wastage: the container gets rotten, and you throw the content also. The body is only a container. If the container has become dirty, old, unusable, change the container, but don't throw away the content. The genius mind can live for eternity in different bodies; that is nothing against nature. You hear, if it

starts failing, and if you are of immense value to humanity...what is the fear of exchanging the heart? Somebody may be dying from cancer, but his heart is perfectly healthy; that heart can be planted in a man who is talented, a genius, and is healthy, but whose heart is not strong. This is simple; there is nothing in it against nature.

But with politicians and the power in their hands, of course every advance has gone against nature. Everything that human genius has discovered, invented, finally is in the service of death. So are the priests. Now science is no longer a child, that it has to depend on others. Science is now grown-up enough, it is adult. Just a little courage...

I give the invitation to all the scientists of the world; we have a place, we have intelligent people here in my commune to help you in every possible way. It will be a great revolution in the history of man. The whole power will be in the hands of the scientists, who have never done any harm to anybody. And once all the power is in the hands of the scientists, politicians will fade away of their own accord. They have been exploiting scientists for their own purposes, and to be exploited by anybody is not an act of dignity.

The scientists should recognize their dignity, they should recognize their individuality. They should recognize that they have been exploited down the ages by the priests and the politicians. Now it is time to declare that science is going to stand on its own feet. This will be a great freedom. Then all these experiments, such as laboratory babies, will be of a different caliber, because you can arrange what kind of genius you want. Up to now it has been just accidental, and because it has been accidental, ninety-nine percent of the people have nothing to contribute. They contribute only problems to the world. Now, what has Ethiopia contributed to the world? What have the poor countries contributed to the world – or even the rich countries? Except problems, wars, there is no contribution on their part.

But if you can give birth to a child in a scientific lab... It is possible, there is no problem in it.... Sex, for the first time, will be simply fun! Children will be produced in the lab. They will belong to all. And because you are not

going to produce children in the old way – it should be illegal and criminal to do so, you will be behind bars if you do it – then many problems of your life will be simply dissolved.

Why is the man so insistent? Throughout the ages the insistence has remained there: he wants to be certain that the child born out of his wife's womb is his. Why? Who are you anyway? It is a question of property, because your child will become the inheritor of all that you have accumulated. You want to be certain that it is your child, not your neighbor's child. Women have been kept almost imprisoned for the simple fear that if they start mixing with people it will be difficult to decide whose child it is. Only the mother will know, or even she may not know.

Once production of life goes into the hands of science sex will be transformed. Then you are not jealous, then you are not a monopolist, then monogamy is absurd. Then sex is just fun, the way you enjoy tennis. And you don't bother that the partners should remain monogamous – two bodies enjoying each other... And there will be no fear that the wife may get pregnant and there will be problems, financial and other. Sex will no longer be a problem for the world population; it will no longer be a problem for the priest. In fact, if children are produced in the scientific lab many of the troubles of the world will dissolve. And we can create the best people: beautiful, healthy, capable of living as long as we want. Old age is not necessary – a man can remain young, healthy, without sickness. All these hospitals and so many people, so much money involved. Do you know – America spends more money on laxatives than on education. Great idea! Who cares about education? The question is laxatives!

But the basic thing should be remembered: scientists have to be courageous enough and declare that they don't belong to any nation, to any religion, that whatsoever they will be doing will be for the whole humanity. And I don't see that there is anything impossible in it. I am absolutely for those progressive inventions which can make man happier, live longer, be younger, healthier, and which make his life more of a play, fun, and less of a torturous journey from the cradle to the grave.

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21. THE HEALING POWER OF LAUGHTER

Laughter has meditative powers and medicinal powers. It certainly changes your very chemistry; it changes your brain waves, it changes your intelligence – you become more intelligent. The parts of your mind that have been asleep suddenly wake up. The laughter reaches to the innermost part of your brain, to your heart. A man of laughter cannot have a heart attack. A man of laughter cannot commit suicide. A man of laughter automatically comes to know the world of silence, because when laughter ceases suddenly there is silence. And each time laughter becomes deeper it is followed by deeper silence.

It certainly clarifies you – from the traditions, from the garbage of the past. It gives you a new vision of life. It makes you more alive and radiant, more creative.

Now, even medical science says that laughter is one of the most deep-going medicines nature has provided man with. If you can laugh when you are ill you will get your health back sooner. If you cannot laugh, even if you are healthy, sooner or later you will lose your health and you will become ill. Laughter brings some energy from your inner source to your surface. Energy starts flowing, follows laughter like a shadow. Have you watched it? – when you really laugh, for those few moments you are in a deep meditative state. Thinking stops. It is impossible to laugh and think together. They are diametrically opposite: either you can laugh or you can think. If you really laugh, thinking stops. If you are still thinking, laughter will be just so-so, it will be *just* so-so, lagging behind. It will be a crippled laughter. When you really laugh, suddenly mind disappears. And the whole Zen methodology is how to get into no-mind – laughter is one of the beautiful doors to get to it.

As far as I know, dancing and laughter are the best, natural, easily approachable doors. If you really dance, thinking stops. You go on and on, you whirl and whirl, and you become a whirlpool – all boundaries, all divisions are lost. You don't even know where your body ends and where the existence begins. You melt into existence and the existence melts into you; there is an overlapping of boundaries. And if you are really dancing – not managing it but allowing it to manage you, allowing it to possess you – if you are possessed by dance, thinking stops. The same happens with laughter. If you are possessed by laughter, thinking stops. And if you know a few moments of no-mind, those glimpses will promise you many more rewards that are going to come. You just have to become more and more of the sort, of the quality, of no-mind. More and more, thinking has to be dropped. Laughter can be a beautiful introduction to a non-thinking state....

In a few Zen monasteries every monk has to start his morning with laughter and has to end his night with laughter – the first thing and the last thing! You try it. It is very beautiful. It will look a little crazy – because so many serious people are all around. They will not understand. If you are happy, they always ask why. The question is foolish! If you are sad, they never ask why. They take it for granted – if you are sad, it's okay. Everybody is sad. What is new in it? Even if you want to tell them they are not interested because they know all about it, they themselves are sad. So what is the point of telling a long story? – cut it short! But if you are laughing for no reason then they become alert – something has gone wrong. This man seems to be a little crazy because only crazy people enjoy laughter; only in madhouses will you find crazy people laughing. This is unfortunate, but this is so.

It will be difficult, if you are a husband or a wife it will be difficult for you to suddenly laugh early in the morning. But try it – it pays tremendously. It is one of the most beautiful moods to get up with, to get out of the bed with. For *no* reason! – because there is no reason. Simply you are again there, still alive – it is a miracle. It seems ridiculous – why are you alive? And again the world is there. Your wife is still snoring, and the same room, and the same house. In this constantly changing world – what Hindus call the

maya – at least for one night nothing has changed? Everything is there: you can hear the milkman and the traffic has started, and the same noises – it is worth laughing for!

One day you will not get up in the morning. One day the milkman will knock at the door, the wife will be snoring, but you will not be there. One day death will come. Before it knocks you down have a good laugh – while there is time have a good laugh. And look at the whole ridiculousness: again the same day starts; you have done the same things again and again for your whole life. Again you will get into your slippers, rush to the bathroom – for what? Brushing your teeth, taking a shower – for what? Where are you going? Getting ready and nowhere to go! Dressing, rushing to the office – for what? Just to do the same thing again tomorrow?

Look at the whole ridiculousness of it – and have a good laugh. Don't open your eyes. The moment you feel that sleep is gone, first start laughing, then open the eyes – and that will set a trend for the whole day. If you can laugh early in the morning you will laugh the whole day. You have created a chain effect; one thing leads to another. Laughter leads to more laughter. And almost always I have seen people doing just the wrong thing. From the very early morning they get out of bed complaining, gloomy, sad, depressed, miserable. Then one thing leads to another – and for *nothing* – and they get angry. It is very bad because it will change your climate for the whole day, it will set a pattern for the whole day.

Zen people are more sane. In their insanity they are saner than you. They start with laughter... and then the whole day you will feel laughter bubbling, welling up. There are so many ridiculous things happening all over! God must be dying of his laughter – down the centuries, for eternity, seeing this ridiculousness of the world. The people that he has created, and all the absurdities – it is really a comedy. He must be laughing. If you become silent after your laughter, one day you will hear God also laughing, you will hear the whole existence laughing – trees and stones and stars with you.

The Zen monk goes to sleep in the night again with laughter. The day is over, the drama is closed again – with laughter he says, “Good-bye, and if I survive again tomorrow morning I will greet you again with laughter.”

Try it! Start and finish your day with laughter, and you will see, by and by, in between these two more and more laughter starts happening. And the more laughing you become, the more religious.

Millions of people have forgotten how to laugh. In some countries psychologists are preparing manuals for people to be taught in schools, colleges, hospitals, on how to laugh, because they have discovered what I have been saying to you continually: love and laughter go together, and laughter is one of the greatest medicines. At the same time it is also a great meditation. Researchers have been working very deeply to find out what happens when people laugh. Their blood flow changes, their brain cells become more active, their heartbeat becomes more rhythmic. Something like laughter has been found by the scientists to be of tremendous importance – but they are being immensely stupid about it. They think it has to be a training; every schoolchild has to be trained how to laugh.

And if everybody is trained how to laugh, no laughter will exist at all! Now they are saying that in every hospital there should be a special ward, a humor ward where all the patients should tell jokes and laugh. It is very calculated: what their medicines cannot do, laughter can do. But to me, if laughter comes as a training it may do something, but it cannot be a total transformation where in a single moment your whole being is thrilled, vast, rejuvenated, and there are no side-effects.

Just today I came to know that one-third of the diseases in the world are created by the doctors. Not knowingly – just because of their medicines, which are going to have aftereffects. For the moment they may be useful, but they may create something in your chemistry, in your hormones, in your biology. And you may never connect them. You had taken the aspirin only

for your headache – to be exactly true, only for your wife! – but that aspirin is going to have its own effects, and you are a complex phenomenon.

It is a poor humanity who needs training to laugh. The day would be very ugly when birds ask, “First train us, then we will sing the song.” And the peacocks will say, “We don’t care about the clouds. First train us; then we will open our wings.” But the peacocks dance as the first clouds of rain start coming; there is no training for it, no training school for peacocks. No training for the birds, no training for the flowers – why should man be trained for everything? Why should he not be allowed to be spontaneous?

There is some fear of spontaneity, because the spontaneous behavior is unpredictable. You may laugh at somebody and he may simply look at you as if you are an idiot. There is no need for him to laugh in response — he is being spontaneous, he is feeling like looking at you as an idiot. Nothing is wrong in it; it is his problem. You were laughing – that was your problem. Why get mixed up? To avoid such situations, people have been trained for everything: how to walk, how to talk, what to say, when to say it. Naturally, by and by they become very phony – just actors in a drama, repeating dialogues.

I was visiting a theological college which is the biggest in Asia, which trains missionaries to go all over the poor East to convert people to Christianity. The principal was a friend, and he took me around their campus. In one class, I could not believe my eyes. What I saw being done was such an absurdity that I was almost stunned. The professor was teaching nearabout sixty students who were ready, almost ready to go for their missionary work. He was telling them, when they repeat a certain statement of Jesus, what kind of gesture, what kind of facial expression to use...when is the time to hit hard on the table, and when is the time to whisper silently that God is love. “And when you describe paradise, don’t just describe it in prose. Let your face be radiant; let each of your words be pure honey, just poetry.”

And at that time one student asked, “And when we are describing hell, what are we supposed to do?”

The professor said, “As far as hell is concerned...as you are, it is perfectly okay.”

There is no training for hell because you already look like you are in hell!

I asked the principal, “Can’t you see this nonsense? These people don’t have any feeling, and you are imposing on them that when they say something a certain expression on the face, in the eyes, in the hands, is needed.”

I have never been in any training, but when it is needed the hands know what to do. The words know when to stop and when to let silence take over. The eyes flash by themselves when you are describing your own experience. Then there is no effort....

All that is needed is to tell people: Be spontaneous! When laughter comes, don’t stop it. In this world, everything has become fake, because you believe in the fake. Be simple, be just yourself. There is no need to act. Whatever action comes spontaneously, let it come; enjoy its spontaneity. Then you will see a beauty, a centeredness, a simplicity. Something authentic — not fake, not pseudo. All this is so simple.

A farmer once had on his farm a rooster that was one of the laziest creatures that ever lived. Instead of crowing as it was supposed to do, when the sun came up in the morning, it merely waited until some other rooster crowed – and then it nodded its head in agreement.

But if it is spontaneous, it has its own beauty. Why bother?—somebody else is going to do it. I am in absolute agreement with that rooster; I have never

done anything in my life. If somebody happens to do it....

To celebrate their golden wedding anniversary, Saul and Sylvia Shulman decide to repeat the same things they did on their honeymoon. They go to the same hotel and book into the same room. Sylvia puts on the same perfume and the same nightgown. Just as he did on the honeymoon night, Saul goes into the bathroom and Sylvia hears him laughing —just as he had done fifty years before. So when he comes back Sylvia says, “Honey, it is really beautiful — everything is the same. I can remember it as if it were yesterday. Fifty years ago you went to the bathroom and laughed in the same way. At the time I did not have enough courage to ask you, but now, tell me. Why did you laugh?”

“Well, it is like this, darling,” says Paul. “That night fifty years ago, when I went to piss, I wet the ceiling. And tonight I wet my feet!”

Just be innocently simple. This man must have been a very spontaneous man. He told the truth – there is nothing to hide about it. But most of you would not have dared to tell the truth. Truth is very simple; it needs no training, no preparation, no homework. You simply are what you are. Just accept it and expose it to the world.

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Osho's teachings defy categorization, covering everything from the individual quest for meaning to the most urgent social and political issues facing society today. His books are not written but are transcribed from audio and video recordings of extemporaneous talks given to international audiences over a period of 35 years. Osho has been described by the *Sunday Times* in London as one of the "1000 Makers of the 20th Century" and by American author Tom Robbins as "the most dangerous man since Jesus Christ."

About his own work Osho has said that he is helping to create the conditions for the birth of a new kind of human being. He has often characterized this new human being as "Zorba the Buddha" — capable both of enjoying the earthy pleasures of a Zorba the Greek and the silent serenity of a Gautam Buddha. Running like a thread through all aspects of Osho's work is a vision that encompasses both the timeless wisdom of the East and the highest potential of Western science and technology.

Osho is also known for his revolutionary contribution to the science of inner transformation, with an approach to meditation that acknowledges the accelerated pace of contemporary life. His unique "Active Meditations" are designed to first release the accumulated stresses of body and mind, so that it is easier to experience the thought-free and relaxed state of meditation.

Two autobiographical works by the author are available:

OSHO: *Autobiography of a Spiritually Incorrect Mystic*, St. Martin's Griffin (June 9, 2001), ISBN-13: 978-0312280710

OSHO: *Glimpses of a Golden Childhood*, Rebel Publishing (India; 1998), ISBN-13: 978-8172610722

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OSHO International Meditation Resort

The OSHO International Meditation Resort is a great place for holidays and a place where people can have a direct personal experience of a new way of living with more alertness, relaxation, and fun. Located about 100 miles southeast of Mumbai in Pune, India, the resort offers a variety of programs to thousands of people who visit each year from more than 100 countries around the world. Originally developed as a summer retreat for Maharajas and wealthy British colonialists, Pune is now a thriving modern city that is home to a number of universities and high-tech industries. The Meditation Resort spreads over 40 acres in a tree-lined suburb known as Koregaon Park. The resort campus provides accommodation for a limited number of guests, in a new 'Guesthouse' and there is a plentiful variety of nearby hotels and private apartments available for stays of a few days up to several months.

Meditation resort programs are all based in the Osho vision of a qualitatively new kind of human being who is able both to participate creatively in everyday life and to relax into silence and meditation. Most programs take place in modern, air-conditioned facilities and include a variety of individual sessions, courses and workshops covering everything from creative arts to holistic health treatments, personal transformation and therapy, esoteric sciences, the "Zen" approach to sports and recreation, relationship issues, and significant life transitions for men and women. Individual sessions and group workshops are offered throughout the year, alongside a full daily schedule of meditations. Outdoor cafes and restaurants within the resort grounds serve both traditional Indian fare and a choice of international dishes, all made with organically grown vegetables from the resort's own farm. The campus has its own private supply of safe, filtered water. See www.osho.com/resort.

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